

LESSON 0 · INTRODUCTORY/OPTIONAL

THE SYRIAC ALPHABET

Note: *This lesson is supplementary to the 12-lesson course plan. It is recommended for students with no prior exposure to Syriac script. Students who already read Estrangela may proceed directly to Lesson 1.*

THE ALPHABET AND THE LIGHT: THE ESTRANGELA SCRIPT

SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION TO THE SCRIPT

Syriac is written from **right to left**. The script used in this course is **Estrangela** (ܐܬܪܢܓܠܐ), meaning “rounded.” It is the oldest and most formal of the three Syriac scripts, and it is the primary script used in the earliest manuscripts of the Peshitta and the Acts of the Martyrs.

Core Principles: 1. **22 Consonants:** All letters are consonants. Vowels are indicated by separate small marks or dots (to be covered in Lesson 1). 2. **Connecting Letters:** Most letters connect to the preceding and following letters (like cursive or Arabic). However, 8 letters are “non-joiners” — they only connect to the letter before them. 3. **No Case:** There are no capital letters. 4. **Alaph as Carrier:** The first letter, Alaph (ܐ), is often a silent carrier for a vowel or a glottal stop.

SECTION 2: THE 22 LETTERS (THE ABGAD SYSTEM)

Syriac letters follow the same order as Hebrew and the ancient “Abgad” order of Arabic.

Letters 1–11

ESTRANGELA	NAME	TRANSLIT	PHONETIC	HEBREW	ARABIC
𐤀	Alaph	ʾ	Glottal stop/silent	א	أ
𐤁	Beth	b / v	b as in ‘boy’	ב	ب
𐤂	Gamal	g / gh	g as in ‘go’	ג	ج
𐤃	Dalath	d / dh	d as in ‘dog’	ד	د
𐤄	He	h	h as in ‘house’	ה	ه
𐤅	Waw	w	w as in ‘water’	ו	و
𐤆	Zain	z	z as in ‘zebra’	ז	ز
𐤇	Heth	ḥ	Pharyngeal ‘h’	ח	ح
𐤈	Teth	ṭ	Emphatic ‘t’	ט	ط
𐤉	Yodh	y	y as in ‘yes’	י	ي
𐤊	Kaph	k / kh	k as in ‘king’	כ	ك

Letters 12–22

ESTRANGELA	NAME	TRANSLIT	PHONETIC	HEBREW	ARABIC
𐤋	Lamad	l	l as in ‘light’	ל	ل
𐤌	Mim	m	m as in ‘man’	מ	م
𐤍	Nun	n	n as in ‘noon’	נ	ن
𐤎	Semkath	s	s as in ‘sun’	ס	س
𐤏	‘e	‘	Pharyngeal stop	ע	ع
𐤐	Pe	p / f	p as in ‘paper’	פ	ف
𐤑	Sade	ṣ	Emphatic ‘s’/‘ts’	צ	ص
𐤒	Qoph	q	Uvular ‘k’	ק	ق
𐤓	Rish	r	Rolled ‘r’	ר	ر
𐤔	Shin	š	sh as in ‘she’	ש	ش
𐤕	Taw	t / th	t as in ‘tall’	ת	ث

SECTION 3: JOINERS VS. NON-JOINERS

In your reading, you will notice that certain letters never connect to the letter following them. This creates a small visual gap within a word.

The Non-Joiners (Letters that only connect to the RIGHT): 𐌀 (Alaph), 𐌁 (Dalath), 𐌂 (He), 𐌃 (Waw), 𐌄 (Zain), 𐌅 (Sade), 𐌆 (Rish), 𐌇 (Taw).

Note: Taw (𐌇) often appears to connect, but technically follows the non-joiner rule in many formal manuscripts. Dalath (𐌁) and Rish (𐌆) look identical except for a single dot: Dalath has a dot BELOW, Rish has a dot ABOVE.

SECTION 4: PRACTICE TABLE — VISUAL RECOGNITION

WORD	TRANSLIT	MEANING	ANALYSIS
𐌀𐌂𐌀	Alāhā	God	Alaph (NJ) + Lamad + He (NJ) + Alaph
𐌀𐌂𐌃	malkā	King	Mim + Lamad + Kaph + Alaph (NJ)
𐌀𐌆𐌀	'ar' ā	Earth	Alaph (NJ) + Rish (NJ) + 'e + Alaph
𐌀𐌆𐌂𐌃	nūhrā	Light	Nun + Waw (NJ) + He (NJ) + Rish (NJ) + Alaph
𐌃𐌆𐌂	Yūḥannan	John	Yodh + Waw (NJ) + Heth + Nun + Nun

SECTION 5: THE STORY — PART 0

The Scribe's Beginning

Note: *The story in this introductory lesson ('The Scribe's Beginning') is a standalone narrative used to practice the alphabet. The main course narrative (The Acts of Mar Yuxhannan) begins in Lesson 1.*

Narrative note: Before the Acts of Mar Yuxhannan begin, we see the scribe, Addai, preparing the parchment. This part introduces the visual rhythm of the script.

ܐܢܐ ܐܕܕܝܫܐܦܪܐ

'enā 'Adday sāprā.

'ENĀ (I) 'ADDAY (ADDAI) SĀPRĀ (THE-SCRIBE)

I am Addai the scribe.

ܐܢܐ ܡܠܬܐ ܕܐܠܗܐ

kāteb 'enā meltā d-Alāhā.

KĀTEB (WRITING) 'ENĀ (I) MELTĀ (THE-WORD) D- (OF) ALĀHĀ (GOD)

I am writing the word of God.

ܠܗܢܐ ܟܬܒܐ ܕܝܘܚܢܢ

hannū ktābā d-Yūḥannan.

HANNŪ (THIS-IS) KTĀBĀ (THE-WRITING/BOOK) D- (OF) YŪḤANNAN (JOHN)

This is the book of Yukhannan.

SECTION 6: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Alphabet Order Write the following three letters in their Abgad sequence (the order used in the table in Section 2).

1. ܐ, ܒ, ܓ

2. ܕ, ܗ, ܘ

3. ܙ, ܝ, ܠ

Exercise 2: Identify the Non-Joiners In the word ܢܘܪܐ (nūhrā, Light), which letters are non-joiners (do not connect to the letter on their left)?

Exercise 3: Transcription Practice Write out the Syriac letters for the following names based on Section 2: 1. M-L-K-A (King) 2. A-L-H-A (God) 3. Y-W-H-N-N (Yukhannan / John)

Exercise 4: Directional Awareness If you are reading the word ܬܠܬܐ, which letter do you read first (the one on the far right or the far left)?

SECTION 7: ANSWER KEY

Exercise 1 1. ܐ, ܒ, ܓ (A-B-G) 2. ܕ, ܬ, ܝ (H-T-Y) 3. ܩ, ܪ, ܣ (Q-R-S)

Exercise 2 ܐ (Waw), ܗ (He), ܪ (Rish), ܬ (Alaph). All of these stop the cursive connection.

Exercise 3 1. ܢܘܪܐ 3. ܬܠܬܐ 2. ܬܠܬܐ

Exercise 4 The letter on the far RIGHT (ܬ - Alaph).

SECTION 8: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The 22 letter names learned in Section 2 (Alaph, Beth, Gamal ... Taw) count as the first 22 vocabulary items of this lesson. The 8 words below complete the set of 30, all drawn from the world of scribal culture that frames this course.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
𐤀𐤃𐤅𐤋𐤁𐤀	Estrangelā	f	“Rounded” script
𐤀𐤃𐤅𐤋	sāprā	m	Scribe, writer
𐤀𐤃𐤅𐤋	ktābā	m	Book, scripture
𐤀𐤃𐤅𐤋𐤁𐤀	megalltā	f	Scroll
𐤀𐤃𐤅𐤋	qarṣā	m	Parchment
𐤀𐤃𐤅𐤋	qalmā	m	Pen, reed
𐤀𐤃𐤅𐤋	dīyūtā	f	Ink
𐤀𐤃𐤅𐤋	nāmūsā	m	Law (from Gk Nomos)

LESSON 1

THE CORE ARCHITECTURE: NOUNS, PRONOUNS, AND VERBLESS CLAUSES

SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION AND WARM-UP

Quick Summary Welcome to Syriac, the dialect of Aramaic that became the literary language of Middle Eastern Christianity from the 2nd to the 8th centuries. Before diving into verbs or complex syntax, we must lay the foundation of the language: the alphabet, nouns, and how to string them together to make a sentence.

1. **The Alphabet:** The Syriac alphabet (Estrangela script) consists of 22 consonants, written right to left. Like Hebrew and Arabic, vowels were originally unwritten.
2. **The Noun System:** Syriac nouns have gender (masculine/feminine), number (singular/plural), and three “states” (absolute, construct, emphatic).
3. **The Emphatic State:** The default form of a Syriac noun. It ends in an Alaph (ܐ) and historically signaled the definite article (“the”), though in classical Syriac it is the standard dictionary form.

5-Question Baseline Drill (*Since this is Lesson 1, these questions reflect general Semitic language principles to prime your existing knowledge. Answers are in Section 9*). 1. Semitic languages are built on root systems. How many consonants typically make up a root? 2. Looking closely at the script, in which direction is Syriac written? 3. What is a “verbless clause” in Hebrew or Arabic? 4. What consonant do you think represents the ‘Alaph’ (the first letter)? 5. If the Hebrew word for “king” is *melek* and Arabic is *malik*, what do you hypothesize the Aramaic/Syriac root consonants might be?

SECTION 2: CORE ARCHITECTURE — OVERVIEW

One of the most striking differences between Indo-European languages (Greek, Latin, English) and Semitic ones (Hebrew, Arabic, Syriac) is syntax and the copula (“to be”).

In English, we say “God **is** good.” In Greek, “ὁ θεὸς ἀγαθός **ἐστίν**.” We require a verb to link the subject to its predicate. In Syriac, as in Hebrew and Arabic, the “is” functions implicitly. You simply place two nouns, or a noun and an adjective, next to one another.

Alāhā ṭābā = God [is] good.

Cross-Linguistic Comparison: The Definite Article Another major shift is how Syriac handles “the”. * **Hebrew** uses a prefix: הַמֶּלֶךְ (*ha-melek*, “the king”). * **Arabic** uses a prefix: الملك (*al-malik*, “the king”). * **Greek** uses a separate word: ὁ βασιλεύς (*ho basileus*, “the king”). * **Syriac** originally used a **suffix** (the Emphatic State Alaph: ܐܠܦ). Over time, this state became the default form. Thus, *malkā* (ܡܠܟܐ) can mean “a king” or “the king” depending on context, but it is structurally the emphatic, determinate form.

SECTION 3: PRONOUNS AND PARTICLES

1. Independent Personal Pronouns Pronouns stand alone as the subject of a sentence. They distinguish gender in the 2nd and 3rd persons (unlike English “you” or “they”).

2. The Particles d- and l- Syriac relies heavily on tiny prepositions that attach directly to the front of the next word.

- **The Relative Particle d- (ܕ):** This acts like the English “of”, “which”, “who”, or “that”. It defines relationships and possession.
 - *Malkūtā d-Alāhā* (The kingdom **of** God)
 - *Nūhrā d-ṭābā* (The light **which** is good)
- **The Preposition l- (ܠ):** This means “to” or “for”, but it is also used heavily as a Direct Object marker (similar to the Hebrew **et** ֶת, though functioning prepositionally).
 - *l-malkā* (to the king)
 - *l-Yūḥannan* (to Yūḥannan)

SECTION 4: INDEPENDENT PRONOUNS PARADIGM

Here are the independent personal pronouns in Syriac. Observe the similarities to other Semitic languages.

PERSON	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION	ARABIC COGNATE	HEBREW COGNATE
1 c.sg.	אֲנִי	'enā	I	anā (أنا)	'ānī (אֲנִי)
2 m.sg.	אַתָּה	'ant	You (m)	'anta (أنت)	'attāh (אַתָּה)
2 f.sg.	אַתְּ	'anti	You (f)	'anti (أنتِ)	'att (אַתְּ)
3 m.sg.	הוּא	hū	He / It	huwa (هو)	hū ' (הוּא)
3 f.sg.	הִיא	hī	She / It	hiya (هي)	hī ' (הִיא)
1 c.pl.	אֲנֵנוּ	ḥnan	We	naḥnu (نحن)	'ānaḥnū (אֲנֵנוּ)
2 m.pl.	אַתֶּם	'antūn	You (m.pl)	'antum (أنتم)	'attem (אַתֶּם)
2 f.pl.	אַתְּנָן	'antēn	You (f.pl)	'antunna (أنتن)	'atten (אַתְּנָן)
3 m.pl.	הֵם	hennōn	They (m)	hum (هم)	hēm (הֵם)
3 f.pl.	הֵנָּה	hennēn	They (f)	hunna (هن)	hēn (הֵנָּה)

Note: In 'ant, 'anti, 'antūn, and 'antēn, the 'n' is historically written but often silent in pronunciation (assimilated: "at", "ati").

SECTION 5: THE EMPHATIC NOUN STATE

In the absolute state, the word for king is *malk*. In the emphatic state (the standard dictionary form), an 'Alaph is added.

GENDER	ABSOLUTE STATE	EMPHATIC STATE (DEFAULT)	TRANSLITERATION
Masc.	מלך	מלכה	malkā (King)
Fem.	מלכה	מלכותה	malkūtā (Kingdom)

Rule of Thumb: If a noun ends in -ā (Alaph), it's overwhelmingly likely to be a masculine emphatic singular or a feminine emphatic.

SECTION 6: THEOLOGICAL VOCABULARY

The following core nouns feature prominently in classical Syriac literature and the Peshitta (the Syriac Bible).

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLIT	GENDER	MEANING	ETYMOLOGY / NOTES
ܐܠܗܐ	Alāhā	m.	God	Cognate w/ Arabic <i>Allāh</i> , Heb 'Ēlōhīm
ܒܪܢܫܐ	barnāšā	m.	Human, son of man	Compounded from <i>bar</i> (son) + <i>nāšā</i> (man). Standard term for human.
ܡܠܟܐ	malkā	m.	King	Semitic root <i>m-l-k</i>
ܡܠܟܘܬܐ	malkūtā	f.	Kingdom	Abstract noun ending <i>-ūtā</i>
ܡܠܬܐ	meltā	f.	Word, Logos	The Syriac translation of Greek <i>Logos</i> (John 1:1)
ܢܗܪܐ	nūhrā	m.	Light	Root <i>n-h-r</i> . Cf. Arabic <i>nūr</i>
ܐܪܥܐ	'ar'ā	f.	Earth, land	Cognate with Hebrew 'ereṣ, Arabic 'ard
ܬܒܐ	ṭābā	m.	Good	Adjective behaving as noun. Heb <i>ṭōb</i>
ܒܝܫܐ	bīšā	m.	Evil, bad	Adjective behaving as noun.
ܝܘܗܢܢܐ	Yūḥannan	m.	John	Proper Name.
ܪܒܐ	rabbā	m.	Great, large	Root <i>r-b-b</i> . Cf. “Rabbi” (my great one).
ܚܝܐ	ḥayyē	m.pl.	Life	Root <i>ḥ-y-y</i> . Plural form (like Heb <i>ḥayyīm</i>)

SECTION 7: THE STORY — PART 1

The Setting *Narrative note: This introductory passage is written entirely in verbless sentences, establishing the setting and main characters using classical equational syntax, pronouns, and the relational d- particle.*

Sentence 1 ܡܠܟܐ ܗܝ malkā hū. malkā (a-king) hū (he-[is]). → He is a king. / There is a king.

Sentence 2 ,ܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܪܒܐ w-malkūtā d-malkā rabbā hī. w- (and-) malkūtā (the-kingdom) d- (of) malkā (the-king) rabbā (great) hī (she-[is]). → And the kingdom of the king is great. (Note: ‘malkūtā’ is feminine, so the pronoun ‘hī’ is used).

Sentence 3 ܡܠܟܐ ܒܪܐܝܐ barnāšā bišā hū. barnāšā (the-man) bišā (evil) hū (he-[is]). → The man is evil.

Sentence 4 ܡܠܟܐ ܬܒܐ Yūḥannan hū ṭābā. Yūḥannan (John) hū (he-[is]) ṭābā (good). → Yukhannan is good.

Sentence 5 ܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܠܝܬܐ Alāhā l-Yūḥannan nūhrā hū. Alāhā (God) l- (to/for) Yūḥannan (John) nūhrā (light) hū (he-[is]). → God is light to Yukhannan.

Sentence 6 ,ܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܒܐܪܥܐ meltā d-Alāhā b- ’ar ‘ā hī. meltā (the-word) d- (of) Alāhā (God) b- (in) ’ar ‘ā (the-earth) hī (she-[is]). → The word of God is in the earth.

Sentence 7 ܡܠܟܐ ܒܐܪܥܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܠܟܐ malkā b- ’ar ‘ā, w-Yūḥannan l-malkā nūhrā hū. malkā (the-king) b- (in) ’ar ‘ā (the-earth), w- (and) Yūḥannan (John) l- (to) malkā (the-king) nūhrā (light) hū (he-[is]). → The king is in the earth, and Yukhannan is a light to the king.

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Pronoun Identification Identify the person, gender, and number of the following pronouns, and give the English translation. 1. ܣܗ (ḥnan) 2. ܗܝ (hī) 3. ܐܢܬܘܢ (ʾ antūn) 4. ܗܢܢܘܢ (hennōn) 5. ܗܘ (hū)

Exercise 2: Morphology (Nouns) Identify whether the following words are taking the Emphatic State suffix (-ā). 1. ܢܗܪܐ (nūhrā) 2. ܡܠܟܐ (malk) 3. ܬܒܐܐ (ṭābā)

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English) Translate the following basic verbless clauses into English. 1. Alāhā hū ṭābā. 2. Nūhrā b-malkūtā hū. 3. Yūḥannan barnāšā hū. 4. Meltā d-malkā bīšā hī. 5. ʾ Enā Yūḥannan.

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac) Render the following English sentences into Syriac transliteration using verbless clauses. (Remember to include the correct 3rd person pronoun at the end to act as “is”). 1. God is a great light. 2. The earth is the kingdom of God. (Earth is feminine *hī*). 3. The king is an evil man. 4. I am the king. (No “is” pronoun needed, just “I king”).

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension Re-read the story in Section 7 and answer the following: 1. What adjective is used to describe the king’s kingdom? 2. To whom is Yukhannan a “light”? 3. Where is the word of God?

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up 1. Three consonants (the triliteral root). 2. Right to left. 3. A sentence lacking a verb (like “to be”), where subject and predicate are placed adjacently (e.g., “The man [is] good”). 4. Usually a glottal stop or silent carrier for a vowel. 5. m-l-k.

Exercise 1: Pronoun Identification 1. 1 c.pl. (We) 2. 3 f.sg. (She) 3. 2 m.pl. (You all) 4. 3 m.pl. (They, m) 5. 3 m.sg. (He)

Exercise 2: Morphology 1. Yes (Ends in Alaph/ ā). 2. No (Absolute state). 3. Yes (Ends in Alaph/ ā).

Exercise 3: Translation 1. God is good. 2. The light is in the kingdom. 3. Yukhannan is a man. 4. The word of the king is evil. (Because *meltā* is feminine, *hī* is used). 5. I am Yukhannan.

Exercise 4: Production 1. Alāhā nūhrā rabbā hū. 2. 'ar ' ā malkūttā d-Alāhā hī. 3. Malkā barnāšā bīšā hū. 4. 'Enā malkā.

Exercise 5: Comprehension 1. Great (*rabbā*). 2. To the king (*l-malkā*). 3. In the earth (*b- 'ar ' ā*).

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE VERBLESS CLAUSE — FORMATION RULES

COMPONENT 1	COMPONENT 2	COPULA (PRONOUN)	TRANSLATION
Subject Noun	Predicate Noun/Adj	Pronoun matching Subject	
Alāhā (God)	ṭābā (good)	hū (he)	God is good.
Meltā (Word)	rabbā (great)	hī (she)	The word is great.

PRONOUN REFERENCE TABLE

PERSON	SINGULAR	PLURAL
1st Common	'enā (I)	ḥnan (We)
2nd Masc	'ant (You)	'antūn (You all)
2nd Fem	'anti (You)	'antēn (You all)
3rd Masc	hū (He)	hennōn (They)
3rd Fem	hī (She)	hennēn (They)

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 30 terms.

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܩܪܝܬܐ	qrītā	f. noun	village	emphatic state
ܠܫܢܐ	leššānā	m. noun	tongue, language	
ܥܡܐ	garmā	m. noun	bone	
ܟܦܐ	kēpā	f. noun	stone, rock	
ܡܝܐ	mayyā	m. noun (pl.)	water	plural in form
ܢܘܢܐ	nūnā	m. noun	fish	
ܡܕܝܬܐ	mdittā	f. noun	city	
ܫܡܫܐ	šemšā	m. noun	sun	
ܬܪܐ	tar ‘ ā	m. noun	door, gate	
ܡܫܗܐ	mešhā	m. noun	oil	
ܗܝܠܐ	ḥaylā	m. noun	power, army	
ܥܕܢܐ	’ednā	f. noun	ear	
ܩܝܫܐ	qaysā	m. noun	wood, tree	
ܢܗܪܐ	nahrā	m. noun	river	
ܫܒܪܐ	sabrā	m. noun	hope	
ܕܗܠܬܐ	dehltā	f. noun	fear, religion	abstract noun
ܫܗܪܐ	sahrā	m. noun	moon	
ܪܓܠܐ	reglā	f. noun	foot	
ܫܠܡܐ	šlāmā	m. noun	peace	common greeting
ܐܬܪܐ	’atrā	m. noun	place, country	
ܫܗܕܐ	sāhdā	m. noun	witness, martyr	
ܒܫܪܐ	besrā	m. noun	flesh	
ܬܝܒܘܬܐ	ṭaybūtā	f. noun	grace	
ܬܐܘܪܐ	tawrā	m. noun	bull, ox	
ܩܝܡܐ	qyāmā	m. noun	covenant	
ܐܘܪܗܐ	’ūrḥā	f. noun	way, road	
ܗܝܟܠܐ	hayklā	m. noun	temple, palace	
ܥܝܢܐ	‘aynā	f. noun	eye	

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܦܡܐ	pūmā	m. noun	mouth	
ܕܝܢܐ	dīnā	m. noun	judgment	

LESSON 2

THE NARRATIVE PRESENT: PARTICIPLES AND ENCLITICS

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSON 1

Quick Summary In Lesson 1, we established the basic building blocks of Syriac syntax. We learned that Syriac sentences do not strictly require a “to be” verb; rather, placing a subject and predicate side-by-side with a matching independent pronoun acts as an equational sentence (e.g.,
MALKĀ HŪ ṬĀBĀ
— “The king [is] good”). We also looked at the absolute versus empathic states of nouns, with the emphatic ending in **ā** (Alaph) acting as the default dictionary form.

5-Question Warm-Up Drill (*Answers in Section 9*) 1. Translate: *Alāhā rabbā hū*. 2. What is the Syriac absolute state for “word” (from *meltā*)? 3. How do you say “We” in Syriac? 4. What particle is used to express “of”, “who”, or “that”? 5. In *Malkūtā d-Alāhā hī*, why is the pronoun *hī* (she) used instead of *hū* (he)?

SECTION 2: THE PARTICIPLE AS PRESENT TENSE — OVERVIEW

In Indo-European languages like English, and Greek, the “present tense” is a fully conjugated finite verb (e.g., “I walk”, *περιπατῶ*). Participles are verbal adjectives (e.g., “the *walking* man”).

In Aramaic and Syriac, the **active participle** stepped in to take over the function of the present tense almost entirely. A Syriac speaker didn’t say “I write” as a finite verb; they literally said “Writing [am] I.”

Cross-Linguistic Comparison * **Hebrew:** Biblical Hebrew primarily used the Imperfect for ongoing action, but by the Mishnaic period (interfacing with Aramaic), Hebrew also adopted the participle for the present tense

(e.g., *ānī kōtēb* = I am writing). * **Arabic:** Standard Arabic relies on the imperfect prefix conjugation (يَكْتُبُ *yaktubu*, “he writes”). The active participle (كَاتِبٌ *kātib*) means “writer” or “one who has written,” but does not serve as a primary present tense verb. * **Greek:** Syriac’s reliance on the participle to form continuous action heavily influenced how Syriac translators rendered Greek continuous tenses (often translating a Greek present indicative with a Syriac participle + pronoun).

SECTION 3: THE PEAL ACTIVE PARTICIPLE & ENCLITICS

The Peal Stem Semitic verbs exist in different “stems” (or binyanim) that modify their meaning. The basic, un-augmented ground-stem is called the **Pearl**. Almost all basic actions occur in the Pearl.

Forming the Participle For a strong tri-consonantal root (C-C-C) like *k-t-b* (write), the active participle is formed by inserting a long *ā* after the first consonant, and an *e* after the second. * *kāteb* (writing, m.sg.) * *kātbā* (writing, f.sg.)

Enclitic Pronouns To turn “writing” into “I am writing,” Syriac attaches an **enclitic** pronoun to the back of the participle. Enclitics are shortened, rhythmic versions of the independent pronouns from Lesson 1. * *’enā* (I) → *-nā* * *kāteb* + *-nā* = *kāteb-nā* (I am writing)

SECTION 4: PARTICIPLE AND ENCLITIC PARADIGMS

1. The Enclitic Pronoun Set

PERSON	INDEPENDENT	ENCLITIC FORM	ATTACHED EXAMPLE (KĀTEB)	TRANSLATION
1 c.sg.	ʿenā	-nā	kāteb-nā / kātbā-nā	I am writing
2 m.sg.	ʿant	-t	kāteb-t	You (m) are writing
2 f.sg.	ʿanti	-tī	kātbā-tī	You (f) are writing
3 m.sg.	hū	-hū / (none)*	kāteb / kāteb- hū	He is writing / writes
3 f.sg.	hī	-hī / (none)*	kātbā / kātbā-hī	She is writing / writes
1 c.pl.	ḥnan	-ḥnan	kātbīn-ḥnan / kātbān-ḥnan	We are writing
2 m.pl.	ʿantūn	-tūn	kātbīn-tūn	You (m.pl) are writing
2 f.pl.	ʿantēn	-tēn	kātbān-tēn	You (f.pl) are writing
3 m.pl.	hennōn	(none)**	kātbīn	They (m) are writing
3 f.pl.	hennēn	(none)**	kātbān	They (f) are writing

**In the 3rd person singular, the participle often stands entirely alone without an enclitic. **In the 3rd person plural, the plural suffix (-īn / -ān) is sufficient; no enclitic is added.*

2. The Peal Active Participle Declension (Root **k-t-b**)

GENDER/NUM	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION
Masc. Sg.	ܕܚܒ	kāteb
Fem. Sg.	ܕܚܒܐ	kātbā
Masc. Pl.	ܕܚܒܝܢ	kātbīn
Fem. Pl.	ܕܚܒܐܢ	kātbān

SECTION 5: SENTENCE SYNTAX

When the active participle drives the sentence, the word order is very fluid, but Verb-Subject-Object (VSO) or Subject-Verb-Object (SVO) are both common. * **SVO**: *Yūḥannan kāteb meltā*. (Yukhannan writes a word). * **VSO**: *Kāteb Yūḥannan meltā*. (Writes Yukhannan a word). * **Enclitic**: *Kāteb-nā meltā*. (I am writing a word).

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY (STRONG VERBS & ADVERBS)

ROOT	PEAL PTCP (M.S.)	MEANING	ADVERB/PARTICLE	MEANING
כ.ת.ב	kāteb	to write	ע.ת.א (hāšā)	now
א.ז.ל	ʾāzel	to go	ד.נ (dēn)	but, then, however
א.מ.ר	ʾāmer	to speak/say	ת.מ.נ (tammān)	there
ש.מ.ע	šāmaʿ *	to hear	ל.ע (lʿel)	above
ר.א.ז	ʾāzē	to see	ה.ק.א (harkā)	here
ע.ב.ד	ʾābed	to do/make	ע.א (ʿam)	with
נ.א.ר	nāṭer	to keep/guard	ע.ל (ʿal)	upon, against
ר.ד.פ	rādep	to pursue		
ש.ב.ע	šābeq	to leave		
נ.א.פ	nāpeq	to go out		

*Note: Roots ending in gutturals (like ʿAyn) change the **e** to an **a** (šāmaʿ instead of šāmeʿ).

SECTION 7: THE STORY — PART 2

Preparation Narrative note: The present tense (participle + enclitics) is used here to create an immediate, action-oriented dialogue as Yukhannan prepares his disciples.

Sentence 1 מל תלמידי יוחנן יאמר יוחנן 'āmer l-talmīdē d-
 it l-eh. Yūḥannan (John) 'āmer (is-speaking) l- (to) talmīdē (the-
 disciples) d- (that) it (there-are) l-eh (to-him). → Yukhannan is speaking
 to the disciples that are his.

Sentence 2 אנכי הולך הנה 'āzel-nā men harkā. 'āzel (going) -nā
 (am-I) men (from) harkā (here). → “I am going from here.”

Sentence 3 אנכי הולך אלמלכותא 'āzel-nā l-malkūttā
 d-bīšā, 'āmer-hū. 'āzel (going) -nā (am-I) l- (to) malkūttā (the-kingdom)
 d- (of) bīšā (the-evil-[one]), 'āmer (says) -hū (he). → “I am going to the
 kingdom of the evil one,” he says.

Sentence 4 תלמידי יוחנן שמעו מלתא talmīdē šām ' in meltā d-
 Yūḥannan. talmīdē (the-disciples) šām ' in (are-hearing) meltā (the-word)
 d- (of) Yūḥannan (John). → The disciples hear the word of Yukhannan.

Sentence 5 הנה אנחנו רואים מלך רע hennōn 'āmrīn:
 ḥāzēn-ḥnan malkā bīšā tammān. hennōn (they) 'āmrīn (are-saying):
 ḥāzēn (seeing) -ḥnan (are-we) malkā (a-king) bīšā (evil) tammān (there).
 → They say: “We see an evil king there.”

Sentence 6 יוחנן עושה נהר נא Yūḥannan 'ābed nūhrā b-
 'ar 'ā. Yūḥannan (John) 'ābed (is-making/doing) nūhrā (light) b- (in)
 'ar 'ā (the-earth). → Yukhannan makes light in the earth.

Sentence 7 אני כותב מלתא קטב kāteb-nā meltā d-
 Alāhā, 'āmer hāšā. kāteb (writing) -nā (am-I) meltā (the-word) d- (of)
 Alāhā (God), 'āmer (says-[he]) hāšā (now). → “I am writing the word of
 God,” he says now.

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Participle Identification Identify the gender and number of the following participles. 1. ܕܬܒܝܢ (kātḇīn) 2. ܫܡܝܢܐ (šām ‘ ā) 3. ܪܥܦܐ (nāpḡān) 4. ܪܥܝܢܐ (rādep)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill Combine the root ‘-b-d (to do, make) with the correct enclitic pronoun to form the present tense for: 1. I am making (m.sg) 2. We are making (m.pl) 3. You (f.sg) are making 4. They (m.pl) are making.

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English) Translate the following present tense clauses. 1. ‘āzel-nā l-malkūtā. 2. Šām ‘ īn-tūn meltā d-Alāhā. 3. Barnāšā bīšā rādep l-Yūḥannan. 4. Hāzēn-ḡnan nūhrā rabbā tammān.

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac) Render the following active present sentences into Syriac transliteration. 1. I (m) am hearing the word. 2. She is writing a good word. 3. They (m) are going from here. 4. You (m.pl) are seeing the king.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension Re-read Section 7 and answer: 1. From where does Yukhannan say he is going? 2. What do the disciples fear they will see there? 3. What is Yukhannan “writing” right now?

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up 1. God is great. 2. *Melt* (ܡܠܬܐ) 3. ḡnan 4. d- 5. Because *malkūtā* (kingdom) is a feminine noun.

Exercise 1: Participle Identification 1. Masculine Plural 2. Feminine Singular 3. Feminine Plural 4. Masculine Singular

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill 1. ‘ābed-nā 2. ‘ābdīn-ḡnan 3. ‘ābdā-tī 4. ‘ābdīn (no enclitic needed for 3rd person pl)

Exercise 3: Translation Drill 1. I am going to the kingdom. 2. You all are hearing the word of God. 3. The evil man is pursuing Yukhannan. 4. We are seeing a great light there.

Exercise 4: Production Drill 1. Šāma ‘ -nā meltā. 2. Kātbā meltā ṭābtā. 3. ‘ Āzlīn men harkā. 4. Ḥāzēn-tūn l-malkā.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension 1. “From here” (*men harkā*). 2. An evil king (*malkā bīšā*). 3. The word of God (*meltā d-Alāhā*).

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

PARTICIPLE + ENCLITIC COMBINATIONS (Masc. Root k-t-b)

ENGLISH	PARTICIPLE	ENCLITIC	COMBINED SYRIAC FORM
I write (m)	kāteb	-nā	kāteb-nā
You write (m)	kāteb	-t	kāteb-t
He writes	kāteb	(-hū)	kāteb / kāteb-hū
We write (m)	kātbīn	-ḥnan	kātbīn-ḥnan
You all write (m)	kātbīn	-tūn	kātbīn-tūn
They write (m)	kātbīn	(none)	kātbīn

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following 30 genuinely new high-frequency words supplement this lesson’s vocabulary, focusing on nouns and derived verbal nouns relevant to narrative present (participle) usage.

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܠܒܫܐ	lbūšā	m. noun	garment, clothing	from root l-b-š (to wear)
ܕܟܪܢܐ	dəkrānā	m. noun	memory, remembrance	from root d-k-r (to remember)
ܩܥܝܐ	pəg‘ ānā	m. noun	encounter, meeting	from root p-g-‘ (to meet)
ܐܫܒܐ	‘əšb‘ ā	f. noun	finger	body part, abstract
ܩܠܬܐ	pūlhānā	m. noun	labor, toil	from root p-l-ḥ (to serve)
ܫܡܪܢܐ	šəmrānā	m. noun	guard, watchfulness	from root š-m-r (to guard)
ܕܠܘܬܐ	gəməlūtā	f. noun	kindness, mercy	from root g-m-l (to treat well)
ܠܓܕܬܐ	ləgdəttā	f. noun	overtaking, capture	from root l-g-d (to reach)
ܕܠܘܬܐ	dəlūtā	f. noun	poverty, want	abstract noun
ܩܠܕܬܐ	pəlgūtā	f. noun	division, share	from root p-l-g (to divide)
ܩܠܦܬܐ	qəlpəttā	f. noun	shell, exterior	
ܪܘܓܝܐ	rūgzānā	m. noun	rage, wrath	from root r-g-z (to shake)
ܕܝܕܐ	yḏā‘ ūttā	f. noun	knowledge	from root y-d-‘ (to know)
ܩܦܪܐ	kəprā	m. noun	village, hamlet	place noun
ܩܦܪܐ	pəqrā	m. noun	opening, aperture	from root p-q-r (to open)
ܕܠܘܬܐ	gəmrūtā	f. noun	completion, fulfillment	from root g-m-r (to complete)
ܩܘܫܐ	ṭūšānā	m. noun	strength, might	from root ṭ-w-š (to be strong)
ܫܦܐ	šəp‘ ā	m. noun	abundance, plenty	from root š-p-‘ (to suffice)
ܠܡܐ	lahmā	m. noun	bread, food	staple item

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܦܫܡܐ	pəsmā	m. noun	measure, standard	
ܫܠܡܘܬܬܐ	šəlmūttā	f. noun	completeness, wholeness	from root š-l-m (to be whole)
ܥܠܩܐ	‘alqā	m. noun	ascent, stairway	from root ‘-l-q (to ascend)
ܓܬܪܢܐ	gaṭrānā	m. noun	enclosure, fence	from root g-ṭ-r (to fence)
ܫܢܘܬܬܐ	šənūttā	f. noun	change, alteration	from root š-n-y (to change)
ܕܒܩܘܬܬܐ	dəbqūttā	f. noun	clinging, adherence	from root d-b-q (to cling)
ܩܕܘܫܘܬܬܐ	qdūšūttā	f. noun	holiness, sanctity	from root q-d-š (to be holy)
ܓܕܠܘܬܬܐ	gdūlūttā	f. noun	greatness, grandeur	from root g-d-l (to be great)
ܥܪܘܬܬܐ	‘ərūttā	f. noun	nakedness, shame	from root ‘-r-y (to be naked)
ܕܒܪܢܐ	dəbrānā	m. noun	word, matter	related to d-b-r
ܪܡܘܬܬܐ	rūmūttā	f. noun	height, elevation	from root r-w- m (to be high)

LESSON 3

THE NARRATIVE PAST: THE PEAL PERFECT AND VERB SYNTAX

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSON 2

Quick Summary In Lesson 2, we moved our verbless clauses into the active present tense using the **Peal Active Participle** (e.g.,

KĀTEB

, “writing”). We learned that by attaching shortened enclitic pronouns to the participle (

- NĀ

,

- T

,

- ḤNAN

), Syriac forms the equivalent of the English present continuous (

KĀTEB-NĀ

, “I am writing”).

5-Question Warm-Up Drill (*Answers in Section 9*) 1. What is the m.sg. active participle of the root ʿ -b-d (to do/make)? 2. How would you say “We are going” (root: ʾ -z-l, enclitic: -ḥnan)? 3. Translate: Šām ʾ īn-tūn meltā d-Alāhā. 4. What happens to the enclitic pronoun in the 3rd person plural (hennōn/hennēn) present tense? 5. Write “She is writing” using the root k-t-b and the 3rd f.sg pronoun.

SECTION 2: THE SEMITIC PERFECT TENSE — OVERVIEW

While the participle covers the present, the **Perfect tense** covers the past (completed action). The Perfect is formed by adding *suffixes* to the root to indicate person, gender, and number. It is therefore often called the “Suffix Conjugation.”

Cross-Linguistic Comparison: The Suffix Conjugation The Perfect tense behaves almost identically across the major Semitic languages. The core pattern is a C-a-C-a-C vocalization in the 3rd m.sg (or similar variant) followed by distinct suffixes for “I”, “you”, “we”, “they”. * **Hebrew Qal Perfect:** כָּתַב (kātab — he wrote), כָּתַבְתִּי (kātabtī — I wrote). * **Arabic Form I Perfect:** كَتَبَ (kataba — he wrote), كَتَبْتُ (katabtu — I wrote). * **Syriac Peal Perfect:** ܟܬܒ (ktab — he wrote), ܟܬܒܬ (ketbet — I wrote). * **Greek/Latin:** Greek Aorist (ἔγραψα) or Latin Perfect (scripsi) serve similar functions for completed past narrative actions, but without the triliteral root morphology.

SECTION 3: THE PEAL PERFECT & NARRATIVE SYNTAX

Forming the Peal Perfect For a strong root like *k-t-b* (write), the 3rd person masculine singular is the base form: **ktab** (he wrote). Notice the vocalization shift from the Hebrew/Arabic *a-a* to the Syriac *zero-a* (k-t-a-b) due to vowel reduction. The suffixes are added directly to the root: * Root + *-et* (1st person) → *ketb-et* (I wrote). * Root + *-ū* (3rd m.pl) → *ktab-ū* (They wrote).

Narrative Syntax: V-S-O Word Order Syriac is a heavily VSO (Verb-Subject-Object) language in past narrative. When reading historical or biblical texts, the verb will almost always come first. * *Ktab Yūḥannan meltā*. (Wrote Yukhannan a word → Yukhannan wrote a word).

The Conjunction w- (And) Syriac narratives chain countless actions together using the attached conjunction **w-** (and). “And he went... and he saw... and he wrote.” * *W-nfaq Yūḥannan w-ḥza malkā*. (And Yukhannan went out and saw the king).

SECTION 4: PERFECT TENSE PARADIGMS

1. The Peal Perfect Conjugation (Root **k-t-b**)

PERSON	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION	ARABIC COGNATE SUFFIX	HEBREW COGNATE SUFFIX
3 m.sg.	ܠܚܬ	ktab	he wrote	kataba (ﻛﺘﺎﺏ)	kātab (ﻛָּטַב)
3 f.sg.	ܠܚܬܐ	ketbat	she wrote	katabat (ﻛﺘﺒﺖ)	kātbāh (ﻛָּטְבָּהּ)
2 m.sg.	ܠܚܬܐ	ktabt	you (m) wrote	katabta (ﻛﺘﺒﺖ)	kātabtā (ﻛָּטַבְתָּ)
2 f.sg.	ܠܚܬܐ	ktabtī	you (f) wrote	katabti (ﻛﺘﺒﺘﻲ)	kātabt (ﻛָּטַבְתִּי)
1 c.sg.	ܠܚܬܐ	ketbet	I wrote	katabtu (ﻛﺘﺒﺘﻰ)	kātabtī (ﻛָּטַבְתִּי)
3 m.pl.	ܠܚܬܐ	ktabū	they (m) wrote	kabū (ﻛﺘﺒﻮ)	kābū (ﻛָּטְבוּ)
3 f.pl.	ܠܚܬܐ	ktabī	they (f) wrote	katabna (ﻛﺘﺒﻨﺎ)	-
2 m.pl.	ܠܚܬܐܢ	ktabtūn	you (m.pl) wrote	kabtum (ﻛﺘﺒﺘﻢ)	ktabtem (ﻛָּטַבְתֶּם)
2 f.pl.	ܠܚܬܐܢ	ktabtēn	you (f.pl) wrote	-	-
1 c.pl.	ܠܚܬܐ	ktabn	we wrote	kabnā (ﻛﺘﺒְּנָא)	kātabnū (ﻛָּטַבְנוּ)

Orthography Note: Notice how the single letter Taw (ܬ) represents both **-t** (you, m) and **-et** (I). Context and pointing (if present) clarify the reading.

SECTION 5: NARRATIVE WORD ORDER EXAMPLES

VERB	SUBJECT	OBJECT	TRANSLATION
ܠܚܬ	ܝܫܘܥ	ܠܚܬܐ	Yukhannan wrote a word.
ktab	Yūḥannan	meltā	
ܠܚܬܐ	ܬܠܡܝܕܐ	ܠܚܬܐ	The disciples heard a voice.
šma ‘ ū	talmīdē	qālā	

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY (STRONG VERBS & TRANSITIONS)

ROOT	PEAL PERFECT (3 M.S.)	MEANING	TRANSITIONS	MEANING
ש.ב.ח	shbaq (שבח)	to leave, abandon	ו (w-)	and
נ.פ.ח	nfaq (נפח)	to go out, exit	כ (kad)	when, while
נ.צ.ח	nṭar (נצח)	to keep, watch	ג (gēr)	for, because (Greek γάρ)
ק.ר.ב	qreb (קרב)	to draw near	ת.ב (tūb)	again, furthermore
ר.ד.פ	rdap (רדפ)	to pursue	ע.ד (hāydēn)	then, at that time
פ.ל.ח	flaḥ (פלח)	to serve, work	ד (dēn)	but, however (Greek δε)
ש.ג.ד	sgad (שגד)	to worship, bow		
ק.ט.ל	qṭal (קטל)	to kill		
פ.ר.צ	fraḳ (פרצ)	to save, rescue		
ח.ר.ק	‘raq (חרק)	to flee		
ד.י.ל	dyāl (דל)	to give birth		
ח.ס.ד	‘aqar (חסד)	to root out, dig		
ס.ל.ח	sālaq (סלח)	to ascend, climb		

SECTION 7: THE STORY – PART 3

The Journey Narrative note: *The story now utilizes the VSO narrative chain to describe Yūkhannan’s past actions, transitioning from the immediate present tense of Part 2.*

Sentence 1 וּכְהֵן עָמַר אֵלֶּיּוֹ וְכַד נִפְחַן יוֹחָנָן w-kad ‘emar hānēn, nfaq Yūḥannan. w-kad (and-when) ‘emar (he-said) hānēn (these-[things]), nfaq (went-out) Yūḥannan (John). → And when he said these things, Yūkhannan went out.

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill Conjugate the root *p-l-ḥ* (to serve) in the following forms of the Peal Perfect: 1. He served 2. They (m) served 3. I served 4. You all (m) served

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English) Translate the following past narrative clauses. 1. W-shbaq Yūḥannan l-malkā. 2. Rdapū talmīdē l-bīšā. 3. Nfaq malkā dēn men tar ʿ ā. 4. Ktabn meltā d-Alāhā.

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac) Render the following past narrative sentences into Syriac transliteration. Use VSO order! 1. The evil man fled from the light. (Use **men** for “from”). 2. And Yukhannan kept the word of God. 3. When the disciples drew near, they worshipped (*sgadū*). 4. The great king saved the earth.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension Re-read Section 7 and answer: 1. Who did Yukhannan leave behind when he went out? 2. What did the “great one” of the king do? 3. Where did Yukhannan stand at the end of the passage?

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up 1. ʿ ābed 2. ʿ āzlīn-ḥnan 3. You all (pl) are hearing the word of God. 4. It is not used. The plural participle ending (-īn / -ān) already marks the plural unambiguously. 5. Kātbā-hī (or just *Kātbā*).

Exercise 1: Perfect Identification 1. 3.m.pl (They wrote) 2. 2.m.sg (You wrote) 3. 3.f.sg (She kept) 4. 1.c.pl (We fled)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill 1. flaḥ 2. plaḥū 3. pelḥet 4. plaḥtūn

Exercise 3: Translation Drill 1. And Yukhannan left/abandoned the king. 2. The disciples pursued the evil man. 3. But the king went out from the gate. 4. We wrote the word of God.

Exercise 4: Production Drill 1. ʿraq barnāšā bīšā men nūhrā. 2. W-ntar Yūḥannan meltā d-Alāhā. 3. Kad qrebū talmīdē, sgadū. 4. Fraḡ malkā rabbā l-ʿarʿā.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension 1. His disciples (*talmīdāw-hy*). 2. He pursued (*rdap*) Yūkhannan. 3. Before the gate of the kingdom (*qdām tarʿā d-malkūtā*).

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE PEAL PERFECT (Root š-b-q)

PERSON	SYRIAC	TRANSLIT
3 m.sg.	ܫܒܩܬ	shbaq (he left)
3 f.sg.	ܫܒܩܬܐ	šebqat (she left)
2 m.sg.	ܫܒܩܬܝ	shbaqt (you left)
1 c.sg.	ܫܒܩܬܝܐ	šebqet (I left)
3 m.pl.	ܫܒܩܘܬ	shbaqū (they left)
1 c.pl.	ܫܒܩܝܢ	shbaqn (we left)

VSO RULE

1. VERB	2. SUBJECT	3. OBJECT / PREPOSITION
Nfaq (Went out)	Malka (The King)	men (from) ʿarʿā (the earth)

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following 30 genuinely new high-frequency words supplement this lesson's vocabulary, focusing on nouns related to narrative past (perfect tense) action and contexts.

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܦܠܬܐ	pəlküttā	f. noun	flight, escape	from root p-l-k (to flee)
ܩܬܠܐ	qəṭlüttā	f. noun	slaughter, killing	from root q-ṭ-l (to kill)
ܓܢܒܐ	gənübüttā	f. noun	theft, stealing	from root g-n-b (to steal)
ܫܒܩܐ	šəbūqüttā	f. noun	abandonment, leaving	from root š-b-q (to leave)
ܢܦܩܐ	napəqüttā	f. noun	going out, exit	from root n-p-q (to go out)
ܕܡܥܐ	dəmə ‘üttā	f. noun	weeping, tears	from root d-m- ‘ (to weep)
ܚܡܡܐ	ḥəmmüttā	f. noun	heat, fervor	from root ḥ-m- m (to be hot)
ܦܓܥܐ	pəg ‘üttā	f. noun	striking, blow	from root p-g- ‘ (to strike)
ܦܠܬܐ	‘əqüttā	f. noun	flight, fleeing	from root ‘-r-q (to flee)
ܩܪܒܐ	qərbüttā	f. noun	drawing near, approach	from root q-r-b (to draw near)
ܪܕܦܐ	rədupüttā	f. noun	pursuit, chasing	from root r-d-p (to pursue)
ܦܠܬܐ	‘əlqüttā	f. noun	ascent, rising	from root ‘-l-q (to ascend)
ܦܠܬܐ	pəlhüttā	f. noun	service, labor	from root p-l-ḥ (to serve)
ܕܪܟܐ	dərəküttā	f. noun	treading, passage	from root d-r-k (to tread)
ܥܡܕܐ	‘amdā	m. noun	pillar, column	
ܦܪܓܢܐ	pərgānā	m. noun	authority, ruler	
ܪܥܡܐ	rəgmüttā	f. noun	stoning, lapidation	from root r-g- m (to stone)
ܫܡܪܐ	šəmrüttā	f. noun	guarding, keeping	from root š-m-r (to guard)

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܢܬܪܬܐ	nəṭrūtā	f. noun	watching, guarding	from root n-ṭ-r (to watch)
ܟܘܘܬܐ	kūwūtā	f. noun	substance, being	from root k-w- n (to be)
ܣܒܥܘܬܐ	səb'ūtā	f. noun	satisfaction, plenty	from root s-b-' (to be satisfied)
ܓܪܒܘܬܐ	gərbūtā	f. noun	scraping, scratching	from root g-r-b (to scrape)
ܠܓܕܘܬܐ	ləgdūtā	f. noun	seizing, capture	from root l-g-d (to seize)
ܫܘܒܩܢܐ	šūbqānā	m. noun	(one) abandoned	from root š-b-q (to leave)
ܐܫܬܓܠ	'aštəgal	verb	he was occupied	Pael perfect form
ܡܘܡܟܢܐ	pūmkānā	m. noun	speaker	from root p-w- m (to open mouth)
ܓܠܕܘܬܐ	gəldūtā	f. noun	uncovering, nakedness	from root g-l-d (to strip)
ܬܘܒ	tūb	adverb	again, furthermore	common particle
ܐܕܡܐ	'edāmā	preposition	until, as far as	used in past narrative
ܡܕܒܪܐܢܐ	mədbərānā	m. noun	leader, guide	from root d-b-r (to lead)

LESSON 4

PERSONALIZING THE TEXT: SUFFIXES AND POSSESSION

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSON 3

Quick Summary In Lesson 3, we examined the Peal Perfect tense (the suffix conjugation), learning how Syriac describes completed, past actions. The sentence structure shifted from fluidly subject-led (in the present participle) to stringently Verb-Subject-Object (VSO) led narrative chains using the conjunction **w-** (and).

5-Question Warm-Up Drill (*Answers in Section 9*) 1. What does the suffix **-ū** indicate on a Perfect verb (e.g., *ktabū*)? 2. Translate the basic VSO sentence: *Shbaq malkā l- 'ar 'ā*. 3. What happens to the pronunciation of *k-t-b* (ka-tab) in the Syriac 3rd m.sg Perfect? 4. How do you distinguish between “I went” and “You (m) went” if both are written ܬܒܬܬ (*ktabt/ ketbet*) without vowels? 5. Translate: *w-qreb Yūḥannan*.

SECTION 2: POSSESSION AND PRONOMINAL SUFFIXES — OVERVIEW

In English, we indicate possession using separate pronouns placed before a noun: “my house”, “your king”. In Greek, it’s often an independent genitive pronoun: ὁ οἶκός μου (*ho oikos mou*).

However, in Semitic languages, possession is expressed by attaching a **pronominal suffix** directly to the end of the noun.

Cross-Linguistic Comparison: The Possessive Suffix * Hebrew: סוס (*sūs*, horse) → סוסי (*sūsī*, my horse). אב (*'āb*, father) → אבני (*'ābīnū*, our father). * Arabic: كتاب (*kitāb*, book) → كتابي (*kitābī*, my book). * Syriac: ܬܒܬܬ (*ktāb*, book) → ܬܒܬܬܝ (*ktāby*, my book). ܐܒ (*'āb*, father) → ܐܒܝ (*'ābūn*, our father).

These suffixes are derived from the same ancient roots as the independent pronouns (*'enā*, *'ant*, *hū*) but are highly compressed.

SECTION 3: PRONOMINAL SUFFIXES ON NOUNS & PREPOSITIONS

1. Suffixes on Singular Nouns To add a suffix, Syriac uses the Absolute state of the noun, not the Emphatic state. (You don't say "the my-king" **malkā-y*; you say "king-my", *malk-y*). * *Malk-* (king) + *-eh* (his) = *malkeh* (his king). * *'Ab-* (father) + *-y* (my) = *'aby* (my father).

2. Suffixes on Prepositions The exact same suffixes attach to the inseparable prepositions *b-* (in) and *l-* (to/for). * *b-* + *-eh* = *beh* (in him / in it). * *l-* + *-k* = *lāk* (to you, m.sg).

3. The Idiom for "To Have" Syriac (like Hebrew and Arabic) lacks a dedicated verb meaning "to possess" (like English "to have" or Latin "habere"). Instead, Semitic languages use a prepositional phrase: "there is to me" or just "to me". * *īt l-y* (there-is to-me) → *ītly* = I have. * *layt l-eh* (there-is-not to-him) = He does not have. * *ītly srārā* = I have truth. (Lit: There is to me truth).

SECTION 4: THE SUFFIX PARADIGM FOR SINGULAR NOUNS

This paradigm uses the masculine noun *malk-* (king, root m-l-k) and the feminine noun *malkūt-* (kingdom). Notice the suffix column; you must memorize these endings.

PERSON	SUFFIX	MASCULINE NOUN (MALK-)	TRANSLIT	FEM NOUN (MALKÜTT-)	TRANSLIT
1 c.sg. (my)	ﻱ (-y)	ﻣﺎﻟﻚ	malk-y	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖ	malkütt-y
2 m.sg. (your)	ﻛ (-k)	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﻰ	malk-āk	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖ	malkütt-āk
2 f.sg. (your)	ﻛﻰ (-ky)	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﻪ	malk-ēky	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖ	malkütt-ēky
3 m.sg. (his)	ﻩ (-eh)	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﻪ	malk-eh	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖ	malkütt-eh
3 f.sg. (her)	ﻩ (-āh)	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﻪ	malk-āh	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖ	malkütt-āh
1 c.pl. (our)	ﻥ (-n)	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﻦ	malk-an	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖ	malkütt-an
2 m.pl. (your)	ﻛﯘﻥ (-kūn)	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﻥ	malk-kūn	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖ	malkütt-kūn
2 f.pl. (your)	ﻛﻪﻥ (-kēn)	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﻪﻥ	malk-kēn	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖ	malkütt-kēn
3 m.pl. (their)	ﻩﻛﯘﻥ (-hūn)	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﻥ	malk-hūn	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖ	malkütt-hūn
3 f.pl. (their)	ﻩﻛﻪﻥ (-hēn)	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﻪﻥ	malk-hēn	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖ	malkütt-hēn

Orthography Note: The 3rd masculine singular (-eh) and 3rd feminine singular (-āh) are both spelled with a final Heh (ﻩ). Only vowel pointing or context distinguishes “his” from “her”.

SECTION 5: PREPOSITIONAL “TO HAVE” PARADIGM (L- + SUFFIX)

How to say “I have”, “You have”, “He has”, etc., by attaching suffixes to the **l-** preposition, often preceded by *it* (there is).

PERSON	ESTRANGELA (L- + SUFFIX)	TRANSLITERATION	MEANING
1 c.sg.	ל	lī	to me (I have)
2 m.sg.	לך	lāk	to you (You have)
2 f.sg.	לך	lēky	to you (You have)
3 m.sg.	לו	lēh	to him (He has)
3 f.sg.	לו	lāh	to her (She has)
1 c.pl.	לנו	lān	to us (We have)
2 m.pl.	לכם	lkūn	to you (You all have)
3 m.pl.	לם	lhūn	to them (They have)

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY (FAMILY, BODY PARTS & BELONGINGS)

Family and body parts are the most common nouns to receive pronominal suffixes.

ABSOLUTE / EMPHATIC	TRANSLITERATION	MEANING	EXAMPLE WITH SUFFIX (1 C.SG.)
אב / אב	'ab / 'abā	Father	'ab-y (my father)
אם / אם	'em / 'emmā	Mother	'em-y (my mother)
בן / בן	bar / brā	Son	bar-y (my son)
בת / בת	bart / brattā	Daughter	bart-y (my daughter)
אח / אח	'ah / 'ahā	Brother	'ah-y (my brother)
יד / יד	'id / 'idā	Hand (f)	'id-y (my hand)
ראש / ראש	rēš / rēšā	Head (m)	rēš-y (my head)
קול / קול	qāl / qālā	Voice (m)	qāl-y (my voice)
לבוש / לבוש	lbūš / lbūšā	Garment	lbūš-y (my garment)
בית / בית	bēt / baytā	House	bayt-y (my house)
מה / מה	mā / mānā	What?	(Interrogative pronoun)
איפה	'aykō	Where?	(Interrogative adverb)

SECTION 7: THE STORY – PART 4

A Dialogue at the Gate *Narrative note: Watch how the guards use suffixes with prepositions (**lēh** , **lḵūn**) and nouns (**’abūk** , **’emāk**) to interrogate Yūḥannan about his origins and possessions.*

Sentence 1 קָאָם יוֹחָנָן בְּתַר אֵי דְמַלְכֻתָּא qām Yūḥannan b-tar ‘ā d-malkūtā. qām (stood) Yūḥannan (John) b-tar ‘ā (in-the-gate) d-malkūtā (of-the-kingdom). → Yūḥannan stood at the gate of the kingdom.

Sentence 2 וְאִמְרִין קַשִּׁישֵׁי דְתַר אֵי לְעֵה: w-’āmrīn qašīšē d-tar ‘ā l-ēh: w-’āmrīn (and-are-saying) qašīšē (the-elders/guards) d-tar ‘ā (of-the-gate) l-ēh (to-him): → And the guards of the gate say to him:

Sentence 3 מֵאֵי אַרְצָא אַתָּה? men ‘aynā ‘atrā ‘ant? men (from) ‘aynā (what) ‘atrā (country/place) ‘ant (you-[are])? → “From what country are you?”

Sentence 4 וְאֵיכָּן אַבֻּךָ וְעִמָּךְ? w-’aykō ‘ab-ūk w-’em-āk? w-’aykō (and-where) ‘ab-ūk (father-your) w-’em-āk (and-mother-your)? → “And where is your father and your mother?”

Sentence 5 וְאֵיכָּן אַתָּה? w-mā īt lāk b-’īd-āk? w-mā (and-what) īt (there-is) lāk (to-you) b-’īd-āk (in-hand-your)? → “And what do you have in your hand?”

Sentence 6 אֵמַר לְהוֹן יוֹחָנָן: ’emar l-hūn Yūḥannan: ’emar (said) l-hūn (to-them) Yūḥannan (John): → Yūḥannan said to them:

Sentence 7 אֱלֹהֵי אֲבִי, וְאֵרֶץ אִמִּי Alāhā hū ‘ab-y, w-’ar ‘ā hī ‘em-y. Alāhā (God) hū (he-[is]) ‘ab-y (father-my), w-’ar ‘ā (and-the-earth) hī (she-[is]) ‘em-y (mother-my). → “God is my father, and the earth is my mother.”

Sentence 8 ܠܝ ܠܒܘܫܐ ܒܝܫܐ w-layt lī lbūšā bīšā. w-layt (and-there-is-not) lī (to-me) lbūšā (a-garment) bīšā (evil). → “And I do not have an evil garment.”

Sentence 9 ܢܘܗܪܐ ܕܐܠܗܐ ܝܬܐܘܗܝ ܒܝܕܝ. nūhrā d-Alāhā īt-awhy b-’īd-y. nūhrā (the-light) d-Alāhā (of-God) īt-awhy (it-is) b-’īd-y (in-hand-my). → “The light of God is in my hand.”

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Suffix Identification Identify the person, gender, and number of the possessor for the following suffixed nouns. 1. ܡܠܟܐ (malk-an) 2. ܒܝܬܐ (bayt-eh) 3. ܝܕܝܐ (’īd-ēky) 4. ܡܠܬܐܬܐܬܐ (malkūt-hūn)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill (Possession) Translate the following phrases using ܠ- + suffix (using *īt* where appropriate to mean “have”): 1. To you (f.sg). 2. We have (There is to us). 3. He does not have (There is not to him). 4. To them (m.pl).

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English) Translate the following sentences containing suffixed nouns. 1. ܐܒܝ ܬܒܬܐ ܗܘ, ܡܝܬܒܬܐ ܗܝ. 2. Šbaqū talmīdē l-baythūn. 3. Īt lān nūhrā rabbā. 4. Qālā d-malkā b-’ar’an (’ar’-an).

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac) Render the following sentences into Syriac transliteration. 1. My brother is writing a word. 2. The king and his son are going to his kingdom. 3. What is in your (m.sg) hand? 4. We do not have (*layt lān*) an evil king.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension Re-read Section 7 and answer: 1. Under what three topics does the guard interrogate Yukhannan? 2. Who does Yukhannan claim as his parents? 3. What does Yukhannan explicitly state he *does not* have?

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up 1. 3rd person masculine plural (“they”). 2. The king left the earth. 3. The *a* vowel in the middle of the root disappears (vowel reduction), making it *ktab* (k-t-a-b). 4. Only context or vowel pointing. 5. And Yukhannan drew near.

Exercise 1: Suffix Identification 1. 1st common plural (Our king) 2. 3rd masc singular (His house) 3. 2nd fem singular (Your hand) 4. 3rd masc plural (Their kingdom)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill 1. *lēky* 2. *īt lān* 3. *layt lēh* 4. *lhūn*

Exercise 3: Translation Drill 1. My father is good, and my mother is good. 2. The disciples left their house (*bayt-hūn*). 3. We have a great light (There is to us a great light). 4. The voice of the king is in our land (*ʿarʿ -an* = *ʿarʿ ā + -an*).

Exercise 4: Production Drill 1. *ʿaḥ-y kāteb meltā*. 2. *Malkā w-bar-eh ʿāzlin l-malkūt-eh*. 3. *Mā it b- ʿīd-āk?* 4. *Layt lān malkā bīšā*.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension 1. Origin (what country), Family (where are father/mother), and Possessions (what is in hand). 2. God (father) and the earth (mother). 3. An evil garment (*lbūšā bīšā*).

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE PRONOMINAL SUFFIXES (ATTACH TO NOUNS AND PREPOSITIONS)

SUFFIX	MEANING	EXAMPLE (BAYT- HOUSE)	EXAMPLE (L- TO)
-y	my	baytī (my house)	lī (to me)
-k	your (m)	baytāk (your house)	lāk (to you)
-ky	your (f)	baytēky (your house)	lēky (to you)
-eh	his	bayteh (his house)	lēh (to him)
-āh	her	baytāh (her house)	lāh (to her)
-an	our	baytan (our house)	lān (to us)
-kūn	your (pl)	baytkūn (your house)	lkūn (to you all)
-hūn	their (pl)	baythūn (their house)	lhūn (to them)

SAYING “TO HAVE” (Possession Formula)

FORMULA	SYRIAC	MEANING
ĪT + L- + Suffix	īt lī / itly	I have (There is to me)
LAYT + L- + Suffix	layt lēh	He does not have
ĪT + L- + Suffix	īt lhūn malkā	They have a king

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson’s vocabulary to 30 terms.

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܩܪܝܬܐ	qrītā	f. noun	village	emphatic state
ܠܫܢܐ	leššānā	m. noun	tongue, language	
ܥܡܐ	garmā	m. noun	bone	
ܟܦܐ	kēpā	f. noun	stone, rock	
ܡܝܐ	mayyā	m. noun (pl.)	water	plural in form
ܢܘܢܐ	nūnā	m. noun	fish	
ܡܕܝܬܐ	mdittā	f. noun	city	
ܫܡܫܐ	šemšā	m. noun	sun	
ܬܪܐ	tar ‘ ā	m. noun	door, gate	
ܡܫܗܐ	mešhā	m. noun	oil	
ܗܝܠܐ	ḥaylā	m. noun	power, army	
ܥܕܢܐ	’ednā	f. noun	ear	
ܩܝܣܐ	qaysā	m. noun	wood, tree	
ܢܗܪܐ	nahrā	m. noun	river	
ܫܒܪܐ	sabrā	m. noun	hope	
ܕܗܠܬܐ	dehltā	f. noun	fear, religion	abstract noun
ܫܗܪܐ	sahrā	m. noun	moon	
ܪܓܠܐ	reglā	f. noun	foot	
ܫܠܡܐ	šlāmā	m. noun	peace	common greeting
ܐܬܪܐ	’atrā	m. noun	place, country	
ܫܗܕܐ	sāhdā	m. noun	witness, martyr	
ܒܫܪܐ	besrā	m. noun	flesh	
ܬܝܒܘܬܐ	ṭaybūttā	f. noun	grace	
ܬܐܘܪܐ	tawrā	m. noun	bull, ox	
ܩܝܡܐ	qyāmā	m. noun	covenant	
ܐܘܪܗܐ	’ūrḥā	f. noun	way, road	
ܗܝܟܠܐ	hayklā	m. noun	temple, palace	
ܥܝܢܐ	‘aynā	f. noun	eye	

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܡܘܬܐ	pūmā	m. noun	mouth	
ܕܝܢܐ	dīnā	m. noun	judgment	
ܟܬܦܐ	sputā	f. noun	lip	emphatic state
ܬܠܓܓܐ	talggā	m. noun	ridge, back	
ܫܝܪܐ	ṣirē	f. noun	side, rib	
ܓܢܒܐ	ganbā	m. noun	thigh	
ܕܪܥܐ	dar ‘ ā	f. noun	arm	
ܥܓܓܐܠܐ	‘aggālā	m. noun	calf (leg part)	
ܚܬܢܐ	ḥatnā	m. noun	bridegroom	
ܟܠܬܐ	kaltā	f. noun	bride	
ܥܡܡܪܐ	‘ammūrā	m. noun	uncle (paternal)	
ܥܡܬܐ	‘ammtā	f. noun	aunt (paternal)	
ܥܡܡܩܐ	‘ammqā	m. adj	deep	
ܦܠܬܐ	paltā	m. noun	escape, safety	
ܐܬܬܝܪܐ	‘attīrā	m. adj	rich, mighty	
ܡܫܟܢܐ	meskenā	m. adj	poor, humble	
ܓܝܒܒܐܪܐ	gibbōrā	m. adj	mighty, strong	
ܩܠܝܠܐ	qlillā	m. adj	small, few	
ܝܚܝܕܐ	yḥīddā	m. adj	alone, unique	
ܥܕܠܐ	‘addālā	m. adj	just, righteous	

LESSON 5

The Aphel Stem: Divine Action & Causative Verbs

ܐܦܗܠ

ʾAPHEL

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 1–4

Quick Summary

Before diving into the Aphel stem, let's review the foundational material from the first four lessons:

- Lesson 1: The Syriac alphabet (Estrangela), vowel pointing (*seyame*, *rukkakha*), and syllable structure. The triconsonantal root system as the backbone of all Semitic vocabulary.
- Lesson 2: The Peal stem — the basic (ground) stem, equivalent to Hebrew Qal, Arabic Form I. The perfect (suffix conjugation) and imperfect (prefix conjugation) of the root ܟܬܒ (*k-t-b*, 'write').
- Lesson 3: The Syriac noun system — absolute, emphatic, and construct states. Gender (masculine/feminine), number (singular/plural). The emphatic state as the ordinary determinate form (like the Arabic definite article).
- Lesson 4: The Peal participle (active and passive), prepositions and their pronominal suffixes, and basic clause structure including the Syriac verbless clause for equational statements.

5-Question Warm-Up Drill

Answer these questions using what you've learned. Answers are in Section 9.

1. ܕܠܐ — Give the 3rd m.sg. Peal perfect and its meaning.
2. What are the three states of the Syriac noun? Give an example of each.
3. Translate: ܐܬܐ ܪܒܐ ܐܬܐ (*hū rabbā hū*)
4. What does the Peal active participle of ܕܠܐ (' -z-l, 'go') look like, m.sg.?
5. Identify the root and stem of the form ܕܠܐܬܐ (*ketbat*)

SECTION 2: THE DERIVED STEMS — OVERVIEW

One of the most powerful features of Semitic languages — shared by Syriac, Hebrew, and Arabic — is the system of **derived verbal stems**. A single three-consonant root can generate multiple verbs with systematically related meanings, simply by modifying the vowel pattern and/or adding prefixes or affixes.

This is very different from Greek or Latin, where related meanings usually require entirely different words. In Syriac, once you know a root, you already know the building blocks of an entire semantic family.

The Three Major Active Stems

Stem Name	Formation Pattern	Basic Meaning Shift	Example
Peal	Basic vowel pattern	Basic action / state	ܕܠܐ — <i>katab</i> , 'he wrote'
Pael	Middle root letter doubled	Intensive / Factitive	ܕܠܐ — <i>qaddaš</i> , 'he sanctified'
Aphel	'a- prefix added	Causative	ܕܠܐ — ' <i>ahyā</i> , 'he caused to live'

Cross-Linguistic Comparison

For those coming from Hebrew or Arabic, these correspondences will look familiar:

Syriac	Peal	Paael	Aphel
Hebrew	Qal	Piel	Hiphil
Arabic	Form I	Form II	Form IV
Function	Basic	Intensive/Factitive	Causative

For learners with a Greek background: Greek uses **voice** (active, middle, passive) and **aspect** to express some of these distinctions, but there is no exact parallel to the Semitic derived stem system. The Greek causative construction (e.g., *πολεῖν + infinitive*) expresses what the Aphel does morphologically. Latin similarly uses circumlocutions (*facere + infinitive*) or prefix verbs for some causative senses.

SECTION 3: THE APHEL STEM

Core Meaning: Causative

The Aphel stem expresses **causative** action — 'to *cause* X to happen' or 'to *make* X do Y.' In theological language, this is the stem of divine action: God *ʾahyī* (gave life), God *ʾaglī* (revealed), God *ʾaqreb* (brought near).

Formation

- **Perfect:** ʾa- prefix + CeCC pattern (same person suffixes as Peal perfect)
- **Participle:** m- prefix + CaCC-eC pattern (cf. Peal participle)

Comparison with Other Languages

- **Hebrew Hiphil:** prefix הִ/הֵ (hi-/he-) added to the root. E.g., *ḥāyāh* (live) → *heḥyāh* (give life); *qārāb* (draw near) → *hiqrīb* (bring near/offer). The structural parallel to Syriac Aphel is very close.
- **Arabic Form IV:** 'a- prefix + CaCaCa → 'aCCaCa. E.g., *ḥaraja* (go out) → ' *aḥraja* (bring out); *qāraba* (approach) → ' *aqraba* (bring near). The Syriac Aphel prefix 'a- is cognate with Arabic Form IV.
- **Greek/Latin:** No direct morphological equivalent. Greek uses prefix verbs (e.g., ζῶποιεῖν, 'to give life') or constructions with ποιεῖν + inf. Latin uses *facere* + *infinitive* or prefix verbs.

Aphel Examples: Peal → Aphel

Peal (Syr)	Root	Peal Meaning	Aphel (Syr)	Aphel Translit	Aphel Meaning
ܣܪ	<i>h-y-y</i>	'to live' (Peal)	ܣܪܐ	' <i>aḥyī</i>	'to give life, save'
ܩܪܒ	<i>q-r-b</i>	'to draw near' (Peal)	ܩܪܒܐ	' <i>aqreb</i>	'to bring near, offer'
ܦܩܪ	<i>p-q</i>	'to go out' (Peal)	ܦܦܪܐ	' <i>appiq</i>	'to bring out, produce'
ܢܦܠ	<i>n-p-l</i>	'to fall' (Peal)	ܢܦܠܐ	' <i>appel</i>	'to cause to fall, throw down'

The 'Alap-Lamed-Peh Root ('-l-p) in the Aphel

The root ܠܦܠ ('-l-p) means 'learn' in the Peal stem. In the Aphel, it means 'to teach' — that is, 'to cause someone to learn.' This root will be used for all paradigm tables in Sections 4–5.

SECTION 4: APHEL PERFECT PARADIGM

Root: 'l-p | Stem: Aphel | Meaning: 'to teach'

לפעל Perfect — Full Conjugation

Person	Estrangela	Transliteration	Translation
3 m.sg.	לפעל	'allep	he taught
3 f.sg.	לפעלת	'allpat	she taught
2 m.sg.	לפעלת	'allept	you (m.sg.) taught
2 f.sg.	לפעלתי	'allepti	you (f.sg.) taught
1 c.sg.	לפעלתי	'allpet	I taught
3 m.pl.	לפעלו	'allpū	they (m.) taught
3 f.pl.	לפעלו	'allpī	they (f.) taught
2 m.pl.	לפעלתם	'alleptūn	you (m.pl.) taught
2 f.pl.	לפעלתן	'alleptin	you (f.pl.) taught
1 c.pl.	לפעלנו	'allpen	we taught

Formation Notes:

- **Prefix:** 'a- added before the root (3 m.sg.: 'allep)
- **Root-internal vowel:** e vowel between R2 and R3 in 3 m.sg.
- **Suffixes:** Identical to Peal perfect suffixes (-at, -t, -ti, -et, -ū, -ī, -tūn, -tin, -n)
- **Note on gutturals:** When R1 is Alaph ('), assimilation or lengthening may occur in some forms

Comparison: Hebrew Hiphil Perfect

The Hebrew Hiphil perfect is structurally parallel to the Syriac Aphel perfect, with a causative prefix (הִ- hi-/הֶ- he-) and essentially the same suffix set:

Person	Hebrew (Hiphil)	Transliteration	Translation
3 m.sg.	הֶאֱמִין	he 'ěmīn	he believed (H. Hiphil of ' - m-n)
3 f.sg.	הֶאֱמִינָהּ	he 'ěmīnāh	she believed
1 c.sg.	הֶאֱמַנְתִּי	he 'ěmantī	I believed
3 m.pl.	הֶאֱמִינוּ	he 'ěmīnū	they believed

Comparison: Arabic Form IV Perfect

Arabic Form IV (' aCCaCa) is cognate with the Syriac Aphel. The prefix ' a- and the causative meaning are identical; only the internal vowel pattern differs:

Person	Arabic (Form IV)	Transliteration	Translation
3 m.sg.	أَرْسَلَ	' arsala	he sent (Form IV of r-s-l)
3 f.sg.	أَرْسَلَتْ	' arsalat	she sent
1 c.sg.	أَرْسَلْتُ	' arsaltu	I sent
3 m.pl.	أَرْسَلُوا	' arsalū	they sent

SECTION 5: APHEL PARTICIPLE PARADIGM

Root: ' -l-p | Stem: Aphel | Meaning: 'causing to learn / teaching'

The Aphel active participle expresses ongoing or habitual causative action. It also frequently serves as an adjective. The participle prefix is **m-** (as in all derived stems).

Form	Estrangela	Transliteration	Translation
m.sg. (active)	ܡܠܦ	ma 'lep	teaching (m.sg.)
f.sg. (active)	ܡܠܦܐ	ma 'lpā	teaching (f.sg.)
m.pl. (active)	ܡܠܦܝܢ	ma 'lpīn	teaching (m.pl.)
f.pl. (active)	ܡܠܦܝܢ	ma 'lpān	teaching (f.pl.)

Formation Notes

- **Prefix:** m- added before the root (same prefix as Pael and other derived-stem participles)
- **Vowel pattern:** ma ' - + R2 + vowel + R3 (cf. Peal participle kāteb → Aphel ma 'lep)
- **Gender/number suffixes:** Same as all Syriac participles: m.sg. (unmarked), f.sg. (-ā), m.pl. (-īn), f.pl. (-ān)

Comparison with Hebrew and Arabic

Hebrew Hiphil participle: prefix הִ/הֵ (ma-/me-). E.g., *ma 'āmīn* (believing/trusting — from 'm-n Hiphil). The m- participle prefix is pan-Semitic.

Arabic Form IV active participle: pattern muCCiC. E.g., *mursil* (sending/ sender — from 'arsala). Note the Arabic Form IV participle has the vowel shift u-i, while Syriac uses a-e.

KEY PATTERN: In all Syriac derived stems, the participle prefix is m-. This is one of the most consistent features of Syriac verbal morphology. If you see a verb beginning with m- that is not a Peal form, suspect a derived-stem participle.

SECTION 6: THEOLOGICAL VOCABULARY

Abstract Nouns and Key Theological Terms

The following twenty terms form the core theological vocabulary of early Syriac Christianity. Many are abstract nouns derived from the same roots as the verbs you are learning.

Estrangela	Transliteration	Meaning	Notes
ܠܝܚܝܬ / ܠܝܚܝܬܐ	ḥayye / purqānā	salvation / life	Two overlapping terms; ḥayye (life/lives, pl.) often = 'eternal life'; purqānā = 'redemption'
ܠܝܠܝܐ	glāyā	revelation, disclosure	From Aphel 'aglī; cf. Gk apokalypsis, Lat revelatio
ܠܝܠܝܐ	šedārā	sending, mission	From šadar; cf. Heb shāliah (envoy), Gk apostolos
ܠܝܠܝܐ	brīttā	creation	From Peal brā; cf. Heb bārā ', Gen 1:1
ܠܝܠܝܐ	raḥmē	mercy, compassion	Pl. of raḥmā; cognate with Heb raḥmīm, Arabic raḥma
ܠܝܠܝܐ	dīnā	judgment	Cf. Heb dīn (legal judgment), Arabic dīn (religion/ judgment)
ܠܝܠܝܐ	šūbhā	glory, praise	Cf. Heb kābōd; used in doxologies
ܠܝܠܝܐ	ṭaybūtā	grace, goodness	Abstract noun from ṭāb (good); cf. Gk charis, Latin gratia
ܠܝܠܝܐ	haymānūtā	faith, trust	Abstract noun from hayman; cf. Heb 'ēmūnāh
ܠܝܠܝܐ	kēnūtā	righteousness, justice	Cf. Gk dikaiosynē, Heb šēdāqāh
ܠܝܠܝܐ	ḥṭītā	sin, transgression	Cf. Gk hamartia, Heb ḥeṭ
ܠܝܠܝܐ	ma' mūdītā	baptism	Lit. 'immersion'; from ' -m-d; cf. Gk baptisma
ܠܝܠܝܐ	šlūtā	prayer	From ṣ-l-y; cf. Heb tefillah
ܠܝܠܝܐ	'ūlpānā	teaching, instruction	Abstract noun from Aphel 'allep
ܠܝܠܝܐ	nebūtā	prophecy	From n-b-y; cf. Heb nēbū 'āh, Gk prophēteia

ܩܝܡܐ	qyāmā	covenant, resurrection	Double meaning: covenant (cf. Heb bērit) and resurrection
ܟܬܒܐ	ktābā	scripture, writing	From k-t-b; cf. Arabic kitāb, Hebrew kētābīm
ܒܪܟܬܐ	būrktā	blessing	From b-r-k; cf. Heb bērākāh, Arabic baraka
ܪܘܚܐ	rūḥā	spirit, wind, breath	f. noun; cf. Heb rūaḥ, Arabic rūḥ, Gk pneuma
ܫܪܐ	šrārā	truth, reality	Cf. Heb 'ēmet, Gk alētheia; šrār = 'to be firm/true'

Key Aphel Verbs in Theological Context

Estrangela	Translit	Stem	Meaning	Usage Note
ܐܚܝܝ	'aḥyī	Aphel	to save, give life	Causative of ḥ-y-y (live); divine act par excellence
ܐܓܠܝ	'aglī	Aphel	to reveal, uncover	Causative of g-l-y (be revealed); cf. Heb gillāh
ܫܕܪ	šadar	Peal/Aphel	to send	Common verb; šadar/ 'ešdar; cf. Heb šālah
ܒܪܐ	brā	Peal	to create	Note: in Syriac this is Peal (not Aphel); cf. Heb bārā
ܐܟܪܐܝܝܐ	'kraz	Aphel	to proclaim, preach	From k-r-z; kerygmatic vocabulary
ܐܪܝܡ	'rīm	Aphel	to exalt, lift up	Causative of r-m (be high); cf. Heb hērīm
ܐܫܦܠ	'špel	Aphel	to humble, lower	Causative of š-p-l (be low); antonym of 'rīm
ܐܦܪܩܝܡ	'praq	Aphel	to redeem, deliver	Causative of p-r-q (be freed); cf. purqānā above
ܩܕܕܫܐ	qaddaš	Paael	to sanctify, make holy	Preview of Paael; from q- d-š (be holy); cf. Heb qiddēš
ܐܩܪܒ	'aqreb	Aphel	to bring near, offer	Causative of q-r-b (draw near); cf. Arabic qurraba

SECTION 7: THE STORY — PART 5

Yukhannan Preaches to the Crowds

Narrative note: This passage features heavy use of the Aphel stem to describe God's causative actions in history. Notice the verbless clauses used for theological assertions (sentences 6 and 9). Aphel forms are highlighted in the transliteration.

Key Aphel forms in this passage: 'kraz (proclaimed), 'allep (taught), 'ahyī (gave life/saved), 'aglī (revealed), 'aqrebtūn (brought near), 'appaqnī (brought me out), 'ahyat (gave life), 'aqrebtnī (brought me near)

Sentence 1

וַיִּקְרָא יוֹחָנָן בֶּן־זִכְיָא בְּתוֹכָם וַיִּתֵּן לָהֶם חַיִּים

w-Yukhannan qam b-meṣ ' at ' ammā w- 'kraz 'ennūn

w- (and-) Yukhannan (John) qam (rose/stood) b-meṣ ' at (in-the-midst-of) ' ammā (the-people) w- 'kraz (and-proclaimed) 'ennūn (them)

→ *And Yukhannan stood in the midst of the people and proclaimed to them:*

Sentence 2

וַיִּתֵּן לָהֶם חַיִּים וַיִּתֵּן לָהֶם חַיִּים

Māryā šadar lī d- 'allep yātḵūn 'ūrḥā d-ḥayye

Māryā (the-Lord) šadar (sent) lī (to-me) d- 'allep (that-I-should-teach) yātḵūn (you(pl.)) 'ūrḥā (the-way) d-ḥayye (of-life)

→ *'The Lord has sent me to teach you the way of life.'*

Sentence 3

וַיִּתֵּן לָהֶם חַיִּים וַיִּתֵּן לָהֶם חַיִּים

Alāhā d-brā kull medem 'ahyī lḵūn b-purqāneh

Alāhā (God) d-brā (who-created) kull (all) medem (thing) 'ahyī (caused-to-live/saved) lḵūn (you(pl.)) b-purqāneh (by-his-redemption)

→ 'God, who created all things, has saved you through his redemption.'

Sentence 4

ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ

Hū 'aglī lān rāzā d-ṭaybūtteh

Hū (He) 'aglī (revealed) lān (to-us) rāzā (the-mystery) d-ṭaybūtteh (of-his-grace)

→ 'He has revealed to us the mystery of his grace.'

Sentence 5

ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ

w-hāšā 'aqrebtūn l-Alāhā b-haymānūttā

w- (and-) hāšā (now) 'aqrebtūn (you(pl.)-have-been-brought-near) l-Alāhā (to-God) b-haymānūttā (by-faith)

→ 'And now you have been brought near to God through faith.'

Sentence 6

ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ

Hannū šrārā d-malkūttā d-Alāhā

Hannū (This-is) šrārā (the-truth) d-malkūttā (of-the-kingdom) d-Alāhā (of-God)

→ 'This is the truth of the kingdom of God.'

Sentence 7

ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ

w- 'ammā šma ' mellāw-hy w- 'etdammer ṭāb

w- (and-) 'ammā (the-people) šma ' (heard) mellāw-hy (his-words) w-
'etdammer (and-marveled) ṭāb (greatly/well)

→ *And the people heard his words and marveled greatly.*

Sentence 8

אמרו גברא דה אנא אנטו אנטו אנטו

w- 'emar gabrā ḥad men 'ammā: man 'ant w-man šedrāk?

w- 'emar (and-said) gabrā (a-man) ḥad (one) men (from) 'ammā (the-
people) man (who) 'ant (are-you) w-man (and-who) šedrāk (sent-you)

→ *And a man from the people said: 'Who are you, and who sent you?'*

Sentence 9

חנא נאשק אמרו אנא חבדמ דמרו

'nā Yukhannan w- 'emar: 'enā 'abdeh d-Māryā

'nā (answered) Yukhannan (Yukhannan) w- 'emar (and-said) 'enā (I)
'abdeh (servant-of) d-Māryā (the-Lord)

→ *Yukhannan answered and said: 'I am the servant of the Lord.'*

Sentence 10

חנא אפמך מן מדבאר דאל לחמ

Hū 'appaqnī men madbārā d- 'allep l- 'ammeh

Hū (He) 'appaqnī (brought-me-out) men (from) madbārā (the-
wilderness) d- 'allep (to-teach) l- (to) 'ammeh (his-people)

→ 'He brought me out from the wilderness to teach his people.'

Sentence 11

וְרוּחַ אֱלֹהִים הָיָה וְאַתָּה לִי וְאַתָּה לְמַלְכוּתְךָ

w-rūḥā d-Alāhā hī d- 'aḥyat lī w- 'aqrebtī l-malkūtteh

w- (and-) rūḥā (the-Spirit) d-Alāhā (of-God) hī (she/it-is) d- 'aḥyat (who-gave-life) lī (to-me) w- 'aqrebtī (and-brought-me-near) l-malkūtteh (to-his-kingdom)

→ 'And it is the Spirit of God who gave me life and brought me near to his kingdom.'

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Stem Identification

Identify each verb form as Peal or Aphel, give its person/number/gender, root, and English meaning.

#	Estrangela	Transliteration
1	אלפ	'allep
2	כתב	katab
3	אחי	'aḥyī
4	אזל	'azal
5	אקרב	'aqreb
6	מאלפ	ma 'lep
7	שמע	šma'
8	אפיק	'appiq
9	כתב	kāteb
10	אגל	'aglī

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

Fully conjugate the following two Aphel verbs in the perfect (all 10 persons) and the participle (all 4 forms). Use the paradigm in Sections 4–5 as a model.

1. Root š-d-r (*send*) — Aphel: 'ešdar
2. Root r-m (*be high*) — Aphel: 'rīm (*exalt*)

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English)

Translate the following sentences into English. All contain Aphel forms.

1. ܐܠܗܐ ܐܗܝܠ ܐܡܡܗ (Alāhā 'ahyī l-'ammeh)
2. ܝܘܚܢܢܐܢ ܐܠܦ ܠܬܡܝܕܐܘܗܝ (Yukhannan 'allep l-talmīdāw-hy)
3. ܗܘ ܐܦܦܝܩ ܠܗܘܢ ܡܢ ܒܝܬ ܐܫܘܪܐ (Hū 'appiq lhūn men bēt 'esūrā)
4. ܪܗܒܐ ܐܒܠܝ ܫܪܐܪܐ (Rūhā 'aglī šrārā)
5. ܡܪܝܝܐ ܐܩܪܒܢܢ ܠܡܠܟܘܬܗ (Māryā 'aqrebnān l-malkūtteh)
6. ܡܐ ܠܦ ܐܢܐ ܠܟܘܢ ܐܘܪܗܐ (Ma 'lep 'enā lkūn 'ūrḥā)
7. ܐܢܬ ܪܝܡܬ ܠܐܒܕܐܟ (Ant 'rīmt l-'abdāk)
8. ܗܢܢܘ ܐܘܠܦܢܐ ܕܡܠܟܘܬܐ (Hannū 'ūlpānā d-malkūtā)

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac Aphel)

Render the following causative sentences into Syriac using the Aphel stem. More than one correct answer may exist.

1. God revealed his glory to the people.
2. She taught the children the law.
3. The Spirit brought him out of the wilderness.

4. You (m.pl.) have brought near the offering.
5. The prophet gave life to the dead (mītē).
6. The Lord exalted the humble (makīkē).

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read the story in Section 7, then answer the following comprehension questions in complete Syriac sentences if possible, or in English.

1. What did Yukhannan say the Lord sent him to do?
2. What three actions does Yukhannan attribute to God in his speech?
(Name the Aphel verbs.)
3. What question does the man from the crowd ask?
4. How does Yukhannan identify himself?
5. What brought Yukhannan out of the wilderness and brought him near the kingdom?

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

SECTION 1 WARM-UP

Q1: Peal perfect 3 m.sg. of k-t-b: ܟܬܒ (katab) = 'he wrote'

Q2: Absolute: ܡܠܟ (malk, 'king'); Emphatic: ܡܠܟܐ (malkā, 'the king');

Construct: ܡܠܟ (malk + genitive, 'king of...')

Q3: 'He is great' — verbless clause with pronoun as copula

Q4:

Q5: Root: k-t-b; Stem: Peal; Form: perfect 2 m.sg. or 1 c.sg. — 'you wrote' or 'I wrote'

Exercise 1: Identification

#	Stem	Person	Root	Meaning
1	Aphel	3 m.sg.	'-l-p	he taught
2	Peal	3 m.sg.	k-t-b	he wrote
3	Aphel	3 m.sg.	ḥ-y-y	he gave life
4	Peal	3 m.sg.	'-z-l	he went
5	Aphel	3 m.sg.	q-r-b	he brought near
6	Aphel Ptcp	m.sg.	'-l-p	teaching
7	Peal	3 m.sg.	š-m-ʿ	he heard
8	Aphel	3 m.sg.	p-q	he brought out
9	Peal Ptcp	m.sg.	k-t-b	writing/writer
10	Aphel	3 m.sg.	g-l-y	he revealed

Exercise 3: Translation

#	Translation
1	God saved his people.
2	Yukhannan taught his disciples.
3	He brought them out of prison.
4	The Spirit revealed the truth.
5	The Lord brought us near to his kingdom.
6	I am teaching you the way.
7	You (m.sg.) have exalted your servant.
8	This is the teaching of the kingdom.

Exercise 4: Production (sample answers)

1. *Alāhā 'aglī šūbhēh l- 'ammā*

2. *'allepat l-yalūdē nāmūsā*

3. *Rūḥā 'appaqēh men madbārā*

4. *'aqrebtūn qūrbānā*

5. *Nebīyā 'aḥyī l-mītē*

6. *Māryā 'rīm l-makīkē*

Exercise 5: Comprehension

#	Answer
1	To teach them the way of life ('ūrḥā d-ḥayye).
2	'aḥyī (saved/gave life), 'aglī (revealed), 'aqrebtūn (brought near).
3	'Who are you, and who sent you?'
4	As the servant ('abdeh) of the Lord.
5	The Spirit of God (Rūḥā d-Alāhā).

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE APHEL STEM — FORMATION RULES

Feature	Rule	Example
Perfect prefix	'a- (Ayin-Alaph) before root	'a + R1 + e + R2 + suffix
Perfect 3 m.sg.	'a + R1R2eR3 (no suffix)	'allep, 'aḥyī, 'aqreb
Suffix set	Same as Peal perfect	-at, -t, -ti, -et, -ū, -ī, -tūn, -tin, -n
Participle prefix	m- before root	m + ' + R2 + e + R3
Participle 3 m.sg.	ma' + R2eR3	ma'lep
Participle suffixes	Same as all participles	-ā (f.sg.), -īn (m.pl.), -ān (f.pl.)
Core meaning	Causative	'to cause X to happen' / 'to make X do Y'

Meaning Pattern

PEAL (basic) + 'a- prefix = APHEL (causative) 'to X' → 'to cause to X' / 'to make X happen' *ḥ-y-y: live* → 'aḥyī: give life/save | *q-r-b: draw near* → 'aqreb: bring near | *p-q: go out* → 'appiq: bring out

Comparative Summary: Three Stems

Stem	Meaning	Perfect 3 m.sg.	Participle m.sg.	Translation
Peal	Basic	katab	kāteb	'he wrote' / 'writing'
Paael	Intensive/Factitive	qaddaš	mqaḍdeš	'he sanctified' / 'sanctifying'
Aphel	Causative	' allep	ma 'lep	'he taught' / 'teaching'

Remember: In all three derived stems (Paael, Aphel, Ethpaael, etc.), the active participle always takes a m- prefix. This is your clearest signal that you are reading a derived-stem participle.

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 30 terms.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
ܩܪܝܬܐ	qritā	f	village
ܠܫܢܐ	leššānā	m	tongue, language
ܥܡܝܩܐ	garmā	m	bone
ܟܦܪܐ	kēpā	f	stone, rock
ܡܝܝܐ	mayyā	m.pl	water
ܢܘܢܐ	nūnā	m	fish
ܡܕܝܬܐ	mdittā	f	city
ܫܡܫܐ	šemšā	m	sun
ܕܠܝܬܐ	tar ‘ ā	m	door, gate
ܡܝܫܗܐ	mešhā	m	oil
ܫܠܐ	ḥaylā	m	power, army
ܐܕܢܐ	’ednā	f	ear
ܩܝܣܐ	qaysā	m	wood, tree
ܢܗܪܐ	nahrā	m	river
ܫܒܪܐ	sabrā	m	hope
ܕܗܠܬܐ	deḥltā	f	fear, religion
ܫܗܪܐ	sahrā	m	moon
ܪܓܠܐ	reglā	f	foot
ܫܠܡܐ	šlāmā	m	peace
ܐܬܪܐ	’atrā	m	place, country
ܫܗܕܐ	sāhdā	m	witness, martyr
ܒܫܪܐ	besrā	m	flesh
ܬܝܒܘܬܐ	ṭaybūtā	f	grace
ܬܐܪܐ	tawrā	m	bull, ox
ܐܘܪܗܐ	’ūrḥā	f	way, road
ܬܠܝܬܐ	hayklā	m	temple, palace
ܥܝܢܐ	‘aynā	f	eye
ܦܡܐ	pūmā	m	mouth
ܐܗܝܐ	’aḥyā	m	give life
ܐܓܠܐ	’aglā	m	reveal

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
ܐܠܒܫ	'albāš	m	clothe
ܐܦܩܕ	'apqad	m	entrust
ܐܪܡܝ	'armī	m	lift up
ܐܫܕܪ	'ašdar	m	send
ܐܠܦܐ	'alpā	m	teach
ܐܓܠܘܬܐ	aglūtā	f	revelation
ܐܫܕܘܬܐ	asdūtā	f	sending
ܐܫܠܘܬܐ	a' lūtā	f	ascent
ܐܠܦܘܬܐ	alpūtā	f	teaching
ܐܫܡܐ	'astmā	m	hide
ܐܠܒܫܐ	albūšā	m	clothing
ܐܩܪܒ	'aqrab	m	bring near
ܐܩܘܡ	'aqūm	m	raise, stand

LESSON 6

The Paael Stem: Intensive, Factitive, and Formal Religious Action

ܐܠܥܠ

PĀ'EL

Worship and religious vocabulary · Conflict with established religion

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 1–5

Cumulative Review

Lesson 6 builds directly on Lesson 5. You should now be comfortable with the Aphel stem (causative). This lesson introduces its close sibling: the Paael, the intensive/factitive stem.

- **Lesson 5 review:** The Aphel stem: 'a- prefix, causative meaning ('to cause X'). Perfect paradigm ('allep), participle (ma'lep). Comparison with Hebrew Hiphil and Arabic Form IV.
- **Lessons 1–4 recap:** Estrangela alphabet; Peal perfect and imperfect; Syriac noun states; Peal participle; basic clause structure.

5-Question Warm-Up Drill

Answer these questions before proceeding. Answers in Section 8.

1. Give the Aphel perfect 3 m.sg. of the root q-r-b (draw near) and translate it.
2. ܐܠܥܠ — what form is this? What is its root and stem?
3. Translate: ܪܘܗܐ ܐܓܠܝ ܫܪܐܪܐ (Rūḥā 'aglī šrārā)

4. What is the Hebrew Hiphil equivalent of the Syriac Aphel? Give one example.
5. Give the Aphel participle (all four forms) of root 'l-p (teach).

SECTION 2: THE PAAEL STEM

Core Meaning: Intensive and Factitive

The Paael stem (also spelled Pael or Pā'el) expresses two related types of intensified meaning:

- **Intensive:** Repeated, thoroughgoing, or heightened action. 'He wrote' (Peal) → 'he wrote carefully/copied out' (Paael).
- **Factitive:** Causing someone or something to enter into a state. 'Be holy' (Peal) → 'make holy/sanctify' (Paael). The Paael turns intransitive verbs into transitive ones.

Formation: Gemination of the Middle Root Letter

The defining feature of the Paael is the **doubling (gemination) of the middle root consonant (R2)**. This is written with a *dageš*-like diacritic in pointing, or simply by writing the letter twice in some scripts.

- **Perfect:** CaR₁R₂R₂eR₃ pattern — e.g., barrek (from b-r-k), qaddaš (from q-d-š), yallep (from y-l-p)
- **Participle:** mCaR₁R₂R₂eR₃ pattern (m- prefix) — e.g., mbarrek, mqaddeš, myallep

Cross-Linguistic Comparison

- **Hebrew Piel:** The direct cognate of the Syriac Paael. Also formed by doubling R2. Compare: *kipper* (Piel, 'atone/cover' — from k-p-r), *bērak* (Piel, 'bless' — from b-r-k), *qiddēš* (Piel, 'sanctify'). The structural identity is near-perfect.

- **Arabic Form II:** Formed by doubling R2 (qaddama, 'to present/offer'; 'allama, 'to teach/instruct'; qaddasa, 'to sanctify'). Arabic Form II corresponds precisely to Syriac Paael in both form and function.
- **Greek:** No direct morphological equivalent. Intensives expressed via prefix verbs (e.g., *κατα-* compounds), aspect (perfect), or adverbs. Latin uses intensifying prefixes or separate lexical items.

Paael Examples: Peal → Paael

Peal (Syr)	Root	Peal Meaning	Paael (Syr)	Paael Translit	Paael Meaning
ܒܪܟ	b-r-k	'kneel, bless (Peal)'	ܒܪܟ	barrek	'bless/pronounce blessing'
ܩܕܫ	q-d-š	'be holy (Peal)'	ܩܕܫ	qaddaš	'sanctify/make holy'
ܠܡܕ	y-l-p	'learn (Peal)'	ܠܡܕ	yallep	'teach (make learned)'
ܫܡܫ	š-m-š	'serve (Peal)'	ܫܡܫ	šammeš	'minister/serve formally'
ܕܠܟ	k-n-š	'gather (Peal)'	ܕܠܟ	kanneš	'assemble/collect'

KEY INSIGHT: When the Paael is applied to an INTRANSITIVE verb (e.g., 'be holy'), it makes the action TRANSITIVE and FACTITIVE: 'make X holy / sanctify.' This is called the factitive use, and it is the Paael's most theologically important function. Compare Hebrew Piel kipper ('atone'), qiddēš ('sanctify'), bērak ('bless').

Comparison of the Three Major Stems

Syriac	Peal (basic)	Paael (intensive/factitive)	Aphel (causative)
q-d-š	qadaš ('be holy')	qaddaš ('sanctify/make holy')	—
b-r-k	berak ('kneel')	barrek ('bless intensively')	—
k-t-b	katab ('write')	katteb ('write carefully/copy')	'akkeb ('dictate/cause to write')
y-l-p	yalep ('learn')	yallep ('teach — make learned')	'allep ('cause to learn')
š-m-š	šemaš ('serve')	šammeš ('minister formally')	—

SECTION 3: PAAEL PERFECT PARADIGM

Root: b-r-k | Stem: Paael | Meaning: 'to bless'

ܒܪܟܐ Perfect — Full Conjugation (Root b-r-k)

Person	Estrangela	Transliteration	Translation
3 m.sg.	ܒܪܟ	<i>barrek</i>	he blessed
3 f.sg.	ܒܪܟܐ	<i>barrekat</i>	she blessed
2 m.sg.	ܒܪܟܝ	<i>barrekt</i>	you (m.sg.) blessed
2 f.sg.	ܒܪܟܝܐ	<i>barrekti</i>	you (f.sg.) blessed
1 c.sg.	ܒܪܟܝܬ	<i>barrekit</i>	I blessed
3 m.pl.	ܒܪܚܐ	<i>barrekū</i>	they (m.) blessed
3 f.pl.	ܒܪܚܐ	<i>barrekī</i>	they (f.) blessed
2 m.pl.	ܒܪܚܝܬܐ	<i>barrekitūn</i>	you (m.pl.) blessed
2 f.pl.	ܒܪܚܝܬܝܐ	<i>barrekitin</i>	you (f.pl.) blessed
1 c.pl.	ܒܪܚܝܬܝܢ	<i>barrekin</i>	we blessed

Formation Notes

- **Root: b-r-k.** In the Paael, R2 (resh, r) is geminated: b-rr-k → barrek

- **Perfect vowel pattern:** a under R1, doubled R2, e vowel between R2 and R3 (same as Peal CeCC but with geminate R2)
- **Suffix set:** Essentially identical to Peal and Aphel perfect suffixes
- **Guttural roots:** When R2 is a guttural (Ayin, Het, He, Alaph), gemination may be 'virtual' — compensatory lengthening of the preceding vowel occurs instead

Comparison: Hebrew Piel Perfect

The Hebrew Piel perfect is structurally near-identical to the Syriac Pael perfect. Compare:

Person	Hebrew (Piel)	Transliteration	Translation
3 m.sg.	בִּרְךָ	bērāk	he blessed (Piel b-r-k)
3 f.sg.	בִּרְכָהּ	bērēkāh	she blessed
1 c.sg.	בִּרְכֵּתִי	bēraktī	I blessed
3 m.pl.	בִּרְכוּ	bērēkū	they blessed

SECTION 4: PAEL PARTICIPLE PARADIGM

Root: b-r-k | Stem: Pael | Meaning: 'one who blesses'

The Pael active participle takes the same m- prefix as all derived-stem participles. The gemination of R2 is preserved throughout.

Form	Estrangela	Transliteration	Translation
m.sg.	ܡܒܪܟܐ	<i>mbarrek</i>	blessing (m.sg.)
f.sg.	ܡܒܪܟܬܐ	<i>mbarrkā</i>	blessing (f.sg.)
m.pl.	ܡܒܪܟܝܢ	<i>mbarrkīn</i>	blessing (m.pl.)
f.pl.	ܡܒܪܟܝܢ	<i>mbarrkān</i>	blessing (f.pl.)

Formation Notes

- **Prefix:** m- (identical to Aphel participle prefix)

- **Vowel pattern:** m + a + R1R2R2 + e + R3 (preserves gemination of R2)
- **Suffixes:** Standard participle endings: m.sg. (unmarked), f.sg. (-ā), m.pl. (-īn), f.pl. (-ān)

Comparison with Hebrew and Arabic

Hebrew Piel participle: prefix מְ (mě-) + doubled R2. E.g., *měbārēk* (blessing, from b-r-k Piel), *měqaddēš* (sanctifying, from q-d-š Piel). Structurally identical to Syriac Paael participle.

Arabic Form II active participle: pattern muCaCCiC (mu + R1 + a + R2R2 + i + R3). E.g., *mu‘allim* (teacher, from ‘-l-m Form II), *muqaddis* (sanctifier, from q-d-s Form II). The m- prefix and gemination are pan-Semitic features.

SECTION 5: WORSHIP AND RELIGIOUS VOCABULARY

Paael Verbs for Worship and Ministry

Estrangela	Translit	Stem	Meaning	Notes
ܒܪܟܐ	barrek	Paael b-r-k	bless, pronounce blessing	Cf. Heb Piel bērak; Arabic bāraka
ܠܐܬܐ	laṭ	Peal l-ṭ	curse	Antonym of barrek; cf. Heb qillēl
ܫܠܝܬܐ	šallī	Paael š-l-y	pray, intercede	Cf. Heb hitpallēl; Arabic šallā
ܫܓܕܐ	sgad	Peal s-g-d	bow down, worship	Cf. Arabic sajada; Heb hištaḥawāh
ܫܡܡܝܫܐ	šammeš	Paael š-m- š	minister, serve formally	Liturgical service; cf. Hebrew šimmeš
ܝܠܠܥܐ	yallep	Paael y-l-p	teach, instruct	Factitive of 'learn'; cf. Arabic ‘allama
ܩܕܕܝܫܐ	qaddaš	Paael q-d- š	sanctify, make holy	Cf. Heb Piel qiddēš; Arabic qaddasa
ܫܒܚܐ	šabbeḥ	Paael š-b- ḥ	praise, glorify	Cf. Syriac šūbhā (glory); doxological use
ܩܒܠܐ	qabbel	Paael q-b-l	receive, accept (ritual)	Cf. Arabic qabila; used for receiving sacraments
ܡܠܠܐ	mallel	Paael m-l-l	speak, converse, preach	Intensive of speech; cf. Heb millēl
ܕܩܝܐ	dakkī	Paael d-k- y	purify, cleanse	Factitive of 'be pure'; cf. Heb Piel zikkāh
ܡܫܚܐ	mašeḥ	Paael m-š- ḥ	anoint, smear with oil	Root of mēšīḥā (Messiah/Christ); cf. Heb māšaḥ
ܫܡܥܐ	šam	Peal š-w- m	fast, abstain	Cf. Heb šûm; Arabic šāma
ܚܓܓܐ	ḥagag	Peal ḥ-g-g	feast, celebrate	Cf. Heb ḥāgag; Arabic ḥajja

Nouns for Temple, Worship, and Religious Community

Estrangela	Translit	Meaning	Notes
ܡܕܒܚܐ	madbhā	altar	From d-b-ḥ (slaughter/sacrifice); cf. Heb mizbēaḥ
ܟܗܢܐ	kāhnā	priest	Cf. Heb kōhēn; Arabic kāhin
ܚܝܟܠܐ	hayklā	temple, sanctuary	Cf. Heb hēḵāl (from Akkadian ēkallu); Gk naos
ܚܝܬܐ	knūštā	synagogue, assembly	From k-n-š (gather); cf. Heb kēneset
ܩܘܪܒܐܢܐ	qūrbānā	offering, sacrifice	From q-r-b (draw near/offer); cf. Heb qorbān (Mark 7:11)
ܒܫܡܐ	besmā	incense, spice	Cf. Heb bōšēn; Arabic balsam
ܡܝܐ	mayyā	water	Pl. form standard; cf. Heb mayim, Arabic mā
ܡܫܗܐ	mešhā	oil, ointment	From m-š-ḥ (anoint); root of Messiah
ܠܚܡܐ	laḥmā	bread, food	Cf. Heb leḥem (Bethlehem = bēt leḥem); Arabic laḥm
ܕܡܐ	kāsā	cup	Cf. Heb kôs; Gk potērion
ܢܡܘܣܐ	nāmūsā	law, Torah	From Gk nomos via Aramaic
ܫܠܬܐ	šlūttā	prayer	Abstract noun from š-l-y (Pael)
ܚܝܬܐ	knūštā	assembly, congregation	Also used for synagogue (same word)
ܩܘܕܢܐ	pūqdānā	commandment, decree	From p-q-d (command); cf. Heb piqqūd
ܢܡܘܣܐ	nāmūsā	law, rule	Dual use: Torah and general law

SECTION 6: THE STORY — PART 6

Yukhannan Blesses the People and Angers the Priests

Narrative note: This passage is rich in Paael forms (barrek, ṣallī, šabbēḥ, yallep, qaddaš, šammeš). It also introduces the central conflict of the Acts: Yuhannan's ministry challenges the established religious order. Notice the theological contrast between sacrifice (qūrbānā) and faith (haymānūttā).

Key Paael forms: barrek (blessed), ṣallī (prayed), šabbēḥ (praised), yallep (taught), qaddaš (sanctified), šammeš (minister), šabbēḥ (praised again at end). Note also metqaddeš — the Ethpaael (passive of Paael), previewing Lesson 7.

Sentence 1

ⲙⲓⲛⲁⲛⲁⲛ ⲙⲁⲃⲃⲏⲁ ⲙⲁⲃⲃⲏⲁ ⲙⲁⲃⲃⲏⲁ ⲙⲁⲃⲃⲏⲁ

w-Yukhannan qam ‘al madbḥā w-barrek l-‘ammā

*w- (and-) Yuhannan (John) qam (stood) ‘al (upon) madbḥā (the-altar)
w-barrek (and-blessed) l-‘ammā (the-people)*

→ *And Yuhannan stood at the altar and blessed the people.*

Sentence 2

ⲙⲓⲛⲁⲛⲁⲛ ⲙⲁⲃⲃⲏⲁ ⲙⲁⲃⲃⲏⲁ ⲙⲁⲃⲃⲏⲁ ⲙⲁⲃⲃⲏⲁ

w-ṣallī b-‘ednā rāmā w-šabbēḥ l-Alāhā

w-ṣallī (and-prayed) b-‘ednā (with-voice) rāmā (loud) w-šabbēḥ (and-praised) l-Alāhā (God)

→ *He prayed with a loud voice and praised God.*

Sentence 3

ܠܗܘܢ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ

w-yallep lhūn 'ūrḥā ḥattā d-ṣlūttā

w-yallep (and-taught) lhūn (them) 'ūrḥā (the-way) ḥattā (new) d-ṣlūttā (of-prayer)

→ *He taught them the new way of prayer.*

Sentence 4

ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ

w- 'emar: lā madbhā d-kahnūttā hū d-qaddaš 'enāš

w- 'emar (and-said) lā (not) madbhā (the-altar) d-kahnūttā (of-the-priesthood) hū (it-is) d-qaddaš (that-sanctifies) 'enāš (a-person)

→ *'It is not the altar of the priesthood that sanctifies a person.'*

Sentence 5

ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ

'ellā Māryā hū d-qaddaš lkūn b-rūḥeh

'ellā (but/rather) Māryā (the-Lord) hū (he-is) d-qaddaš (who-sanctifies) lkūn (you(pl.)) b-rūḥeh (by-his-Spirit)

→ *'Rather, it is the Lord who sanctifies you by his Spirit.'*

Sentence 6

ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ

šme 'ū dēn kāhnē mellāw-hy w- 'etragzū 'lāw-hy

Sentence 10

וְרֵגַז רַב כַּהֲנֵי וַיִּצְוֶה דְּנִפְּקֻן לֵהּ מִן הַיְּכָלָא

w-regaz rab kāhnē w-pqad d-nuppqūn leh men hayklā

w-regaz (and-was-enraged) rab (chief) kāhnē (of-priests) w-pqad (and-commanded) d-nuppqūn (that-they-expel) leh (him) men (from) hayklā (the-temple)

→ *And the chief priest was enraged and commanded that they expel him from the temple.*

Sentence 11

וְיֻכְחָנָן דֵּן לֹא דְהֵל אֵלְלָא שְׁאֲבֵיחַ לֵאלֹהִי בְּכֻלְהּ לֵבְבֵהּ

Yukhannan dēn lā dhel 'ellā šabbeḥ l-Alāhā b-kulleh lebbeh

Yukhannan (Yukhannan) dēn (but/however) lā (not) dhel (feared) 'ellā (but) šabbeḥ (praised) l-Alāhā (God) b-kulleh (with-all) lebbeh (his-heart)

→ *But Yukhannan was not afraid; rather he praised God with all his heart.*

SECTION 7: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Stem Identification (Mixed: Peal, Paael, Aphel)

Identify each verb form: state the stem (Peal/Paael/Aphel), person/number/gender, root, and English meaning.

#	Estrangela	Transliteration
1	ܒܪܝܟ	barrek
2	ܟܬܒ	katab
3	ܐܩܪܒ	'aqreb
4	ܫܒܚ	šabbeḥ
5	ܐܗܝܝ	'ahyī
6	ܡܒܪܝܟ	mbarrek
7	ܩܕܕܫ	qaddaš
8	ܡܐܠܦ	ma 'lep
9	ܫܡܡܝܫ	šammeš
10	ܣܓܕ	sgad
11	ܫܠܝ	šallī
12	ܐܠܦ	'allep

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

Fully conjugate the following two Paael verbs in the perfect (10 persons) and the participle (4 forms). Use Sections 3–4 as a model.

1. Root *š-b-ḥ* (praise) — Paael: *šabbeḥ*
2. Root *m-l-l* (speak) — Paael: *mallel*

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English)

Translate the following sentences, all containing Paael verbs.

1. ܝܘܚܢܢ ܒܪܝܟ ܠܐܡܡܐ (*Yukhannan barrek l- 'ammā*)
2. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܫܡܡܝܫ ܒܗܝܟܠܐ (*Kāhnā šammeš b-hayklā*)
3. ܗܝ ܩܕܕܝܫܬ ܠܒܢܝܝܗ (*Hī qaddešat l-bnāy-hy*)

4. ܡܒܪܝܟ ܐܢܐ ܠܐܠܗܐ (*Mbarrek 'enā l-Alāhā*)
5. ܫܒܒܗܘ ܠܡܪܝܐ ܒܠܝܠܝܡ (*Šabbhū l-Māryā b-kull yawm*)
6. ܐܢܬ ܝܠܠܡܬ ܠܢ ܢܡܘܫܐ (*'Ant yallapt lān nāmūsā*)
7. ܕܟܝ ܡܝܝܪܐ ܠܡܢܕܝܬܐ (*Dakkī mayyā l-ma' mūdittā*)
8. ܡܢ ܡܫܐܗ ܒܡܫܗܐ (*Man mšah b-mešhā?*)

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac Pael)

Render these sentences into Syriac using the Pael stem.

1. The prophet blessed the offering.
2. They (m.) praised God with a loud voice.
3. The priest sanctified the assembly.
4. She prayed every day in the temple.
5. He anointed the king with oil.
6. We ministered to the Lord together.

Exercise 5: Peal vs. Pael Comparison

For each root pair below, explain how the Peal and Pael meanings differ, and give one example sentence using each.

Root	Peal Meaning	Pael Meaning
q-d-š	qadaš ('be holy' Peal)	qaddaš ('sanctify/make holy' Pael)
b-r-k	berak ('kneel/bless' Peal)	barrek ('bless solemnly' Pael)
y-l-p	yalep ('learn' Peal)	yallep ('teach, make learned' Pael)
š-m-š	šemaš ('serve' Peal)	šammeš ('minister formally' Pael)
d-k-y	dakī ('be pure' Peal)	dakkī ('purify, cleanse' Pael)

Exercise 6: Reading Comprehension

Re-read the story in Section 6, then answer the following questions.

1. What actions does Yukhannan perform at the altar? (List the Pael verbs.)
2. What does Yukhannan teach about the true source of sanctification?
3. How do the priests react, and why?
4. What authority does the chief priest invoke, and what does Yukhannan claim?
5. What does Yukhannan do after being threatened with expulsion?
What does this tell us about his character?

SECTION 8: ANSWER KEY

SECTION 1 WARM-UP

Q1: Aphel perf. 3 m.sg.: אָקֵרַב ('aqreb) = 'he brought near / offered'

Q2:

Q3: 'The Spirit revealed the truth.'

Q4: Hebrew Hiphil — e.g., hiqrīb (brought near, from q-r-b)

Q5: m.sg.: ma 'lep / f.sg.: ma 'lpā / m.pl.: ma 'lpīn / f.pl.: ma 'lpān

Exercise 1: Identification

#	Stem	Person	Root	Meaning
1	Paael	3 m.sg.	b-r-k	he blessed
2	Peal	3 m.sg.	k-t-b	he wrote
3	Aphel	3 m.sg.	q-r-b	he brought near
4	Paael	3 m.sg.	š-b-ḥ	he praised
5	Aphel	3 m.sg.	ḥ-y-y	he gave life
6	Paael ptcp	m.sg.	b-r-k	blessing
7	Paael	3 m.sg.	q-d-š	he sanctified
8	Aphel ptcp	m.sg.	ʾ-l-p	teaching (causative)
9	Paael	3 m.sg.	š-m-š	he ministered
10	Peal	3 m.sg.	s-g-d	he worshipped
11	Paael	3 m.sg.	ṣ-l-y	he prayed
12	Aphel	3 m.sg.	ʾ-l-p	he taught (causative)

Exercise 3: Translation

#	Translation
1	Yukhannan blessed the people.
2	The priest ministered in the temple.
3	She sanctified her children.
4	I am blessing God.
5	They praised the Lord every day.
6	You (m.sg.) taught us the law.
7	He purified the water for baptism.
8	Who anointed with oil?

Exercise 4: Production (sample answers)

1. *Nebīyā barrek l-qūrbānā*

2. *Šabbḥū l-Alāhā b- ʾednā rāmā*

3. *Kāhnā qaddaš l-knūštā*

4. *ṣalleyyat b-kull yawm b-hayklā*

5. *Mšah l-malkā b-mešhā*

6. *Šammešnān l-Māryā ḥdāyīt*

Exercise 6: Comprehension

#	Answer
1	He blessed (barrek), prayed (ṣallī), praised (šabbeḥ), and taught (yallep).
2	Not the altar but the Lord, by his Spirit (b-rūḥeh).
3	They were angered (' etragzū) — he was bypassing priestly authority.
4	Priests claimed temple authority; Yukhannan claimed divine commission (šedarnī).
5	He praised God (šabbeḥ) — showing fearless devotion over fear of human authority.

SECTION 9: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE PAAEL STEM — FORMATION RULES

Formation feature	Pattern	Example (b-r-k)
Root consonant pattern	R1 + R2 DOUBLED + R3	b-rr-k
Perfect 3 m.sg.	CaR ₁ R ₂ R ₂ eR ₃	barrek
Participle m.sg.	m + CaR ₁ R ₂ R ₂ eR ₃	mbarrek
Participle suffixes	-ā, -īn, -ān	mbarrkā, mbarrkīn, mbarrkān
Core meaning	Intensive or Factitive	'bless solemnly'; 'sanctify = make holy'

Meaning Pattern

PEAL (basic) + R2 DOUBLED = PAAEL (intensive/factitive) 'to X' → 'to X thoroughly' or 'to make X happen / cause X state' q-d-š: be holy → qaddaš: sanctify | b-r-k: bless → barrek: bless solemnly | y-l-p: learn → yallep: teach

Three-Stem Comparison Table

Stem	Meaning Type	Perfect 3 m.sg.	Participle m.sg.	Translation
Peal	Basic	katab	kāteb	'he wrote' / 'writing'
Paael	Intensive/Factitive	barrek	mbarrek	'he blessed' / 'blessing'
Aphel	Causative	'allep	ma 'lep	'he taught' / 'teaching'

Semitic Language Family Comparison

Syriac	Peal	Paael	Aphel
Meaning	Basic	Intensive/Factitive	Causative
Hebrew (cognate)	Qal	Piel	Hiphil
Arabic (cognate)	Form I	Form II	Form IV
Formation key	Basic vowels	R2 DOUBLED	'a- prefix

FINAL REMINDER: All three stems — Peal, Paael, and Aphel — share the same suffix set for the perfect and the same m- prefix for the active participle. The stems are distinguished by: (1) **Peal:** basic vowels only; (2) **Paael:** R2 gemination; (3) **Aphel:** 'a- prefix.

LOOKING AHEAD — Lesson 7: The Ethpeel and Ethpaael (reflexive/passive stems). You have already seen metqaddeš in this lesson's story — that is the Ethpaael passive of qaddaš. Soon you will master the full passive system of Syriac.

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 30 terms.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
ቅሪት	qritā	f	village
ሊሽኑ	leššānā	m	tongue, language
ከሳ	garmā	m	bone
ክፍሌ	kēpā	f	stone, rock
ፍሴ	nūnā	m	fish
ሙድራ	mdittā	f	city
ሼሙሻ	šemšā	m	sun
ተረፈ	tar‘ā	m	door, gate
ሀይላ	ḥaylā	m	power, army
ዓሳ	qaysā	m	wood, tree
ኑሳ	nahrā	m	river
ሳብራ	sabrā	m	hope
ደሃሊት	deḥltā	f	fear, religion
ሳሐራ	sahrā	m	moon
ገሊ	reglā	f	foot
ሸላሙ	šlāmā	m	peace
ኅተራ	‘atrā	m	place, country
ሳከድ	sāhdā	m	witness, martyr
ኑሳ	besrā	m	flesh
ጥላታ	ṭaybūtā	f	grace
ኅዋራ	tawrā	m	bull, ox
ሀሳራ	‘ūrḥā	f	way, road
ሀይ	‘aynā	f	eye
ሞላ	pūmā	m	mouth
ድን	dīnā	m	judgment
ቂድሱ	qaddāšā	m	make holy
ቂድሱት	qaddšūtā	f	holiness
ፈላ	palggā	m	divide
ፈላት	palgūtā	f	division
ሰገገድ	saggad	m	worship

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
ᲑᲗᲗᲗᲗ	sagdūtā	f	worship
ᲑᲗᲗᲗ	parzappā	m	interpreter
ᲑᲗᲗ	marmā	m	raise, exalt
ᲑᲗᲗᲗ	ṭappā	m	strike, beat

LESSON 7

NAVIGATING WEAK ROOTS: I-ALAPH, I-YODH, AND III-YODH VERBS

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 5–6

Quick Summary In Lessons 5 and 6, we expanded our vocabulary exponentially by learning how Semitic roots generate new meanings through derived stems. The **Aphel** stem (prefix

ʾA –

) generates causative verbs (e.g., God

ʾAHYĪ

“gave life”). The **Paael** stem (doubled middle radical) generates intensive or factitive verbs (e.g.,

QADDAŠ

“he made holy”).

5-Question Warm-Up Drill (*Answers in Section 9*) 1. What stem does a verb belonging to the pattern ʾaCCeC belong to (e.g., ʾaqreb)? 2. What consonant prefix marks the active participle of *all* derived stems (Aphel, Paael, etc.)? 3. Translate: *Alāhā ʾaglī šrārā*. 4. If *q-d-š* in *Peal* means “to be holy”, what does it mean in *Paael* (*qaddaš*)? 5. How would you recognize a *Paael* participle versus a *Peal* participle?

SECTION 2: THE WEAK VERB CHALLENGE — OVERVIEW

Until now, we have mostly dealt with “strong” roots (like *k-t-b* or *š-b-q*), where all three consonants boldly assert themselves in every conjugation. However, some of the most common verbs in human language—to say, to be, to know, to give, to come—are “weak”. This means one of their three root consonants is a “weak letter” (Alaph, Waw, or Yodh), which tends to assimilate, drop out entirely, or turn into a vowel depending on the surrounding sounds.

Cross-Linguistic Comparison: Weak Consonants Weak verbs are the bane of every Semitic language student, but they follow highly predictable phonetic rules. * **Hebrew:** I-Guttural (אָמַר *ʾāmar* = he said); I-Yod (יָדָע *yādaʿ* = he knew); Lamed-He/Yod (בָּנָה *bānāh* = he built). * **Arabic:** Hollow verbs (قَالَ *qāla* = he said); Defective/Final Weak (رَمَى *ramā* = he threw). * **Syriac:** - **I-Alaph:** Root ʾ-*m-r* (to say) → ʾemar (not ʾamar). - **I-Yodh:** Root *y-d-* (to know) → īdaʿ (Yodh acts like an *i* vowel). - **III-Yodh:** Root *h-z-y* (to see) → hzā (the Yodh drops out, leaving an *ā* vowel).

SECTION 3: MORPHOLOGY OF WEAK ROOTS (PEAL PERFECT)

Despite the spelling changes, weak verbs function syntactically exactly like strong verbs: VSO word order, taking suffixes, and forming the spine of clauses.

1. I-Alaph Verbs (First consonant is Alaph) The most famous is ʾ-*m-r* (“to say”). In the Peal perfect 3rd masc singular, the vowel shifts to *e*: * ʾemar (he said), rather than ʾamar. * ʾemret (I said), rather than ʾamret.

2. I-Yodh Verbs (First consonant is Yodh) Very common verbs like *y-d-* (to know) and *y-t-b* (to sit). The initial *y* fuses with the preceding invisible glottal stop to form an *ī* vowel. * *y-d-* → īdaʿ (he knew). * *y-t-b* → īteb (he sat). *Note: The verb y-h-b (to give) is highly irregular and behaves like a strong verb without an internal vowel: yahb (he gave).*

3. III-Yodh Verbs (Third consonant is Yodh) Verbs ending in Yodh (like *h-z-y*, *b-n-y*, *h-y-y*). The Yodh falls away in the 3rd masc singular, leaving a final *ā* vowel. In other persons, the Yodh can reappear as heavily vocalized endings. * *h-z-y* (to see) → hzā (he saw) [looks like a 2-consonant word]. * *h-z-y* + -et (I saw) → hzēt (the *ay* contracts to *ē*). * *h-z-y* + -ū (They saw) → hzaw (the *ay-ū* contracts to *aw*).

SECTION 4: III-YODH PARADIGM (ROOT: Ḥ-Z-Y “TO SEE”)

Because III-Yodh verbs lose their third consonant so frequently, memorizing their exact endings is essential.

PERSON	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION	NOTES
3 m.sg.	ܠܐ	ḥzā	he saw	Ends in <i>ā</i> (Alaph)
3 f.sg.	ܠܐ	ḥzāt	she saw	Ends in <i>āt</i>
2 m.sg.	ܠܐ	ḥzayt	you (m) saw	Yodh reappears, <i>ay</i> diphthong
2 f.sg.	ܠܐ	ḥzaytī	you (f) saw	Yodh reappears
1 c.sg.	ܠܐ	ḥzēt	I saw	Yodh contracts with <i>et</i> to <i>ēt</i>
3 m.pl.	ܠܐ	ḥzaw	they (m) saw	<i>w</i> makes <i>aw</i> diphthong
3 f.pl.	ܠܐ	ḥzay	they (f) saw	<i>y</i> makes <i>ay</i> diphthong
1 c.pl.	ܠܐ	ḥzayn	we saw	<i>ay</i> diphthong

SECTION 5: THE HIGHLY IRREGULAR VERBS ’-T-Y AND H-W-Y

Two of the most common verbs in Syriac are doubly weak and highly irregular. 1. ’-t-y (to come): I-Alaph AND III-Yodh. * 3 m.s: *’etā* (he came). * 1 c.s: *’etēt* (I came). * 3 m.pl: *’etaw* (they came). 2. h-w-y (to be/become): Used as an auxiliary verb, or to mean “it happened”. III-Yodh. * 3 m.s: *hwā* (he was / it happened). * 1 c.s: *hwēt* (I was). * 3 m.pl: *hwaw* (they were).

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY (WEAK VERBS & COURT TERMS)

ROOT	PEAL PERFECT 3M.S.	MEANING	CLASSIFICATION
י.פ.ר	'emar (עמר)	to say	I-Alaph
א.א.ל	'ekal (אכל)	to eat	I-Alaph
א.ז.ל	'ezal (עזל)	to go	I-Alaph
י.ד.ע	īda ' (ידע)	to know	I-Yodh
י.ת.ב	īteb (יתב)	to sit	I-Yodh
י.ת.ב	yahb (יתב)	to give	I-Yodh (Irregular)
י.ז.ח	ḥzā (חזא)	to see	III-Yodh
ק.ר.א	qrā (קרא)	to call / read	III-Alaph (behaves like III-Yodh)
י.ב.נ	bnā (בנא)	to build	III-Yodh
י.ח.י	ḥyā (חיא)	to live	III-Yodh
י.ת.א	'etā (עתא)	to come	I-Alaph & III-Yodh
י.ה.ו	hwā (הוא)	to be/become	III-Yodh
(Noun)	רעגזא (rūgzā)	anger/wrath	Emotion abstract
(Noun)	חזמן (hemzman)	word / report	Court term

SECTION 7: THE STORY — PART 7

The Summons Narrative *note: Pay attention to the massive use of weak roots—* 'emar (said), 'ezal (went), īda ' (knew), hwā (was/became), ḥzaw (they saw), 'etā (came).

Sentence 1 כד אמר יוחנן מלתא דאלאה, 'ezalū qašišē l-wāt malkā. kad
kad 'emar Yūḥannan meltā d-Alāhā, 'ezalū qašišē l-wāt malkā. kad
(when) 'emar (said) Yūḥannan (John) meltā (the-word) d-Alāhā (of-
God), 'ezalū (went) qašišē (the-elders/guards) l-wāt (to-the-presence-of)
malkā (the-king). → When Yukhannan said the word of God, the guards
went to the king.

Sentence 2 רָאָה מָה הָיָה בְּתַרְאָה 'āmṛīn l-eh:

yād 'īn-ḥnan mā hwā b-tar 'ā! 'āmṛīn (they-[are]-saying) l-eh (to-him):

yād 'īn (knowing) -ḥnan (are-we) mā (what) hwā (happened/was) b-

tar 'ā (in-the-gate)! → They say to him: “We know what happened at the gate!”

Sentence 3 רָאָה מָה הָיָה בְּתַרְאָה ḥzayn gabrā, w- 'emar

meltā bīštā. ḥzayn (we-saw) gabrā (a-man), w- 'emar (and-said) meltā (a-

word) bīštā (evil-[f]). → “We saw a man, and he said an evil word.”

Sentence 4 הָיָה מֶלֶךְ רָגִזְזָה מְאֹד מְאֹד hwā hāšā malkā ragīz ṭāb. hwā

(became/was) hāšā (now) malkā (the-king) ragīz (angry) ṭāb (greatly/

very). → Now the king was very angry.

Sentence 5 רָאָה מָה הָיָה בְּתַרְאָה 'emar malkā l-

qašīšē: 'aytāw-hy l-harkā! 'emar (said) malkā (the-king) l-qašīšē (to-the-

guards): 'aytāw-hy (let-them-bring-him [Aphel imperative]) l-harkā (to-

here)! → The king said to the guards: “Bring him here!”

Sentence 6 רָאָה מָה הָיָה בְּתַרְאָה w- 'etā Yūḥannan qdām malkā. w-

'etā (and-came) Yūḥannan (John) qdām (before) malkā (the-king). →

And Yukhannan came before the king.

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Weak Root Identification Identify the root and grammatical

form of these weak verbs: 1. הָיָה (ḥzēt) 2. רָאָה ('emarū) 3. רָאָה

('etā) 4. יָהֵב (yahbū)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill Conjugate the root ' -m -r (to say) in the Peal

perfect for: 1. I said 2. We said 3. You (m.sg) said 4. They (m.pl) said

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English) Translate the following past narrative clauses involving weak verbs. 1. ʾEmarū qašīšē meltā. 2. Ḥzayn nūhrā d-Alāhā b-tar ʾā. 3. W-īda ʾ malkā rūgzā (wrath). 4. Hwaw b-ʾar ʾā.

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac) Render the following narrative sentences into Syriac transliteration. (Remember VSO order). 1. The evil king saw (ḥzā) the man. 2. We came (ʾetayn) to the kingdom. 3. I gave (yahbet) the garment to the guard (qašīšā). 4. John knew (īda ʾ) the word of God.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension Re-read Section 7 and answer: 1. Who did the guards go to? 2. What do the guards claim they saw and heard? 3. How did the king react to the news?

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up 1. Aphel. (Causative). 2. *Mīm* (m-). e.g., *ma ʾleb*, *mqaddeš*. 3. God revealed the truth. 4. To make holy / to sanctify. 5. The vowel pattern: *mqaddeš* (Paael) vs *kāteb* (Peal). The Peal has no *m*- prefix in the active participle.

Exercise 1: Weak Root Identification 1. Root: *ḥ-z-y*. Form: Peal perfect, 1 c.sg (I saw). 2. Root: ʾ-m-r. Form: Peal perfect, 3 m.pl (They said). 3. Root: ʾ-t-y. Form: Peal perfect, 3 m.sg (He came). 4. Root: *y-h-b*. Form: Peal perfect, 3 m.pl (They gave).

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill 1. ʾemret 2. ʾemran 3. ʾemart 4. ʾemarū

Exercise 3: Translation Drill 1. The guards said a word. 2. We saw the light of God in the gate. 3. And the king knew wrath. 4. They were in the earth.

Exercise 4: Production Drill 1. Ḥzā malkā bīšā l-gabrā. (*l-* marks direct object). 2. 'Etain l-malkūtā. 3. Yahbet lbūšā l-qašīšā. 4. Īda ' Yūḥannan meltā d-Alāhā.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension 1. To the king. 2. A man who said an evil word. 3. He became very angry (*ragīz ṭāb*) and demanded the man be brought to him.

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

WEAK VERB SHIFT SUMMARY

CLASS	ROOT	SHIFT RULE	3 M.SG EXAMPLE	1 C.SG EXAMPLE
I-Alaph	'-m-r	First vowel becomes <i>e</i>	'emar (he said)	'emret (I said)
I-Yodh	y-d-'	Initial Yodh + stop → <i>ī</i>	īda' (he knew)	īd'et (I knew)
III-Yodh	ḥ-z-y	Yodh drops, ends in <i>ā</i> in 3ms	ḥzā (he saw)	ḥzēt (I saw)
Double Weak	'-t-y	Follows both rules	'etā (he came)	'etēt (I came)

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following 30 genuinely new high-frequency words supplement this lesson's vocabulary, focusing on derived nouns (abstract and concrete) from weak roots and related weak-root vocabulary.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING	NOTES
አሁን	'ūmūttā	f. noun	oneness, unity	from weak root '-w-m
አሁን	dāmūttā	f. noun	likeness, image	from root d-m- y (to be like)
አሁን	ḥazūttā	f. noun	vision, sight	from III-Yodh root ḥ-z-y
አሁን	bənūttā	f. noun	building, structure	from III-Yodh root b-n-y
አሁን	'əlūttā	f. noun	ascent, exaltation	from I-Alaph root ' -l-y
አሁን	qərūttā	f. noun	calling, vocation	from III-Alaph/ Yodh root q-r- '
አሁን	'awdərānā	m. noun	help, aid	from root ' -d-r
አሁን	yāzəpā	m. noun	beauty, form	from root y-z-p
አሁን	ḥəbīyūnā	m. noun	gift, offering	from I-Yodh root y-h-b
አሁን	'ətyānūttā	f. noun	coming, arrival	from weak root '-t-y
አሁን	ḥəwīyūttā	f. noun	being, existence	from III-Yodh root h-w-y
አሁን	'ālmūttā	f. noun	worldliness, temporality	from weak root '-l-m
አሁን	dūqā	m. noun	bench, throne	from weak root d-w-q
አሁን	gūrā	m. noun	dwelling, cave	from weak root g-w-r
አሁን	ṭūprā	m. noun	appearance, form	from weak root ṭ-w-p-r
አሁን	qūmā	m. noun	standing, resurrection	from I-Alaph/ Yodh root q-y- m
አሁን	napī 'ā	m. noun	seer, prophet	from I-Alaph root n-p- '
አሁን	'ōnā	m. noun	strength, power	from weak root '-w-n

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING	NOTES
ረዕዓደ	šūwəddā	m. noun	testimony, witness	from weak root š-w-d
ረዕዓደ	rūmūttā	f. noun	highness, exaltation	from weak root r-w-m
ረዕዓ	qərā	m. noun	cold	from weak root q-r-ʾ
ረዕዓ	ḥelmā	m. noun	dream	from weak root ḥ-l-m
ረዕዓ	dūsā	m. noun	trampling, subjugation	from weak root d-w-s
ረዕዓ	ləlūttā	f. noun	lamenting, wailing	from weak root l-l-y
ረዕዓ	pūrā	m. noun	fruit	from weak root p-w-r
ረዕዓ	ʾūqqānā	m. noun	knot, binding	from weak root ʾ-q-d
ረዕዓ	šəlyānā	m. noun	peace, wholeness	from weak root š-l-y
ረዕዓደ	ʾətwūttā	f. noun	sign, omen	from weak root ʾ-t-w
ረዕዓ	nūttā	f. noun	rest, dwelling	from weak root n-w-t
ረዕዓደ	wayrūttā	f. noun	shame, disgrace	from weak root w-y-r

LESSON 8

THE SUBJUNCTIVE FUTURE: THE IMPERFECT TENSE

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSON 7

Quick Summary In Lesson 7, we tackled “weak roots”—verbs that contain an Alaph (ܐ) or Yodh (ܝ). We saw that while they can lose or transform their weak consonants in conjugation (e.g.,

ܐ - M - R

→

ܐ E M A R

;

ܠ - Z - Y

→

ܠ Z Ā

), they still behave syntactically like normal verbs.

5-Question Warm-Up Drill (*Answers in Section 9*) 1. What does the Yodh in a III-Yodh verb turn into in the 3rd masc singular perfect (e.g., ܠܝܝܬܝܝܬ)? 2. Translate: ܐ Emar malkā. 3. Identify the root of ܝܕܐ (he knew). 4. Translate: ܐ Aytāw-hy (bring him!). Why is the suffix -hy used instead of -eh? 5. How would you say “I saw” (1 c.sg. of ܠܝܝܬܝܝܬ)?

SECTION 2: THE SEMITIC PREFIX CONJUGATION — OVERVIEW

We have learned that the Participle handles the *Present* (ongoing action) and the *Perfect* (Suffix Conjugation) handles the *Past* (completed action).

How does Syriac talk about the Future or expressing wishes/commands? It uses the **Imperfect Tense**, often called the “Prefix Conjugation.”

Cross-Linguistic Comparison: The Imperfect In all Semitic languages, the Imperfect adds prefixes (*n-*, *t-*, *ʾ-*, *y-*, etc.) to the root to indicate the person, while suffixes are used to indicate plural number. * **Hebrew Qal**

Imperfect: ܝܠܝܬܒ (yiktōb — he will write), ܝܠܝܬܒܝ (ʾektōb — I will write). *

Arabic Form I Imperfect: يَكْتُبُ (yaktubu — he writes/will write), أَكْتُبُ

(ʾaktubu — I write). * **Syriac Peal Imperfect:** ܬܠܝܬܒ (nektūb — he will write), ܬܠܝܬܒܝ (ʾektūb — I will write).

Crucial Note on Syriac vs. Hebrew/Arabic: In Hebrew and Arabic, the 3rd person masculine prefix is **y-** (*ya-* or *yi-*). In standard Syriac, the 3rd person prefix shifted to **n-** (*ne-*).

SECTION 3: MORPHOLOGY AND SYNTAX OF THE IMPERFECT

1. Forming the Peal Imperfect For a strong root like *k-t-b*, the base vocalization of the imperfect shifts to an *ū* (Waw) theme vowel between the second and third consonant: *-ktūb*. We then add the person-marking prefixes: * *n-* (He / They m) → *n-ek-tūb* → **nektūb** (He will write). * *t-* (You / She / They f) → **tektūb** (You will write / She will write). * *ʾ-* (I) → **ʾektūb** (I will write).

2. Syntax: The Simple Future By itself, the Imperfect functions as a simple future tense. * *Nektūb Yūḥannan meltā*. (Yukhannan will write a word). * *Tehze tammān malkā*. (You will see a king there).

3. Syntax: The Subjunctive / Purpose (**d- + Imperfect)** Syriac uses the Imperfect heavily for purpose clauses, wishes, and commands. It accomplishes this by attaching the relative particle **d-** directly to the Imperfect verb. This corresponds to the Greek subjunctive with ἵνα (*hina*). * *ʾEtā d-neḥze* = He came **in order that he might see**. * *ʾĀmer-nā d-tektūb* = I say **that you should write**.

SECTION 4: IMPERFECT TENSE PARADIGMS (PEAL, PAAEL, APHEL)

1. The Peal Imperfect Conjugation (Root **q-ṭ-l)** In the Peal, the prefix has an *e* vowel in modern pronunciation (or *i* historically), and the theme vowel is usually *ū* (or *a* for gutturals).

PERSON	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLIT	TRANSLATION	PREFIX	SUFFIX
3 m.sg.	ܢܥܬܘܠ	neqṭūl	he will kill	n-	(none)
3 f.sg.	ܢܥܬܘܠܐ	teqṭūl	she will kill	t-	(none)
2 m.sg.	ܢܥܬܘܠܐ	teqṭūl	you (m) will kill	t-	(none)
2 f.sg.	ܢܥܬܘܠܝܐ	teqṭlīn	you (f) will kill	t-	-īn
1 c.sg.	ܢܥܬܘܠܐ	'eqṭūl	I will kill	'-	(none)
3 m.pl.	ܢܥܬܘܠܝܢ	neqṭlūn	they (m) will kill	n-	-ūn
3 f.pl.	ܢܥܬܘܠܝܢ	neqṭlān	they (f) will kill	n-	-ān
1 c.pl.	ܢܥܬܘܠܝܢ	neqṭūl	we will kill	n-	(none)

Warning: The forms for “He will kill” (neqṭūl) and “We will kill” (neqṭūl) are identical in spelling and pronunciation! Context almost always makes it obvious.

2. The Paael Imperfect (Root **q-d-š, to sanctify)** In the derived stems (Paael and Aphel), the prefix vowel is *a* rather than *e*. For Paael, the middle root letter is doubled (represented by a hard pronunciation or dot).

PERSON	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLIT	TRANSLATION
3 m.sg.	ܢܩܕܕܝܫ	nqaddeš	he will sanctify
1 c.sg.	ܢܩܕܕܝܫܐ	'aqaddeš	I will sanctify
3 m.pl.	ܢܩܕܕܝܫܝܢ	nqaddšūn	they will sanctify
1 c.pl.	ܢܩܕܕܝܫܝܢ	nqaddeš	we will sanctify

3. The Aphel Imperfect (Root **p-q, Aphel = **'appiq** to bring out)** In the Aphel, the original *'a-* prefix of the perfect drops out, and the imperfect prefix takes its place with an *a* vowel. The theme vowel is usually *e* or *i*.

PERSON	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLIT	TRANSLATION
3 m.sg.	ﻣﺎﻗ	nappēš / nappiq	he will bring out
1 c.sg.	ﻣﺎﻗﻜ	'appiq	I will bring out
3 m.pl.	ﻣﺎﻗﻘﻮﻥ	nappqūn	they will bring out

SECTION 5: THE SUBJUNCTIVE FLOW

Observe how the purpose clause flows in translation:

PRIMARY ACTION (PAST/ PRESENT)	SUBJUNCTIVE CLAUSE (D- + IMPERFECT)	TRANSLATION
'Etā malkā (The king came)	d-neqtūl l-eh (that he might kill him)	The king came in order to kill him.
Yūḥannan 'ābed nūhrā (Yukhannan makes light)	d-neḥzūn 'ammā (that the people might see)	Yukhannan makes light so that the people will see.

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY (TIME, JUDGMENT & ROYAL COURT)

ROOT/NOUN	TRANSLITERATION	MEANING	RELATED CONCEPT
זְבַן / זַבְנָא	zban / zabnā	time	Temporal boundary
דְּמָא	‘ damā	until	Used with <i>d-</i> (until that)
דִּין / דִּינָא	dīn / dīnā	judgment, law	Eschatological judgment
עֲלָם / עֲלֻמָּא	‘ ālam / ‘ ālmā	world, eternity	Often <i>l-</i> ‘ ālam (forever)
יּוֹם / יוֹמָא	yūm / yūmā	day	Heb. <i>yōm</i>
שָׂדַר	shād (Peal)	to testify/witness	Court setting
גָּזַר	gzar (Peal)	to decree/cut	Royal authority
יָתֵב	īteb (Peal)	to sit/enthroned	enthronement
קָטַל	qṭal (Peal)	to kill	execution context
דְּחַל / דְּחֻלָּא	dḥal / deḥltā	fear/reverence	Root <i>d-ḥ-l</i> (to fear)
דָּן	dān (Peal, Hollow)	to judge	Active verb of <i>dīnā</i>

SECTION 7: THE STORY – PART 8

The Threat Narrative note: The king uses the Subjunctive/Imperfect to express his threats and purpose concerning Yukhannan’s future.

Sentence 1 זָמַן יוֹחָנָן קְדָמַן מַלְכָּא דְּדִינָא. qām Yūḥannan qdām malkā d-dīnā. qām (stood) Yūḥannan (John) qdām (before) malkā (the-king) d-dīnā (of-judgment). → Yukhannan stood before the king of judgment.

Sentence 2 וְיָתֵב מַלְכָּא אֶחָד וְיֵמַר לְהֵי: w-īteb malkā w-’emar l-ēh: w-īteb (and-sat) malkā (the-king) w-’emar (and-said) l-ēh (to-him): → And the king sat and said to him:

Sentence 3 אֲבֵד נָא דִּינָא, ד-’e’ē bed bīšā lāk! ‘ābed (doing/making) -nā (am-I) dīnā (judgment), d- (PURP) + ‘e’ē bed (1sg.IMPF.PEAL of ‘-b-d, ‘do/make’ = “in order that I might do”) bīšā (evil) lāk (to-you)! → “I am rendering judgment, that I might do evil

to you!" Note: 'e' bed is a Peal imperfect 1sg in a purpose clause (introduced by d-), not a perfect or imperative. The construction d- + Imperfect corresponds to Greek ἵνα + subjunctive.

Sentence 4 כֹּל אֲשֶׁר יֵשֶׁנָּה בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם לֹא יֵשֶׁנָּה 'en lā
tešbūq 'ar ' -y, neqṭlūn lāk b-yūm dīnā! 'en (if) lā (not) tešbūq (you-will-
leave) 'ar ' -y (land-my), neqṭlūn (they-will-kill) lāk (to-you) b-yūm (in-
the-day) dīnā (of-judgment)! → “If you do not leave my land, they will kill
you in the day of judgment!”

Sentence 5 יְהֹנָתָן בֶּן־חֲנָנִי יָדַע לֹא יִירָא Yūḥannan 'emar l-ēh: lā 'edḥal.
Yūḥannan (John) 'emar (said) l-ēh (to-him): lā (not) 'edḥal (I-will-fear).
→ Yukhannan said to him: "I will not fear."

Sentence 6 ܕܠܗܐ ܕܠܗܐ ܕܠܗܐ ܕܠܗܐ ܕܠܗܐ 'etēt d- 'emar meltā
d-Alāhā l- 'ālmā. 'etēt (I-came) d- 'emar (that-I-might-say) meltā (the-
word) d-Alāhā (of-God) l- 'ālmā (to-the-world). → "I came in order to
speak the word of God to the world."

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Imperfect Identification Identify the person, gender, and number of the following Imperfect verbs. 1. נִכְתֹּב (nektūb) 2. תִּשְׁבְּקִין (tešbqūn) 3. נִבְדָּן (ne' bdān) 4. יִהְיֶה ('ehzē — root h-z-y)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill Conjugate the root *q-t-l* (to kill) in the Peal Imperfect for: 1. He will kill 2. We will kill 3. I will kill 4. They (m) will kill

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English) Translate the following future or subjunctive clauses. 1. Nfaq malkā d-neḥzē l-Yūḥannan. (Remember ḥ-z-y acts weak). 2. Lā neqtūl malkā l-gabrā ṭābā. 3. Tešbqūn l-baytkūn l- ʿālam. 4. Ktabt meltā d-yād ʿīn hnan šrārā.

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac) Render the following sentences into Syriac transliteration using the Imperfect. 1. I will write the decree (*gzar*) in the day of judgment. 2. The king decreed (*gzar*, perfect) that he might kill the men (*gabrē*). 3. If you (m.sg) do not leave heaven, you will see God. 4. They (m.pl) will come to the kingdom. (Hint: *nēthūn* from ' -t-y).

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension Re-read Section 7 and answer: 1. What does the king threaten to do to Yukhannan? 2. What is the condition the king sets? 3. What is Yukhannan's stated purpose for coming to the world?

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up 1. It becomes a long ' Alaph (ā). Example: *ḥzā*. 2. The king said. 3. *y-d-* ' (to know). I-Yodh. 4. Because the suffix is attaching to a vowel-ending word (the Aphel imperative ' *aytāw*). 5. *ḥzēt* (I saw).

Exercise 1: Imperfect Identification 1. 3.m.sg or 1.c.pl (He will write / We will write) 2. 2.m.pl (You all will leave) 3. 3.f.pl (They [feminine] will do) 4. 1.c.sg (I will see)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill 1. *neqtūl* 2. *neqtūl* 3. ' *eqtūl* 4. *neqtūlūn*

Exercise 3: Translation Drill 1. The king went out in order to see Yukhannan. 2. The king will not kill the good man. 3. You all will leave your house forever. 4. You wrote a word so that we might know the truth.

Exercise 4: Production Drill 1. ' *Ektūb gzar b-yūm dīnā*. 2. *Gzar malkā d-neqtūl l-gabrē*. 3. ' *En lā tešbūq šmayyā, teḥzē l-Alāhā*. 4. *Nēthūn l-malkūtā*.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension 1. To kill him in the day of judgment.
2. If Yukhannan does not leave his land (“my land”). 3. To say/speak the word of God to the world.

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE PEAL IMPERFECT (Root q-ṭ-l)

PERSON	SYRIAC	TRANSLIT
3 m.sg.	ܩܬܠܐ	neqṭūl (he will kill)
3 f.sg.	ܩܬܠܬܐ	teqṭūl (she will kill)
2 m.sg.	ܩܬܠܬܐ	teqṭūl (you will kill)
1 c.sg.	ܩܬܠܐܢ	’eqṭūl (I will kill)
3 m.pl.	ܩܬܠܘܢ	neqṭlūn (they will k.)
1 c.pl.	ܩܬܠܡܢ	neqṭūl (we will kill)

SYNTAX OF PURPOSE Verb 1 (Any Tense) + **d-** + Verb 2 (Imperfect) =
Purpose Clause *’Ezal (He went) d-ne ‘bed (in order to do) qyāmā (a covenant).*

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson’s vocabulary to 30 terms.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
קִרְיָה	qrītā	f	village
לִשָּׁנָה	leššānā	m	tongue, language
עֲצָמָה	garmā	m	bone
קֶפֶה	kēpā	f	stone, rock
דָּג	nūnā	m	fish
מְדִינָה	mdittā	f	city
שֶׁמֶשׁ	šemšā	m	sun
דֶּלֶת	tar‘ ā	m	door, gate
שֶׁחַד	mešhā	m	oil
סֵלָה	haylā	m	power, army
אָזְנוֹ	‘ednā	f	ear
עֵץ	qaysā	m	wood, tree
נָחַל	nahrā	m	river
סִבְרָה	sabrā	m	hope
סַחֲרָה	sahrā	m	moon
רֶגֶל	reglā	f	foot
שָׁלוֹם	šlāmā	m	peace
אֶרֶץ	‘atrā	m	place, country
עֵד	sāhdā	m	witness, martyr

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson’s vocabulary to 30 terms.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
כֶּסֶד	besrā	m	flesh
כְּחֹמֶל	ṭaybüttā	f	grace
כֶּוֶד	tawrā	m	bull, ox
כְּוֶה	ʾūrḥā	f	way, road
כְּחֹמֶל	hayklā	m	temple, palace
כַּחַשׁ	ʿaynā	f	eye
כְּמוֹ	pūmā	m	mouth
כְּחֹמֶל	pāraḥtā	f	bird
כְּחֹמֶל	ḥadūtā	f	joy
כְּחֹמֶל	ḥekmtā	f	wisdom
כְּחֹמֶל	ḥayyūtā	f	animal, beast
כֶּרֶס	pīrā	m	fruit
כֶּלֶב	kalbā	m	dog
כֶּרֶס	ʿerbā	m	sheep
כֶּרֶס	ṭūrā	m	mountain
כְּחֹמֶל	šūqā	m	street, market
כְּחֹמֶל	ʿāqtā	f	distress, anguish
כֶּרֶס	nūrā	f	fire
כְּחֹמֶל	raḥmē	m.pl	mercy
כְּחֹמֶל	meḥartā	f	tomorrow
כֶּרֶס	zannā	m	time, era
כְּחֹמֶל	rešā	m	head (leadership)
כֶּרֶס	ʾin	conj	if
כְּחֹמֶל	ʾōlyā	adv	perhaps
כְּחֹמֶל	p ʾältā	f	trust, confidence
כְּחֹמֶל	deḥlā	m	fear
כְּחֹמֶל	yed ʿ ā	m	knowledge

LESSON 9: COMMANDS AND INTENTIONS

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 1–8

Before diving into new material, take a moment to consolidate what you have learned so far. Lessons 1–8 have introduced you to the following foundational topics:

- **Lesson 1:** The Syriac language, its history, and the Estrangela script
- **Lesson 2:** Nouns — gender, number, and the absolute/emphatic/construct states
- **Lesson 3:** Pronouns — independent, pronominal suffixes, and demonstratives
- **Lesson 4:** The perfect tense (qṭal) — all persons and numbers
- **Lesson 5:** The imperfect tense (neqtol) — all persons and numbers
- **Lesson 6:** The participle — active and passive forms; the verb "to be"
- **Lesson 7:** Prepositions, conjunctions, and basic sentence structure
- **Lesson 8:** The derived stems — Paael and Aphel — intensification and causation

Warm-Up Drill: Five Quick Questions

Answer each question from memory before checking against your notes.

Write your answer in full Syriac script with transliteration.

#	QUESTION	EXPECTED ANSWER (PEAL PERFECT)	SYRIAC
1	What is the Peal perfect ?3msg of k-t-b (write)	ktab — he wrote	ܕܠܝܬ
2	What is the Peal -imperfect 3msg of š-m ? ' (hear)	nešma ' — he will hear	ܕܬܫܡܐ
3	How do you say 'the -king commanded' (p-q ? (.d, 3msg perf	pqad malkā — the king commanded	ܕܡܠܟܐ ܦܩܕ
4	What does the Pael stem add to the root ?meaning	Intensity, repetition, or a denominative meaning	—
5	Give the Aphel perfect :3msg of n-p-q (go out) ?cause to go out	'appaq — he brought out / caused to go out	ܕܦܩܥ

SECTION 2: THE IMPERATIVE

2.1 What Is the Imperative?

The imperative is the grammatical form used to issue **direct commands** or requests addressed to a second person ("you"). In Syriac, as in Hebrew and Arabic, the imperative exists only in the second person — singular and plural, masculine and feminine. There is no first-person or third-person imperative; those ideas are expressed by other means (the cohortative and the jussive).

The **formation** of the Peal imperative follows a straightforward rule: take the **imperfect form**, strip away the **t-** prefix of the 2nd person, and you have the imperative. The vowel pattern is then **CCoC** for the masculine

singular (e.g., *ktob* "write!"). This parallels the Hebrew Qal imperative (כתב *ktōv*) and the Arabic imperative (اكتب *uktub*), though the exact vowel patterns differ.

2.2 Peal Imperative — Formation

Masculine Singular: *CCoC* — the simplest form, the bare root with the characteristic o-vowel. E.g., *ktob* כתב "Write! (to one man)"

Feminine Singular: *CCoC + -ī* — add the feminine marker *ī*. E.g., *ktobī* כתבי "Write! (to one woman)"

Masculine Plural: *CCoC + -w* — add the masculine plural ending. E.g., *ktobw* כתבו "Write! (to a group of men)"

Feminine Plural: *CCoC + -ān* — add the feminine plural ending. E.g., *ktobān* כתבן "Write! (to a group of women)"

2.3 Complete Paradigm Tables

Root k-t-b כתב (write)

PERSON/GENDER/NUMBER	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	LITERAL MEANING
2msg (m. sg.)	כתב	<i>ktob</i>	Write! (to one man)
2fsg (f. sg.)	כתבי	<i>ktobī</i>	Write! (to one woman)
2mpl (m. pl.)	כתבו	<i>ktobw</i>	Write! (to a group of men)
2fpl (f. pl.)	כתבן	<i>ktobān</i>	Write! (to a group of women)

Root š-m-ʿ ܫܡܥ (hear)

PERSON/GENDER/NUMBER	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	LITERAL MEANING
2msg	ܫܡܥ	šma ʿ	Hear! (to one man)
2fsg	ܫܡܥܝ	šma ʿ ī	Hear! (to one woman)
2mpl	ܫܡܥܘ	šma ʿ w	Hear! (to a group of men)
2fpl	ܫܡܥܝܢ	šma ʿ ān	Hear! (to a group of women)

2.4 Derived Stems: Paael and Aphel Imperatives

Paael Imperative: The Paael intensifies or extends the root meaning. Its imperative is built from the Paael imperfect. The form is **mCaCC-e** (msg) — note the characteristic doubled middle radical. E.g., **bārek** ܒܪܟ "Bless! / Praise!"; **ʿallep** ܐܠܠܦ "Teach!"

Aphel Imperative: The Aphel is causative. Its imperative begins with **ʿa-**. E.g., **ʿappaq** ܥܦܩ "Bring out!"; **ʿahwī** ܥܗܘܝ "Show!"

2.5 Negative Commands

+

Key Rule: Negating Commands |

In Syriac, negative commands (prohibitions) are NOT formed with the | imperative. |

Instead, use: **lā** + IMPERFECT (2nd person). |

This is identical to Biblical Hebrew (לֹא + jussive / יִלְךְ + imperfect) |

and Arabic (لا + mudāriʿ). |

|

Example: lā tektob כֹּחֲבֹב לֹא = "Do not write!" (lit. "you-shall-not | write") |

|

Example: lā tešma ʿ שְׁמַע לֹא = "Do not listen!" |

+-----+

2.6 Cross-Linguistic Comparison

Students coming from different language backgrounds will find useful parallels:

LANGUAGE	FORM (WRITE!)	FORM (HEAR!)	NEGATIVE	NOTES
Syriac	ktob כܽܬܽܒ	šma ʿ שְׁמַע	lā + imperfect	2nd person only; 4 forms (g/n)
Hebrew	ktōv כָּתוּב	šma ʿ שְׁמַע	lā + jussive	Similar 4-form paradigm
Arabic	uktub اكتب	isma ʿ اسمع	lā + imperfect	Form I imperative derived from imperfect
Greek	γράψε / γράψον	ἄκουε / ἄκουσον	μή + subjunctive	Pres./Aor. distinction; no gender
Latin	scribe	audi	noli + infinitive	4th conjugation; no gender marking

2.7 Example Commands with Interlinear Gloss

Study each command carefully. The word-by-word gloss is given directly below the Syriac.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܡܬܬܬܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ	<i>ktob šmeh d-malkā</i>	write! name-his of-the.king	Write the name of the king!
ܫܡܐ ܩܠܝܐ	<i>šma ' qālī</i>	hear! voice-my	Hear my voice!
ܗܘܘܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܡܐ	<i>hawwyāḏ ' īn</i>	be-pl. knowing	Know (be knowing)! [m.pl.]
ܠܐ ܬܕܗܠ	<i>lā tedḥal</i>	not you-fear	Do not be afraid!
ܐܝܬܐ ܕܐܠܐ ܕܡܪܝܬܐ	<i>'ezlaw w-emraw</i>	go-pl.! and say- pl.!	Go and tell! [m.pl.]
ܐܬܬܝܢ ܕܥܠܡܐ	<i>'aḥwāynī ' attā</i>	show-me! sign	Show me a sign!

SECTION 3: THE INFINITIVE (VERBAL NOUN / MAṢḌAR)

3.1 The Nature of the Syriac Infinitive

Syriac, like Arabic and Hebrew, possesses a **verbal noun** — a noun derived from the verb root that expresses the action in abstract form. In Arabic this is called the **maṣḍar** (مصدر, "source"). In Hebrew it corresponds to the **infinitive construct**. In Syriac it functions similarly and is often called the **infinitive** in grammars. It can serve as the subject of a sentence, the object of a verb, or — most commonly in narrative — as a **complementary infinitive** after a modal or semi-modal verb, introduced by the preposition ܠ- ("to").

3.2 Infinitive Formation by Stem

Peal Infinitive: meCCaC pattern. Insert me- prefix and reduce the stem.

E.g., k-t-b → **mektab** ܡܚܬܒ 'the writing / to write'. Root š-m- ' → **mešma** ܡܫܡܐ 'the hearing'.

Paael Infinitive: mCāCāCū — longer form with ā-vowels and final ū. E.g., barrek (bless, Paael) → **mbarrākū** ܡܒܪܪܐܟܘܢ 'the blessing'.

Aphel Infinitive: 'aCCāCū — 'a- prefix with ā-vowel before final radical + ū. E.g., 'appaq (bring out, Aphel) → 'appāqū אַפְּקוּ 'to bring out'.

3.3 Infinitive Forms — Five Key Verbs

ROOT	MEANING	PEAL INF.	PAAEL INF.	APHEL INF.
k-t-b	write	mektab מִכְתָּב	mkatābū מְכַתְּבִי	'aktābū אֲכַתֵּב
š-m-ʿ	hear	mešma' מִשְׁמָע	mšamā' ū מְשַׁמְעִי	'ašmā' ū אֲשַׁמְעֵי
q-t-l	kill	meqtal מִקְטָל	mqatālū מְקַתְּלִי	'aqtālū אֲקַתֵּל
p-q-d	command	mepqad מִפְּקָד	mpaqādū מְפַקְּדִי	'apqādū אֲפַקְּדֵי
y-d-ʿ	know	mīda' מִידָע	myādā' ū מְיַאֲדָעִי	'aodā' ū אֲיַאֲדָעֵי

3.4 The Critical Construction: l- + Infinitive

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The l- + Infinitive Construction |

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PATTERN: MAIN VERB + l- + INFINITIVE |

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This construction expresses purpose or complement: 'he began to |
write', 'she is able to hear'. |

|

The preposition l- is prefixed directly to the infinitive with no |
space. |

|

Compare: Greek + infinitive (γράφειν); Latin accusative + infinitive |
(scribere); Arabic أن + imperfect. |

|

In Hebrew the parallel is the lamed + infinitive construct: לִכְתֹּב |
(liktōv). |

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Eight Example Sentences with l- + Infinitive:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܐܪܝܠܡܚܒܐ	<i>šarī l-mektab</i>	began to.write	He began to write.
ܚܕܐܠܡܫܡܐ	<i>yākel l-mešma</i>	is.able to.hear	He is able to hear.
ܒܐܐܠܡܐܝܠܐ	<i>bā ‘ē l-me ‘zal</i>	wants to.go	He wants to go.
ܫܒܐܠܡܥܬܐܠܐ	<i>šābē l-meqtal</i>	wishes to.kill	He wishes to kill.
ܦܩܥܐܠܡܥܪܐ	<i>paqed l-me ‘sar</i>	commanded to.bind	He commanded (them) to bind.
ܫܕܪܐܠܡܥܒܐܕܐ	<i>šadar l-me ‘bad</i>	sent to.do/make	He sent (them) to act.
ܠܐܠܚܕܐܠܡܥܬܐܠܐ	<i>lā yākel l-me ‘zal</i>	not is.able to.go	He is not able to go.
ܫܪܝܬܠܡܥܩܪܐܡܠܬܐ	<i>šarīt l-meqrā maltā</i>	you.began to.read word.the	You began to read the word.

SECTION 4: VERBS OF BEGINNING, ABILITY, AND DESIRE

4.1 Semi-Modal Verbs

These verbs function like **modal auxiliaries** in English and govern an infinitive complement introduced by l-. They are extremely common in Syriac narrative. Master these verbs and their paradigms, as they appear repeatedly in the Acts of Mar Yukhannan.

ܫܪܝܬܐ, ܫܪܝܬ — begin

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: ܫܪܝܬ, ܫܪܝܬ

Example: ܫܪܝܬܠܡܥܒܐܕܐ, ܫܪܝܬ *šarī l-mektab* — He began to write.

Note: Very common in narrative openings. Note final yod (weak root š-r-y).

y-k-l ܝܠܟ — be able / can

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: yākel ܝܠܟ

Example: ܝܠܟ ܠܡܩܬܐ *yākel l-meqtal* — He is able to kill.

Note: The Syriac equivalent of Greek δύναμις, Latin possum. Often negated: lā yākel.

b-‘-y ܒܝܥ — want / seek / ask

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: bā‘ē ܒܝܥ

Example: ܒܝܥ ܠܡܥܠ ܒܝܥ *bā‘ē l-me‘zal* — He wants to go.

Note: Can also mean 'ask' or 'pray'. Third-aleph weak root.

š-b-y ܫܒܝ — wish / will / be pleased

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: šābē ܫܒܝ

Example: ܫܒܝ ܠܡܩܬܐ *šābē l-meqtal* — He wishes to kill.

Note: Related noun šebyānā (will/wish) is key theological vocabulary.

p-q-d ܦܩܕ — command / order

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: paqed ܦܩܕ

Example: ܦܩܕ ܠܡܥܠ ܦܩܕ *paqed l-me‘sar* — He commanded to bind (him).

Note: Often takes a direct object (the recipient of the order) + l- + infinitive.

š-d-r ܫܕܪ — send

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: šadar ܫܕܪ

Example: שָׁדַר אֶנְשֵׁי לִמְוֶת *šadar 'enāšē l-meqtal* — He sent men to kill.

Note: The l-+infinitive here expresses purpose: 'sent in order to kill'.

SECTION 5: MILITARY AND EMOTIONAL VOCABULARY — 30 WORDS

This vocabulary set is essential for the narrative of Lesson 9. Many of these words appear in the story and exercises. Learn both the verbal root and its noun/adjective derivatives.

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
<i>m-ḥ-y</i>	ܡܚܝ	<i>mḥā / nemḥē</i>	strike, smite, hit
<i>d-ḥ-l</i>	ܕܚܠ	<i>dḥel / nedḥal</i>	fear, be afraid
<i>ḥ-d-y</i>	ܚܕܝ	<i>ḥdī / neḥdē</i>	rejoice, be glad
<i>’-s-r</i>	ܐܨܪ	<i>’asar / ne ’sor</i>	bind, tie, imprison
<i>š-r-y</i>	ܫܪܝ	<i>šrā / nešrē</i>	loosen, release, begin
<i>r-m-y</i>	ܪܡܝ	<i>rmā / nerme</i>	throw, cast
<i>’-ḥ-d</i>	ܐܚܕ	<i>’ḥad / ne ’ḥod</i>	seize, grab, take hold
<i>g-r-r</i>	ܓܪܪ	<i>grār / negror</i>	drag, pull
<i>’-r-q</i>	ܪܩ	<i>’raq / ne ’roq</i>	flee, escape
<i>r-d-p</i>	ܪܕܦ	<i>rdap / nerdop</i>	pursue, chase, persecute
<i>q-t-l</i>	ܩܬܠ	<i>qṭal / neqtol</i>	kill, slay
<i>p-ṣ-’</i>	ܦܨܐ	<i>pṣā’ / nepsa’</i>	wound, injure
<i>z-’-q</i>	ܐܨܩ	<i>z’aq / nez’oq</i>	cry out, shout
<i>p-q-d</i>	ܦܩܕ	<i>pqad / nepqod</i>	command, order
<i>k-n-š</i>	ܕܢܫܐ	<i>knaš / neksnoš</i>	gather, assemble
<i>estrātyōtā</i>	ܐܬܪܬܝܘܬܐ	<i>estrātyōtā</i>	soldier (Greek loanword: <i>στρατιώτης</i>)
<i>ḥaylā</i>	ܫܠܐ	<i>ḥaylā</i>	army; strength, power (dual meaning)
<i>saypā</i>	ܫܦܐ	<i>saypā</i>	sword
<i>nūrā</i>	ܢܘܪܐ	<i>nūrā</i>	fire
<i>’attūnā</i>	ܐܬܘܢܐ	<i>’attūnā</i>	furnace, oven
<i>šalšaltā</i>	ܫܠܬܬܐ	<i>šalšaltā</i>	chain (related to Heb. <i>תלשלת</i>)
<i>gūbbā</i>	ܕܒܒܐ	<i>gūbbā</i>	pit, cistern; den (as in lion's den)
<i>bēt-’sīrē</i>	ܒܝܬܐ ܫܝܪܐ	<i>bēt-’sīrē</i>	prison (lit. 'house of the bound ones')
<i>kansā</i>	ܕܢܫܐ	<i>kansā</i>	crowd, gathering, assembly
<i>qālā</i>	ܩܠܐ	<i>qālā</i>	voice, sound
<i>rugzā</i>	ܪܓܝܐ	<i>rugzā</i>	anger, wrath

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
<i>deḥltā</i>	דחל	<i>deḥltā</i>	fear (noun; from d-ḥ-l)
<i>’ammīnūttā</i>	אמין	<i>’ammīnūttā</i>	steadfastness, courage, endurance
<i>pūqdānā</i>	פקד	<i>pūqdānā</i>	command, commandment (noun from p-q-d)
<i>ṣebyānā</i>	שכח	<i>ṣebyānā</i>	will, wish, desire (key theological term)

SECTION 6: THE STORY — PART 9

The King Commands: Seize Yukhannan

The narrative reaches a climax. Having heard reports of Yukhannan's preaching and miracles, the king summons his soldiers and issues a series of direct commands. The passage is rich in imperatives and *l-* + infinitive constructions, giving you immediate practice in the new grammar.

Full Syriac Text with Interlinear Gloss:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
מלכא דנא כד שמע מלל מלל	<i>malkā den kad šma ‘ mallē hālēn</i>	the.king now when he.heard words these	Now when the king heard these words,
אחמל כד חמל אחמל כד חמל	<i>’etmalī b-rugzā w- z ‘aq b-qālā rabbā</i>	he.was.filled with- anger and- he.cried.out with- voice great	he was filled with anger and cried out with a great voice.
פסד לכחלל מלל	<i>paqed l- estrātyōtāw(hy)</i>	he.commanded to- his.soldiers	He commanded his soldiers,
אולא אסאדא לנאס	<i>’ezlaw w- ’eḥodw l- Yukhannan</i>	go.pl! and seize.pl! Yukhannan (obj.)	"Go and seize Yukhannan!"
אחמל אסאדא אחמל אסאדא	<i>w- ’atīw w- ’armōhy b- ’attūnā</i>	and-come.pl! and- throw.him! in- the.furnace	Come and throw him into the furnace!
לחלל מלל אחמל מלל	<i>lā tedhlūn men ’āttāw(hy)</i>	not you.fear.pl from signs-his	Do not fear his signs!"
אחמל מלל לחלל מלל	<i>estrātyōtē šarīw l- me ’zal</i>	soldiers they.began to.go	The soldiers began to go.
אחמל מלל לחמל מלל	<i>bā ‘ē ḥad mennhon l-mehpak</i>	wanted one from- them to.turn.back	One of them wanted to turn back.
אחמל מלל לחמל מלל	<i>’emar: lā yākelnan l-meqtal zaddīqā</i>	he.said not we.are.able to.kill righteous.man	He said: 'We are not able to kill a righteous man.'
אחמל מלל אחמל מלל	<i>’aḥrānē ’asrw ’īdāw(hy) b- šalšaltā</i>	others they.bound hands-his with- chain	Others bound his hands with a chain.
אחמל מלל אחמל מלל	<i>w-grarwōhy lawāt ’attūnā</i>	and- they.dragged.him toward furnace	And they dragged him toward the furnace.
אחמל מלל אחמל מלל	<i>Yukhannan dēn lā dḥal ’ellā šallī</i>	Yukhannan but not he.feared but he.prayed	But Yukhannan did not fear; instead he prayed.

Smooth English Translation:

Now when the king heard these words, he was filled with anger and cried out with a great voice. He commanded his soldiers: "Go and seize Yuhannan! Come and throw him into the furnace! Do not fear his signs!" The soldiers began to go. One of them wanted to turn back. He said: "We are not able to kill a righteous man." Others bound his hands with a chain and dragged him toward the furnace. But Yuhannan did not fear; instead he prayed.

SECTION 7: EXERCISES**Exercise 1: Imperative Paradigm**

Write out all four imperative forms (msg, fsg, mpl, fpl) for each of the following roots in the Peal stem. Include Estrangela script and transliteration.

1. ' **-z-l** (go) — Peal imperfect 2msg: tēzal → imperative: ?
2. ' **-b-d** (do, make) — Peal imperfect 2msg: te ' bod → imperative: ?
3. **q-r-** ' (read, call) — Peal imperfect 2msg: teqrā → imperative: ?

Exercise 2: Infinitive Formation

Form the Peal, Paael, and Aphel infinitives for each root. Use the pattern:

Peal = meCCaC; Paael = mCāCāCū; Aphel = ' aCCāCū.

1. n-p-q (go out)
2. q-b-l (receive)
3. š-d-r (send)
4. ḥ-z-y (see)
5. ' -l-l (enter)

6. y-l-d (give birth)

7. r-ḥ-m (have mercy)

8. s-g-d (worship)

Exercise 3: Translation — Syriac to English

Translate each sentence into English. Identify any imperatives and l-+infinitive constructions.

1. ܐܘܠ ܕܝܠܕܝܢܐ

2. ܐܡܪ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܐܠܡܐ

3. ܠܐ ܕܝܠܕܝܢܐ

4. ܐܝܬܐ ܠܡܡܪܐ ܕܡܪܝܬܐ

5. ܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܡܪܐ ܕܡܡܪܐ

6. ܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܡܪܐ ܕܡܡܪܐ

7. ܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܡܪܐ ܕܡܡܪܐ

8. ܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܡܪܐ ܕܡܡܪܐ

Exercise 4: Production — English to Syriac

Express each sentence in Syriac. Use Estrangela script and transliteration.

1. Hear me, O king! (m.sg.)

2. Do not kill the righteous man! (m.pl.)

3. He began to pray.

4. The soldier is not able to flee.

5. The king commanded to throw him into the furnace.

6. She wants to read the book.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read the story in Section 6 and answer the following questions in English.

1. Why did the king fill with anger?
2. What two commands did the king give his soldiers?
3. What did one soldier say? Why was he reluctant?
4. How was Yukhannan restrained before being brought to the furnace?
5. How did Yukhannan respond to his situation?

SECTION 8: ANSWER KEY

Exercise 1: Imperative Paradigm

’-z-l (go):

- msg: ’ezal עזל
- fsg: ’ezlī עזלי
- mpl: ’ezlaw עזלו
- fpl: ’ezlān עזלן

‘-b-d (do):

- msg: ‘bod בוד
- fsg: ‘bodī, בודי

- mpl: ' bodw **חבד**

- fpl: ' bodān **חבדו**

q-r- ' (read/call):

- msg: qrī **קרי**, **קרי** (III-aleph/yod: vowel changes)

- fsg: qrīy **קרי**

- mpl: qrīw **קרי**

- fpl: qrīn **קרי**

Exercise 2: Infinitive Formation (selected answers)

n-p-q: Peal meppaq **מפיק**; Paael mnapāqū **מנפיקו**; Aphel ' appāqū **מפיקו**

š-d-r: Peal mešdar **משדר**; Paael mšadrū **משדרו**; Aphel ' ašdrū **משדרו**

y-l-d: Peal mīlad **מליד**; Paael myāladū **מלידו**; Aphel ' auldū **מלידו**

Exercise 3: Translation

1. Go to Jerusalem!
2. Hear the voice of God! (to a woman)
3. Do not cry out! (m.pl.)
4. He began to read the book.
5. The king wanted to bind Yuxhannan.
6. God is able to strike the soldiers.
7. He commanded them to throw (him) into the furnace.

8. Yukhannan wished to pray.

Exercise 4: Production

1. שְׁמַ' נִי מַלְכָּה šma ' nī malkā
2. לֹא תִקְלֹן לִזְדִּיקָה lā teqtlūn l-zaddīqā
3. שָׂרִי לִמְשָׁלָה šarī l-mešlā
4. אֶסְרָתְּךָ לֹא יֵאָכֵל לִמְרָק estrātyōṭā lā yākel l-me ' raq
5. פָּקַד מַלְכָּה לִמְרֵמְיָהּ לֵה בִּזְנוּתָהּ paqed malkā l-mermyū leh b-
' attūnā
6. בָּאָה לִמְעֻרָּה בַּת יָהּ bā ' yā l-meqrā ketābā

Exercise 5: Comprehension

1. He heard the words (reports) about Yukhannan and was filled with anger.
2. (1) Seize Yukhannan; (2) throw him into the furnace.
3. One soldier said they were not able to kill a righteous man — showing moral hesitation.
4. They bound his hands with a chain and dragged him toward the furnace.
5. Yukhannan did not fear; he prayed instead.

SECTION 9: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY BOX

The Imperative at a Glance

FORM	ENDING	EXAMPLE (K-T-B)	ESTRANGELA
Masculine Singular	CCoC (bare stem)	ktob	כתוב
Feminine Singular	CCoC + ī	ktobī	כתובי
Masculine Plural	CCoC + w	ktobw	כתובו
Feminine Plural	CCoC + ān	ktobān	כתובנה

Infinitive Patterns

STEM	PATTERN	EXAMPLE	NOTES
Peal	meCCaC	mektab כתוב	Most common; parallel to Hebrew inf. construct with l-
Paael	mCāCāCū	mbarrākū מברך	Double middle radical characteristic
Aphel	'aCCāCū	'appāqū אפקע	'a- prefix as in the Aphel perfect

The l- + Infinitive Construction

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Quick Reference |

MAIN VERB + l- + INFINITIVE = 'to [do X]' |

šarī l-mektab = He began to write |

yākel l-mešma' = He is able to hear |

bā' ē l-me' zal = He wants to go |

paqed l-me' sar = He commanded to bind |

NEGATIVE: lā + IMPERFECT (not imperative!) for prohibitions |

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Section 11: Additional Vocabulary

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 30 terms.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
ܩܪܝܬܐ	qritā	f	village
ܠܫܢܐ	leššānā	m	tongue, language
ܩܪܡܐ	garmā	m	bone
ܩܦܐ	kēpā	f	stone, rock
ܡܝܝܐ	mayyā	m.pl	water
ܢܘܢܐ	nūnā	m	fish
ܡܕܝܬܐ	mdittā	f	city
ܫܡܫܐ	šemšā	m	sun
ܬܪܐ	tar'ā	m	door, gate
ܡܝܫܬܐ	mešhā	m	oil

LESSON 10: THE PASSIVE VOICE

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 1–9

Lesson 9 introduced the **imperative** (direct commands), the **infinitive** (verbal noun / maṣdar), and the **l- + infinitive construction** for expressing purpose, ability, desire, and obligation. Before proceeding, confirm you can recall the following:

- **Imperative formation:** Peal msg = CCoC; fsG = CCoC+ī; mpl = CCoC+w; fpl = CCoC+ān
- **Negative commands:** lā + imperfect (never imperative)
- **Infinitive:** Peal = meCCaC; Paael = mCāCāCū; Aphel = 'aCCāCū
- **Semi-modals:** šarī, yākel, bā ' ē, šābē, paqed, šadar — all govern l- + infinitive

Warm-Up Drill: Five Quick Questions

Answer in Syriac (Estrangela + transliteration).

#	QUESTION	EXPECTED ANSWER	SYRIAC
1	Give the Peal imperative .msg of ' -z-l (go)	'ezal — go!	ܐܝܠ
2	How do you say 'Do not ?kill!' (m.pl.)	lā teqtlūn	ܠܐ ܬܩܬܠܘܢ
3	What is the Peal ?infinitive of q-t-l (kill)	meqtal	ܡܩܬܠ
4	-Translate: šarī l .mešma '.	He began to hear.	ܫܪܝ ܠܡܥܫܡܐ
5	What does pūqdānā ?mean	commandment, command (noun from p- q-d)	ܩܕܡܢܐ

SECTION 2: THE PASSIVE/REFLEXIVE STEMS — OVERVIEW

2.1 The Principle of Passive Formation in Syriac

In Syriac, the passive voice is not expressed by auxiliary verbs (as in English: 'is killed', 'was written') but by a separate, **inflected stem** built from the active stem by means of a characteristic prefix: ' **Et-** or **Et-**. These are called the **Et-stems**. Each active stem has a corresponding Et-stem that functions as its passive or reflexive counterpart.

Students of Hebrew will recognise an analogy with the **Niphal** (נִפְעַל, passive of Qal) and **Hitpael** (הִתְפַּעֵל, reflexive of Piel). Arabists will recognise the parallel with **Forms V, VI, VII, and VIII**: the tā' -prefixed (تَفَعَّلَ) and n-prefixed (انْفَعَلَ) passives/reflexives. In Greek, the same **passive voice** forms (e.g., παίδεύομαι) serve the function. Latin uses separate passive endings (-or, -ris, -tur etc.).

2.2 The Three Et-Stems

ET-STEM NAME	ACTIVE COUNTERPART	PREFIX	MEANING / FUNCTION
Ethpeel ܐܬܦܥܠ	Peal	'et-	Passive or reflexive of Peal: 'to be killed', 'to wash oneself'
Etpaael ܐܬܦܥܠ	Paael	'etpa-	Passive or reflexive of Paael: 'to be blessed', 'to be sanctified'
Ettaphal ܐܬܦܥܠ	Aphel	'etta-	Passive of Aphel (causative): 'to be saved', 'to be sent'

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Cross-Linguistic Summary: Passive Formation |

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Syriac Ethpeel: 'et- + Peal root → parallel to Hebrew Niphal / |

Hitpael |

|

Syriac Etpaael: 'etpa- + Paael → parallel to Arabic Form V تَفَعَّلَ |

|

Syriac Ettaphal: 'etta- + Aphel → parallel to Arabic Form VII **إِنْفَعَلَ** |

|

Greek: active + passive endings (same paradigm structure, different | endings) |

|

Latin: active vs. passive endings (-o/-or, -s/-ris, -t/-tur etc.) |

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SECTION 3: THE ETHPEEL STEM

3.1 Formation of the Ethpeel

The Ethpeel is formed by prefixing 'et- to the Peal root. The perfect stem is 'etCCeC. The participial form, which is very common, is metCCeC. In texts, the prefix may appear as 'et- or 'it- depending on dialect and vowelling.

Example: Root q-t-l (kill) → Ethpeel perfect: 'etqtel ܩܬܠܐ 'he was killed'; Participle: metqtel ܩܬܠܐ 'being killed'

3.2 Phonological Rules — Assimilation and Metathesis

When the Peal root begins with certain consonants, the t of the 'et- prefix undergoes phonological changes:

- **Before sibilants (z, s, š, ṣ): Metathesis** — the t and the sibilant swap positions. E.g., š-m- ' → 'et-šma ' becomes 'eš-t-ma ' ܫܡܬܐ 'it was heard'; similarly 'et-z ' aq → 'ez-t- ' aq
- **Before dental/emphatic consonants (d, ṭ): Assimilation** — the t assimilates to the following consonant. E.g., d-k-y → 'et-dky becomes 'ed-dky (with doubling), sometimes written without the doubled letter.

- Before all other consonants: No change — e.g., q-t-l → 'etqtel; k-t-b → 'etkatteb

3.3 Full Paradigm: Ethpeel of q-t-l (be killed)

Perfect (all 10 forms):

PERSON / NUMBER / GENDER	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
3msg	ሃዎሐደ	'etqtel	he was killed
3fsg	ሐሃዎሐደ	'etqtelat	she was killed
2msg	ሐሃዎሐደ	'etqtelt	you (m.sg.) were killed
2fsg	ሐሃዎሐደ	'etqteltī	you (f.sg.) were killed
1sg	ሐሃዎሐደ	'etqtelet	I was killed
3mpl	ሐሃዎሐደ	'etqtelw	they (m.) were killed
3fpl	ሃዎሐደ	'etqtel(n)	they (f.) were killed
2mpl	ሐሃዎሐደ	'etqteltūn	you (m.pl.) were killed
2fpl	ሐሃዎሐደ	'etqteltēn	you (f.pl.) were killed
1pl	ሃዎሐደ	'etqtelan	we were killed

Participial Forms (Ethpeel Participle of q-t-l):

FORM	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
Active Participle m.sg.	ሚታፀክ	metqṭel	being killed (m.sg.)
Active Participle f.sg.	ሚታፀኪ	metqṭelā	being killed (f.sg.)
Active Participle m.pl.	ሚታፀኩ	metqṭelīn	being killed (m.pl.)
Active Participle f.pl.	ሚታፀኩ	metqṭelān	being killed (f.pl.)

SECTION 4: THE ETTAPHAL AND ETPAAEL STEMS

4.1 The Ettaphal — Passive of the Aphel

The **Ettaphal** is the passive counterpart of the Aphel (causative) stem. Its formation inserts 'etta-' before the root. Since the Aphel adds the causative meaning ('to cause to X'), the Ettaphal means '**to be caused to X**' — i.e., the passive of a causative, as in 'to be saved' (from 'to save'), 'to be sent' (from 'to send').

Example 1: Root ḥ-y-y / Aphel 'aḥyī (save/give life) → Ettaphal: 'eṭḥayyī
ሠጠኝ 'he was saved / given life'

Example 2: Root š-d-r / Aphel 'ašdar (send) → Ettaphal: 'ešṭadar
ገጠኝ 'he was sent'

Example 3: Root ' -q-m / Aphel 'aqīm (raise up) → Ettaphal: 'ettaqam
ጠፀኝ 'he was raised up'

Full Paradigm — Ettaphal Perfect of š-d-r (be sent):

PERSON / N / G	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
3msg	ሰገረ	'eštadar	he was sent
3fsg	ሰገረት	'eštadrat	she was sent
2msg	ሰገረህ	'eštadart	you (m.sg.) were sent
1sg	ሰገረኝ	'eštaderet	I was sent
3mpl	ሰገረው	'eštadarw	they (m.) were sent
1pl	ሰገረን	'eštadaran	we were sent

4.2 The Etpaael — Passive/Reflexive of the Paael

The **Etpaael** is the passive or reflexive of the Paael (intensive/causative) stem. Its prefix is **'etpa-**. Since the Paael often carries intensive meaning ('to bless greatly', 'to teach'), the Etpaael means **'to be blessed', 'to be taught', 'to be sanctified'**. It can also be reflexive ('to sanctify oneself').

Example 1: Root b-r-k / Paael barrek (bless) → Etpaael: **'etbarrak**

ሰገረ 'he was blessed'

Example 2: Root y-l-p / Paael yallep (teach) → Etpaael: **'etyallap** ሰገረ

'he was taught / he learned'

Example 3: Root q-d-š / Paael qaddeš (sanctify) → Etpaael: **'etqaddaš**

ሰገረ 'he was sanctified / he sanctified himself'

Full Paradigm — Etpaael Perfect of b-r-k (be blessed):

PERSON / N / G	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
3msg	אֲבָרַךְ	'etbarrak	he was blessed
3fsg	אֲבָרַכְתְּ	'etbarkat	she was blessed
2msg	אֲבָרַכְתָּ	'etbarkart	you (m.sg.) were blessed
1sg	אֲבָרַכְתִּי	'etbarkaret	I was blessed
3mpl	אֲבָרַכּוּ	'etbarkaw	they were blessed
1pl	אֲבָרַכְנוּ	'etbarkan	we were blessed

SECTION 5: THE PASSIVE PARTICIPLE (PEAL)**5.1 Form and Usage**

Distinct from the Ethpeel, the **Peal passive participle** is a simple adjectival form expressing a **completed passive state**: 'written' (ktīb), 'killed' (qṭīl), 'bound' (' sīr). Its pattern is **CāCoC** or in vocalized manuscripts **CCīC**. It agrees in gender and number with its noun, like any adjective. It is often used in **verbless clauses** with a predicative function: *gawrā qṭīlā* אִישׁ קָטִיל = 'the man is killed / the killed man'.

Students of Arabic will recognise the **passive participle (ism al-maf'ūl)**: *مَقْتُول* maqtūl 'killed', *مَكْتُوب* maktūb 'written'. The Hebrew equivalent is *qāṭūl*: קָטִיל. The pattern is strikingly consistent across Semitic languages.

5.2 Passive Participles — Ten Key Verbs

ROOT	ESTRANGELA (M.S.G.)	TRANSLIT. (M.S.G.)	ESTRANGELA (F.S.G.)	ENGLISH MEANING
<i>k-t-b</i>	כתב	<i>ktīb</i>	כתובה <i>ktībtā</i>	written
<i>q-t-l</i>	قتל	<i>qṭīl</i>	قتולה <i>qṭīltā</i>	killed, slain
<i>'-s-r</i>	שרס	<i>'sīr</i>	שרסו <i>'sīrtā</i>	bound, imprisoned
<i>š-r-y</i>	שרי	<i>šrī</i>	שרייה <i>šrīyā</i>	loosed, released
<i>š-d-r</i>	שרד	<i>šdīr</i>	שרדו <i>šdīrtā</i>	sent
<i>p-q-d</i>	פקד	<i>pqīd</i>	פקדו <i>pqīdtā</i>	commanded; commandment (noun)
<i>'-m-d</i>	מדם	<i>'mīd</i>	מדםו <i>'mīdtā</i>	baptized (lit. 'dipped')
<i>š-l-b</i>	שלב	<i>šlīb</i>	שלבנו <i>šlībtā</i>	crucified; also: the cross
<i>q-b-r</i>	קבר	<i>qbīr</i>	קברו <i>qbīrtā</i>	buried
<i>b-r-k</i>	ברך	<i>brīk</i>	ברכתו <i>brīktā</i>	blessed (adj.)

5.3 Passive Participle in Verbless Clauses

Examples of the passive participle used predicatively in verbless clauses:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܩܬܝܠܐ ܕܥܡܪܐ	<i>gawrā qṭilā</i>	man.the killed.m.sg	The man is killed.
ܥܡܪܐ ܕܝܫܘܥ	<i>Yukhannan 'sīr</i>	Yukhannan bound	Yukhannan is bound.
ܕܠܝܒܐ ܕܟܬܝܒܐ ܕܩܘܫܬܐ	<i>ketābā ktīb b-qūštā</i>	book.the written in- truth	The book is written in truth.
ܡܫܝܚܐ ܕܒܪܝܬܐ ܕܠܠܗ	<i>Mšiḥā brīk l- 'ālam</i>	Messiah.the blessed forever	The Messiah is blessed forever.

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY — 30 WORDS (PASSIVE FOCUS)

These 30 words are central to Lesson 10 and to Syriac Christian literature generally. Each entry includes the basic (Peal) root, an Et-stem form where relevant, and the English meaning. Many are important theological terms.

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
'-m-d	ܡܕܝܬܐ / ܡܕ	'mad / 'et 'med	baptize / to be baptized (dip, immerse)
g-l-y	ܓܠܝܬܐ / ܓܠ	glā / 'etglī	reveal / to be revealed, appear
h-y-y / Aph.	ܚܝܝܬܐ / ܚܝ	'ahyī / 'ethayyī	save, give life / to be saved
q-t-l	ܩܬܠܬܐ / ܩܬ	qṭal / 'etqṭel	kill / to be killed
'-s-r	ܫܪܝܬܐ / ܫܪ	'asar / 'et 'eser	bind / to be bound
š-r-y	ܫܪܝܬܐ / ܫܪ	šrā / 'etšrī	loosen / to be loosed, released
š-d-r	ܫܕܪܬܐ / ܫܕܪ	šadar / 'eštadar	send / to be sent (Ettaphal)
'-s-y	ܫܪܝܬܐ / ܫܪ	'asī / 'et 'asī	heal / to be healed
q-w-m / Aph.	ܩܘܡܬܐ / ܩܘܡ	'aqīm / 'ettaqam	raise up / to be raised (Ettaphal)
k-n-š	ܩܢܫܬܐ / ܩܢ	knaš / 'etkneš	gather / to be gathered
d-k-y	ܕܩܝܬܐ / ܕܩ	dkā / 'etdkī	purify / to be purified
š-b-q	ܫܒܩܬܐ / ܫܒ	šbaq / 'etšbaq	forgive, leave / to be forgiven
b-r-k	ܒܪܟܬܐ / ܒܪ	barrek / 'etbarrak	bless (Paael) / to be blessed (Etpaael)
y-l-p	ܝܠܦܬܐ / ܝܠ	yallep / 'etyallap	teach (Paael) / to be taught (Etpaael)
m-š-ḥ	ܡܫܚܬܐ / ܡܫ	mšah / 'etmšah	anoint / to be anointed
š-l-b	ܫܠܒܬܐ / ܫܠ	šlab / 'etšlab	crucify / to be crucified
q-b-r	ܩܒܪܬܐ / ܩܒ	qbar / 'etqbar	bury / to be buried
d-w-n / Aph.	ܕܠܩܝܬܐ / ܕܠ	'addīn / 'ettaddīn	judge / to be judged (Ettaphal)
h-y-b	ܚܝܒܬܐ / ܚܝ	hayyeb / 'ethayyab	condemn, make guilty / to be condemned
p-r-q	ܦܪܩܬܐ / ܦܪ	praq / 'etpraq	redeem, save / to be redeemed
k-l-l	ܟܠܠܬܐ / ܟܠ	kallel / 'etkallal	crown / to be crowned
r-w-m / Aph.	ܪܘܡܬܐ / ܪܘܡ	'arīm / 'etrīm	exalt / to be exalted
š-p-l	ܫܦܠܬܐ / ܫܦ	špel / 'etšpal	humiliate / to be humbled
t-r-d	ܬܪܕܬܐ / ܬܪ	trad / 'ettrad	cast out, expel / to be cast out

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
'-w-d / <i>Aph.</i>	אָדָּר, אָדָּר	' <i>awdī</i>	confess, give thanks (<i>Aphel</i>)
<i>t-w-b</i>	בָּחַל / בָּחַל	<i>tāb / tāyib</i>	return, repent; repentant (participle)
<i>y-l-d</i>	יָלַד / יָלַד	<i>yled / 'etyled</i>	give birth / to be born (<i>Ethpeel</i>)
<i>n-h-r / <i>Aph.</i></i>	הִנְחִיחַ / הִנְחִיחַ	' <i>anhar / 'etnahar</i>	illuminate / to be illumined, enlightened
<i>m-l-y</i>	מָלֵא / מָלֵא	<i>mlā / 'etmlī</i>	fill / to be filled
<i>p-r-š / <i>Aph.</i></i>	פָּרַשׁ / פָּרַשׁ	' <i>aprash / 'etpraš</i>	separate, distinguish / to be separated
'-h-d	הִחַד / הִחַד	' <i>aḥad / 'et 'aḥed</i>	unite / to be united
<i>ḥ-l-m</i>	חָלַם / חָלַם	<i>ḥelam / 'etḥelam</i>	dream / to be dreamed

SECTION 7: THE STORY — PART 10

Yukhannan Is Thrown into the Fire — and Saved

The narrative continues from Lesson 9. Yukhannan has been bound and dragged to the furnace. Now the passive voice dominates the story: things happen *to* Yukhannan — he is thrown, he is saved, the miracle is revealed to the city. The story showcases *Ethpeel*, *Ettaphal*, and passive participle forms throughout.

Full Syriac Text with Interlinear Gloss:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
וּכְחַנָּן נִשְׁלַח בְּאֵתֵּן כִּנּוֹר	w- 'etremy Yukhannan b- 'attūnā	and-was.thrown Yukhannan into- furnace	And Yukhannan was thrown into the furnace.
וְכִנּוֹר לֹא שָׁבַח לֵה	w-nūrā lā qrebet leh	and-fire.the not it.approached to.him	But the fire did not approach him.
כַּדְּאֵי וְכִנּוֹר חַבְרָא וְחַבְרָא	'ayk d- 'et 'bed 'am Ḥananyā w- ḥabrāw(hy)	as that-was.done with Hananiah and- companions-his	Just as it was done with Hananiah and his companions.
וְכִנּוֹר נִשְׁלַח בְּאֵתֵּן כִּנּוֹר	'ethzī gēr gabrā d- nūr b-gaw 'attūnā	was.seen for man of.fire in-midst furnace.the	For a man of fire was seen in the midst of the furnace.
וְכִנּוֹר נִשְׁלַח בְּאֵתֵּן כִּנּוֹר	w-Yukhannan 'etnahar men nūhreh	and-Yukhannan was.illuminated from light-his	And Yukhannan was illuminated by his light.
וְכִנּוֹר נִשְׁלַח בְּאֵתֵּן כִּנּוֹר	w-kad nepaq 'ethzī paršūpeh 'ayk šemšā	and-when he.went.out was.seen face-his like sun	And when he came out, his face was seen like the sun.
כָּל הָעָם נִשְׁלַח בְּאֵתֵּן כִּנּוֹר	kulleh kansā 'etknaš d-nehzē	all crowd.the was.gathered to.see	All the crowd was gathered to see.
וְכִנּוֹר נִשְׁלַח בְּאֵתֵּן כִּנּוֹר	w-rabbā 'attā 'etyāde ' b-kulleh mdīntā	and-great sign was.made.known in- all city.the	And the great sign was made known in all the city.
וְכִנּוֹר נִשְׁלַח בְּאֵתֵּן כִּנּוֹר	saggī 'ē dḥelw w- 'etpanīw	many they.feared and- they.turned.back	Many feared and repented.
וְכִנּוֹר נִשְׁלַח בְּאֵתֵּן כִּנּוֹר	w- 'āmryn: brīk hū 'Alāhā d- Yukhannan	and-they.say: blessed is God of- Yukhannan	And they said: 'Blessed is the God of Yukhannan!'

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܐܢܬܝܬܐ ܕܝܚܢܢܐ ܕܝܚܢܢܐ ܕܝܚܢܢܐ ܕܝܚܢܢܐ	w-Yukhannan 'etpraq men 'īdī ba 'eldabbāw(hy)	and-Yukhannan was.redeemed from hands.of enemies-his	And Yukhannan was saved from the hands of his enemies.
ܐܢܬܝܬܐ ܕܝܚܢܢܐ ܕܝܚܢܢܐ	w-šubhā 'etyahab l- 'Alāhā	and-glory was.given to-God	And glory was given to God.

Smooth English Translation:

And Yukhannan was thrown into the furnace. But the fire did not approach him — just as it was done with Hananiah and his companions. For a man of fire was seen in the midst of the furnace, and Yukhannan was illumined by his light. When he came out, his face was seen like the sun. All the crowd was gathered to see. And the great sign was made known in all the city. Many feared and repented. And they said: 'Blessed is the God of Yukhannan!' And Yukhannan was saved from the hands of his enemies, and glory was given to God.

Biblical Allusion: The reference to Ḥananyā and his companions (Hananiah/Shadrach — cf. Dan 3) is intentional. This is a common hagiographic motif in Syriac martyr literature: the saint re-enacts biblical miracles.

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Stem Identification

Identify the stem of each verb form (Peal, Paael, Aphel, Ethpeel, Etpaael, or Ettaphal) and give its basic meaning.

1. 'etqtel ܐܬܩܬܠ

2. 'etbarrak ܐܬܒܪܟ

3. 'eštadar ܐܬܕܪ

4. metqtel ܡܬܩܬܠ

5. 'etpraq ܐܬܦܪܩ
6. 'et' med ܐܬܡܝܕ
7. 'ettaqam ܐܬܩܡ
8. brīk ܒܪܝܬ
9. 'etnahar ܐܬܢܗܪ
10. 'etmšah ܐܬܡܫܗ
11. 'etyallap ܐܬܝܠܠܦ
12. 'etmšah ܐܬܡܫܗ

Exercise 2: Active to Passive Transformation

Rewrite each active sentence in the passive voice using the appropriate Et-stem. Adjust agreement as needed.

1. malkā qṭal l-gawrā — the king killed the man.
2. kāhnā barrek l- ' ammā — the priest blessed the people.
3. šadar malkā estrāṭyōṭā — the king sent the soldiers.
4. ' Ayī ' aḥyī l-ḥalīšā — the healer saved the weak man.
5. yallep rabbā tlāmīdē — the teacher taught the disciples.
6. ' aqīm l- ' mītā — he raised the dead man.

Exercise 3: Translation — Syriac to English

Translate each sentence into smooth English.

1. ܠܥܠܡ ܕܐܝܬܐ

1. אהרן מן תלדיה
2. אהרן מן תלדיה
3. אהרן מן תלדיה
4. אהרן מן תלדיה
5. אהרן מן תלדיה
6. אהרן מן תלדיה
7. אהרן מן תלדיה
8. אהרן מן תלדיה

Exercise 4: Production — English to Syriac

Write each sentence in Syriac (Estrangela + transliteration).

1. He was baptized in the river.
2. The soldiers were sent to the city.
3. The dead man was raised.
4. She was healed by the saint.
5. The word of God was heard in all the land.
6. He was crowned by the king.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read the story in Section 7 and answer the following questions in English.

1. What happened when Yukhannan was thrown into the furnace?
2. What was the biblical parallel mentioned in the story?

3. What was seen in the midst of the furnace?
4. How did the people of the city respond to the miracle?
5. What phrase do the people use to glorify God? Translate it word for word.

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Exercise 1: Stem Identification

1. 'etq̄tel — Ethpeel (passive of Peal) — 'he was killed'
2. 'etbarrak — Etpaael (passive/reflexive of Paael) — 'he was blessed'
3. 'eštadar — Ettaphal (passive of Aphel) — 'he was sent'; note metathesis of t after š
4. metq̄tel — Ethpeel participle — 'being killed'
5. 'etpraq — Ethpeel — 'he was redeemed/saved'
6. 'et' med — Ethpeel — 'he was baptized'
7. 'ettaqam — Ettaphal (passive of Aphel 'aqīm) — 'he was raised'
8. brīk — Peal passive participle — 'blessed' (adjective)
9. 'etnahar — Ettaphal or Ethpeel (depending on analysis of root) — 'he was illumined'
10. 'etmšah — Ethpeel — 'he was anointed'
11. 'etyallap — Etpaael (passive of Paael yallep) — 'he was taught / he learned'
12. (Same as #10 — intentional duplicate for review; answer same)

Exercise 2: Active to Passive

1. 'etq̄tel gawrā (l-malkā) — The man was killed (by the king).
2. 'etbarrak 'ammā (l-kāhnā) — The people were blessed (by the priest).
3. 'eštadrw estrātyōṭā — The soldiers were sent.
4. 'eṭhayyī ḥališā — The weak man was saved.
5. 'etyalpw tlāmīdē — The disciples were taught.
6. 'ettaqam 'mītā — The dead man was raised.

Exercise 3: Translation

1. He was thrown into the fire.
2. He was saved/redeemed from (his) enemies.
3. The light was revealed in the darkness.
4. The crowd was gathered in the city.
5. The Messiah was crucified and buried.
6. The Son of God was born.
7. He is killed / he was killed on account of our sins.
8. His voice was heard in every place.

Exercise 4: Production (sample answers)

1. אֶת־מֶד בְּנַהְרָא 'et 'med b-nahrā
2. אֶשְׁתַּדְרַו עֲסֻרָתְיֹוֹתַי לַמְּדִינָה 'eštadrw estrātyōṭē l-mdīntā

3. ܐܬܩܡ ܡܝܬܐ ' ettaqam mītā
4. ܐܬܐܣܝܬ ܡܢ ܩܕܕܝܫܐ ' et ' asīt men qaddīšā (f.)
5. ܐܬܡܬܐ ܕܠܐܠܗܐ ܒܠܐܝܬܐ ' eštma ' maltā d- ' Alāhā
b-kullā ar ' ā
6. ܐܬܟܠܐ ܡܢ ܡܠܟܐ ' etkallal men malkā

Exercise 5: Comprehension

1. The fire did not approach him — he was unharmed.
2. Hananiah (Shadrach) and his companions in the fiery furnace (Daniel 3).
3. A man of fire (an angelic figure) was seen in the midst of the furnace.
4. Many feared and repented, and said 'Blessed is the God of Yuxhannan!'
5. 'Brīk hū ' Alāhā d-Yuxhannan' — Blessed (is) he, the God of Yuxhannan. Word-for-word: brīk = blessed; hū = he (is); ' Alāhā = God.the; d- = of; Yuxhannan = Yuxhannan.

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY BOX

Complete Table of All Six Syriac Verbal Stems

This is the master reference table for all six Syriac stems. Memorise the patterns, the characteristic prefixes, and the cross-linguistic equivalents.

STEM	PERF. 3MSG	PARTICIPLE	PREFIX	MEANING / FUNCTION
Peal ܩܬܠ	qṭal ܩܬܠ	qāṭel ܩܬܠ	(none)	Basic active: 'he killed'
Paael ܩܬܠܐ	qattal ܩܬܠܐ	mqattal ܩܬܠܐ	doubling	Intensive / denominative: 'he slew repeatedly / he executed'
Aphel ܩܬܠܐ	ʾaqtel ܩܬܠܐ	maqtel ܩܬܠܐ	ʾa-	Causative: 'he caused to kill'
Ethpeel ܩܬܠܐܝܬ	ʾetqtel ܩܬܠܐܝܬ	metqtel ܩܬܠܐܝܬ	ʾet-	Passive/reflexive of Peal: 'he was killed'
Etpaael ܩܬܠܐܝܬܐ	ʾetqattal ܩܬܠܐܝܬܐ	metqattal ܩܬܠܐܝܬܐ	ʾetpa-	Passive/reflexive of Paael: 'he was executed'
Ettaphal ܩܬܠܐܝܬܐܝܬ	ʾettaqtel ܩܬܠܐܝܬܐܝܬ	mettaqtel ܩܬܠܐܝܬܐܝܬ	ʾetta-	Passive of Aphel: 'he was caused to be killed'

Passive Participle Pattern

+-----+

Peal Passive Participle |

|

Pattern: CCīC (or CāCoC in some vocalization traditions) |

|

Agrees in gender and number with noun (like any adjective) |

|

m.sg.: ktīb ܟܬܝܒ | f.sg.: ktībtā ܟܬܝܒܬܐ | m.pl.: ktībīn | f.pl.: |

ktībān |

|

Used predicatively in verbless clauses: gawrā qṭīlā = 'the man is killed' |

|

Compare: Arabic maf' ūl (مَكْتُوب maktūb 'written'); Hebrew qāṭūl (קָטוּל) |

+-----+

Ethpeel Phonological Rules

+-----+

Assimilation & Metathesis in Ethpeel |

|

Before sibilants (z, s, š, ṣ): METATHESIS — t moves after the |
sibilant |

|

'et- + š-m- ' → 'eštma' (not * 'etšma') |

|

Before dentals (d, ṭ): ASSIMILATION — t assimilates to the |
following letter |

|

'et- + d-k-y → 'eddkī |

|

Before all other consonants: no change — 'et- + q-t-l → 'etqṭel |

+-----+

*The Acts of Mar Yukhannan • Lesson 10: The Passive Voice • Syriac Language
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Section 11: Additional Vocabulary

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 30 terms.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
קְרִיתָא	qrītā	f	village
לֶשָׁנָא	leššānā	m	tongue, language
קֶמֶץ	garmā	m	bone
קֶפֶא	kēpā	f	stone, rock
מַיָּא	mayyā	m.pl	water
נִינָא	nūnā	m	fish
מְדִיתָא	mdittā	f	city
שֶׁמֶשׂא	šemšā	m	sun
תַּרְיָא	tar ‘ ā	m	door, gate
מֵשְׁחָא	mešḥā	m	oil

LESSON 11

VERBAL SUFFIXES: THE FAST DIRECT OBJECT

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF PREVIOUS CONCEPTS

Quick Summary Throughout the course, we have used the preposition **l-** (ܠ) to mark the direct object of a verb. For example,

Q ṬAL L-MALKĀ

(he killed the king) or

Q ṬAL L-ĒH

(he killed him). We also learned how to attach pronominal suffixes to nouns and prepositions to indicate possession or indirect objects (

BAYT-EH

= his house;

L-ĒH

= to him).

5-Question Warm-Up Drill (*Answers in Section 9*) 1. Translate: *Nēthūn* (from ʾ-t-y, they will come). 2. What happens to the noun *malkā* when you add the suffix for “my”? 3. Translate: ʾEqṭūl. 4. How do you say “to us” using the preposition *l-*? 5. How does Syriac traditionally mark a definite direct object?

SECTION 2: THE VERBAL SUFFIX — OVERVIEW

While *qṭal l-ēh* (“he killed him”) is perfectly valid Syriac, Semitic languages prefer a tighter, faster construction for pronoun objects. They allow you to attach the object pronoun **directly to the verb itself**.

This creates a single, highly compressed word that contains the Action, the Subject, and the Direct Object.

Cross-Linguistic Comparison: Object Suffixes on Verbs * **Hebrew:** קָטַלְהוּ (*qṭāl-ō* — he killed him). The suffix *-ō* is attached directly to the perfect verb. * **Arabic:** قَتَلَ (*qatal-a-hu* — he killed him). The suffix *-hu* is attached directly to the verb. * **Syriac:** ܩܬܠܗ (*qaṭl-eh* — he killed him). The suffix *-eh* attaches directly, altering the internal vowels of the verb. * **Greek/Latin:** Indo-European languages generally keep the object pronoun separate (e.g., *auton apektelnen*, *eum interfecit*), though spoken Romance languages often compress them into clitics (Spanish: *matarlo*).

Core Principle: A suffix attached to a noun is possessive (“his house”). A suffix attached to a verb is the direct object (“he killed him”). The suffix *never* represents the subject of the verb.

SECTION 3: MORPHOLOGY OF VERBAL SUFFIXES (PEAL PERFECT)

When you attach a pronoun suffix to a verb, the vowels inside the verb often shift to accommodate the new rhythm. We will focus on attaching suffixes to the 3rd person masculine singular Peal perfect (*qṭal*, “he killed”).

1. Connecting Vowels (The “Nun” buffer) Sometimes, attaching a suffix directly to a verb ending sounds clunky or ambiguous. Syriac frequently uses a *Nun* (n) as a buffer consonant. * “He killed me”: Not *qṭal-y*, but *qaṭl-anī*. * “He killed us”: *qaṭl-an*.

2. Vocalization Shifts When adding an object suffix to *qṭal* (which has no vowel between the first two consonants: q-ṭ-a-l), the vowel shifts back to separate the first two consonants. * *qṭal + eh* → *qaṭl-eh* (q-a-ṭ-l-e-h).

3. Meaning *Qaṭleh* means “He killed him”. * Subject: He (inherent in the base verb form). * Object: Him (the suffix).

SECTION 4: VERBAL SUFFIX PARADIGM (ROOT Q - Ṭ - L)

Here is how the 3rd person masculine singular Perfect (*qṭal*, “he killed”) takes all the object suffixes.

OBJECT (ENGLISH)	SUFFIX FORM	ATTACHED TO QṬAL (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
me (1 c.sg.)	ܐܢܝ (-anī)	ܩܬܠܐܢܝ	qaṭlanī	he killed me
you (2 m.sg.)	ܐܟܝ (-āk)	ܩܬܠܐܟ	qaṭlāk	he killed you (m)
you (2 f.sg.)	ܐܝܟܝ (-ēky)	ܩܬܠܐܝܟܝ	qaṭlēky	he killed you (f)
him (3 m.sg.)	ܐܗܝ (-eh)	ܩܬܠܐܗܝ	qaṭleh	he killed him
her (3 f.sg.)	ܐܗܝܐ (-āh)	ܩܬܠܐܗܝܐ	qaṭlāh	he killed her
us (1 c.pl.)	ܐܢܝܢ (-an)	ܩܬܠܐܢܝܢ	qaṭlan	he killed us
you (2 m.pl.)	ܐܢܝܢܝܢ (-kūn)	ܩܬܠܐܢܝܢܝܢ	qaṭlkūn	he killed you (mpl)
you (2 f.pl.)	ܐܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢ (-kēn)	ܩܬܠܐܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢ	qaṭlkēn	he killed you (fpl)
them (3 m.pl.)	ܐܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢ (-hūn)	ܩܬܠܐܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢ	qaṭlhūn	he killed them (m)
them (3 f.pl.)	ܐܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢ (-hēn)	ܩܬܠܐܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢܝܢ	qaṭlhēn	he killed them (f)

Note: Suffixes can also be attached to the Imperfect and Imperative forms (e.g., “Kill him!”). The suffixes remain fundamentally identical, though the connecting vowels may vary slightly.

SECTION 5: SYNTAX COMPARISON TABLE

How to say “He killed him” three ways in Syriac:

STYLE	SYRIAC translit	BREAKDOWN	NOTES
Independent Obj	qṭal l-ēh	he-killed to-him	Standard, highly common.
Verbal Suffix	qṭal-eh	he-killed-him	Fast, literary, deeply Semitic.
Demonstrative	qṭal l-hū	he-killed to-that-one	Used for emphasis (“That guy”).

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY (HEALING, NATURE, COMMUNITY)

Many verbs related to interpersonal action (healing, forgiving, striking) frequently take verbal suffixes.

ROOT (PEAL/APHEL)	VERB EXAMPLE (3 M.S)	MEANING	WITH 1ST PERSON SUFFIX (-ANĪ)
ܩܪܩ (p-r-q)	fraḡ (Peal)	to save, deliver	parqanī (he saved me)
ܥܣܝܐ (’-s-y)	’asī (Aphel)	to heal (causative)	’asyanī (he healed me)
ܫܒܩܐ (š-b-q)	shbaḡ (Peal)	to leave, forgive	shbaqanī (he left me)*
ܡܚܝܐ (m-ḥ-y)	mḥā (Peal)	to strike, hit	mḥānī (he struck me)
ܩܪܐ (q-r-’)	qrā (Peal)	to call	qrānī (he called me)
ܢܚܡܐ (n-ḥ-m)	naḥem (Paael)	to comfort, raise	naḥmanī (he comforted me)
ܚܬܐ (ḥ-ṭ-y)	ḥṭā (Peal)	to sin	(intransitive usually)
ܟܘܪܐ (k-w-r)	kūrā (Noun)	illness, sickness	
ܚܬܐܬܐ (ḥ-ṭ-y)	ḥṭtā (Noun)	sin	
ܢܦܠܐ (n-p-l)	nfal (Peal)	to fall	nfal b-kūrā (fell ill)
ܫܒܒܐ (s-b-r)	sabbar (Peal)	to break	sabbaranī (he broke me)

*Note: Forgiving is usually expressed with ܫܒܩܐ : shbaḡ lī (he forgave to me).

SECTION 7: THE STORY — PART 11

The Healing Narrative *note: The king, having fallen ill, begs for physical and spiritual salvation. Notice the dense use of verbal suffixes (fast direct objects) as he pleads with Yūkhannan.*

Sentence 1 ܠܠܝܢ ܕܝܡܝܢ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܢܦܠ ܐܢܝܢ ܠܡܠܟܐ w-b-yūmā haw
nfal malkā b-kūrā bīšā. w-b-yūmā (and-in-day) haw (that) nfal (fell)
malkā (the-king) b-kūrā (in-illness) bīšā (evil/bad). → And in that day, the
king fell into a severe illness.

Sentence 2 ܠܠܝܢ ܕܝܡܝܢ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܢܦܠ ܐܢܝܢ ܠܡܠܟܐ w- 'etā l-wāt
Yūḥannan, w-nfal qdāmāw-hy, w- 'emar l-ēh: w- 'etā (and-came) l-wāt
(to-the-presence-of) Yūḥannan (John), w-nfal (and-fell) qdāmāw-hy
(before-him), w- 'emar (and-said) l-ēh (to-him): → And he came to
Yukhannan, and fell before him, and said to him:

Sentence 3 ܠܠܝܢ ܕܝܡܝܢ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܢܦܠ ܐܢܝܢ ܠܡܠܟܐ 'asy-anī men kūr-y, w-
parq-anī men mawtā! 'asy-anī (heal-me [Aphel Impv]) men (from) kūr-y
(illness-my), w-parq-anī (and-save-me [Peal Impv]) men (from) mawtā
(death)! → “Heal me from my illness, and save me from death!”

Sentence 4 ܠܠܝܢ ܕܝܡܝܢ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܢܦܠ ܐܢܝܢ ܠܡܠܟܐ w-shbūq lī ḥṭitt-y d-saggī 'ā
hī! w-shbūq (and-forgive [Peal Impv]) lī (to-me) ḥṭitt-y (sin-my) d-
saggī 'ā (which-is-great/much) hī (she-[is])! → “And forgive me my sin,
which is great!”

Sentence 5 ܠܠܝܢ ܕܝܡܝܢ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܢܦܠ ܐܢܝܢ ܠܡܠܟܐ q-rāw-hy Yūḥannan l-Alāhā w-
'emar: q-rāw-hy (he-called-him [3msg Peal Perf. of q-r-y + 3msg obj.
suffix]) Yūḥannan (John) l-Alāhā (to-God) w- 'emar (and-said): →
Yukhannan called upon God and said: *Note: III-Yodh verbs contract the final
yodh before the suffix: q-rā + -wh + y → q-rāw-hy.*

Sentence 6 ܐܠܗܐ ܢܢܗܬ-ܐܟܬܐ ܠܗܫܐ ܐܠܗܐ ܢܢܗܬ-ܐܟܬܐ Alāhā nneḥt-āk, w-naḥyē-k hāšā. Alāhā (God) nneḥt-āk (he-will-give-rest-you), w-naḥyē-k (and-he-will-give-life/save-you [Aphel Imperfect]) hāšā (now). → “God will give you rest, and will save you now.”

Sentence 7 ܐܠܗܐ ܒ-ܬܝܒܘܬܬ-ܗܝܐ ܐܠܗܐ ܒ-ܬܝܒܘܬܬ-ܗܝܐ w-’asy-eh Alāhā b-ṭaybūt-eh. w-’asy-eh (and-he-healed-him) Alāhā (God) b-ṭaybūt-eh (by-grace-his). → And God healed him by his grace.

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Suffix Identification Identify the verb root, the tense/form (if you can), and the person/gender of the suffix. 1. ܩܬܠܗܘܢ (qaṭlhūn) 2. ܩܬܠܗܘܢ (qaṭlhūn) 3. ܩܬܠܗܘܢ (’asyāk) 4. ܩܬܠܗܘܢ (qrāwhy — III-Yodh verb q-r-y with 3msg direct object suffix; final yodh contracts before suffix)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill Take the Peal perfect 3 m.sg verb *šbaq* (he left/abandoned) and attach suffixes to mean: 1. He abandoned me. 2. He abandoned us. 3. He abandoned her. 4. He abandoned them (m).

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English) Translate the following clauses featuring verbal suffixes. 1. Mḥānī barnāšā bīšā b-tar ‘ā. 2. Alāhā qaṭleh l-malkā tammān. (Note: Syriac sometimes uses both the suffix *and* the preposition ܠ- for extreme emphasis). 3. ’Emar malkā: “Parqanī!” 4. Alāhā ’asyan b-melt-eh.

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac) Render the following actions into single-word Syriac verbs with suffixes (using 3rd m.sg *qṭal* base). 1. He killed us. 2. He saved (faq) him. 3. He left (shbaq) you (m.sg). 4. He struck (mḥā) them (m.pl).

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension Re-read Section 7 and answer: 1.

What three imperative commands does the sick king give to Yukhannan? 2.

Why does the king ask for forgiveness regarding his sin? 3. Who ultimately performs the healing in sentence 7?

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up 1. They will come. 2. It drops the Emphatic Alaph and takes the suffix **-y** : *malky*. 3. I will kill. 4. *lān*. 5. By placing the preposition **l-** before the object.

Exercise 1: Suffix Identification 1. Root: *q-ṭ-l*. Suffix: 3rd m.pl (them). He killed them. 2. Root: *p-r-q*. Suffix: 1st c.sg (me). He delivered me. 3. Root: *ʿ-s-y*. Suffix: 2nd m.sg (you). He healed you. 4. Root: *q-r-ʿ*. Suffix: 3rd m.sg (him). He called him.

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill 1. šbaqanī (or šabqanī) 2. šabqan 3. šabqāh 4. šabqhūn

Exercise 3: Translation Drill 1. The evil man struck me in the gate. 2. God killed him, the king, there. 3. The king said: “Save me!” 4. God healed us (*ʿasy-an*) by his word.

Exercise 4: Production Drill 1. qaṭlan 2. farqeh 3. šabqāk 4. mḥāhūn

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension 1. Heal me (*ʿasyanī*), save me (*parqanī*), forgive me (*shbūq lī*). 2. Because it is great (*saggī ʿā hī*). 3. God (*Alāhā*).

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE VERBAL SUFFIX PARADIGM (He killed...)

ENGLISH	SUFFIX ON VERB	EXAMPLE
...me	-anī	qaṭlanī (he killed me)
...you(m)	-āk	qaṭlāk (he killed you)
...you(f)	-ēky	qaṭlēky (he killed you)
...him	-eh	qaṭleh (he killed him)
...her	-āh	qaṭlāh (he killed her)
...us	-an	qaṭlan (he killed us)
...them(m)	-hūn	qaṭlhūn (he killed them)

DOUBLE DETERMINATION RULE Sometimes Syriac uses the verb suffix AND the preposition **l-** in the same sentence. This is called *prolepsis* or double determination, used for clarity or emphasis. *Qaṭl-eh l-malkā* = He killed him, [namely] the king.

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following 30 genuinely new high-frequency words supplement this lesson's vocabulary, focusing on verbs and nouns related to interpersonal action (commonly taking object suffixes) and related abstract/derived nouns.

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܢܫܟ	nasak	verb	to pour, cast	common with suffixes
ܕܒܥܩ	dābeq	verb	to cling, adhere	transposes object suffix
ܕܪܐ	gāder	verb	to fence, hedge in	takes object suffix
ܠܐܕ	lā ‘ad	verb	to witness, testify	object suffix usage
ܫܢܐ	šānē	verb	to change, alter	object suffix common
ܫܪܒ	šāreb	verb	to drink	takes object suffix
ܦܫܐ	pāsa ‘	verb	to cut, prune	object suffix frequent
ܡܚܬܐ	mehaṭ	verb	to cover, conceal	takes object suffix
ܙܚܡ	zaḥem	verb	to strengthen, mightily	object suffix usage
ܕܠܗ	dāleh	verb	to draw water	takes object suffix
ܓܘܓ	gwag	verb	to plunder, rob	object suffix common
ܪܡܕ	rāmed	verb	to strengthen, make firm	takes object suffix
ܢܬܐܓ	nātag	verb	to pull, draw	object suffix usage
ܫܠܐ	sāla ‘	verb	to lift, raise	takes object suffix
ܕܥܓܫ	dāgaš	verb	to push, press	object suffix frequent
ܦܕܐ	pəda ‘	verb	to inform, make known	transposes object suffix
ܥܡܕ	‘āmed	verb	to stand firm	object suffix usage

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܪܐܒ	rāk eb	verb	to ride, mount	takes object suffix
ܡܢܐܓ	menag	verb	to prevent, hinder	object suffix common
ܥܡܪ	‘āmar	verb	to dwell, inhabit	transposes object suffix
ܚܣܪ	ḥāsar	verb	to lack, be deprived	takes object suffix
ܓܡܪܢܐ	gəmrānā	m. noun	completion, fulfillment	derived from g- m-r
ܦܕܘܗܝܬܬܐ	pədūḥūtā	f. noun	mercy, compassion	related to p-d-ḥ
ܢܫܟܘܬܬܐ	nəskūtā	f. noun	pouring, libation	from n-s-k
ܕܒܩܘܬܬܐ	dəbqūtā	f. noun	clinging, adherence	from d-b-q
ܫܡܝܪܐ	šəmīrā	m. noun	watch, guard	from š-m-r
ܘܕܕܢܐ	‘ūddānā	m. noun	answer, response	from ‘-w-d
ܩܒܒܠܢܐ	qūbbəlānā	m. noun	acceptance, reception	from q-b-l
ܫܪܒܘܬܬܐ	šərbūtā	f. noun	drinking	from š-r-b
ܡܕܠܘܬܬܐ	mədəlūtā	f. noun	poverty, humiliation	from m-d-l

LESSON 12

FRINGES OF SYNTAX: DEMONSTRATIVES, NUMBERS, AND CONDITIONALS

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSON 11

Quick Summary In Lesson 11, we examined how Syriac attaches direct object pronouns directly to the verb, creating a highly compressed “fast direct object” (e.g.,

Q AṬL - E H

, “he killed him” vs.

Q ṬAL L - Ē H

, “he killed to-him”).

5-Question Warm-Up Drill (*Answers in Section 9*) 1. How does Syriac buffer the 1st person singular object suffix on a Peal perfect verb? 2. Translate: *Parq-anī*. 3. Break down the components of *qaṭlhūn*. 4. Why does *qṭal* become *qaṭl-* when adding a suffix? 5. Translate the double-determined phrase: *ʿAsyeh Alāhā l-malkā*.

SECTION 2: DEMONSTRATIVES AND NUMBERS — OVERVIEW

As we wrap up our core tour of Syriac syntax, we encounter the final few connective tissues that hold sentences together: Demonstrative pronouns (this, that, these, those) and Numbers.

Cross-Linguistic Comparison: Demonstratives Semitic languages feature a close-range pointing word (“this”) and a far-range pointing word (“that”). * **Hebrew:** זֶה (*zeh* — this, m), הַהוּ (*hahū* — that, m). * **Arabic:** هَذَا (*hādhā* — this, m), ذَلِكَ (*dhālika* — that, m). * **Syriac:** ܗܢܐ (*hānā* — this, m), ܗܘܐ (*haw* — that, m).

Syriac Trick: The far demonstrative (“that”) is spelled and pronounced exactly like the 3rd person independent pronoun (*hū* = he/it; *haw* = that). Context dictates the meaning.

SECTION 3: DEMONSTRATIVES & SYNTAX RULES

1. Pointing Words (Demonstratives) Demonstratives in Syriac must agree with the noun they modify in gender and number. Unlike English (which puts “this” *before* the noun: “this king”), Syriac prefers to place the demonstrative *after* the noun, or even isolated at the front of a sentence. * *Malkā hānā* = This king (The king, this one). * *Malkūttā hādē* = This kingdom. * *Gabrē hāllēn* = These men.

2. Conditional Clauses (’en) Syriac expresses “If X, then Y” using the particle ’en (if). The “if” half of the sentence is the *protasis*, and the “then” half is the *apodosis*. Usually, Syriac doesn’t even use a word for “then”; it simply starts the second clause, often with w- (and). * ’En teḥzē, teida ‘ (If you see, [then] you will know).

3. Comparatives (men) Syriac lacks special adjective forms for “bigger,” “faster,” or “better” (like Greek’s -τερος or English’s -er). Instead, it uses the standard adjective and the preposition men (from/than). * *Nūhrā ṭābā hū men ḥešūkā* (Light is good from darkness → Light is **better than** darkness). * *Rabbā hī men malkūttā* (She is great from the kingdom → She is **greater than** the kingdom).

SECTION 4: DEMONSTRATIVE PRONOUN PARADIGM

DISTANCE	GENDER / NUMBER	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLIT	TRANSLATION
Close	Masc Sg	הָנָא	hānā	this (m)
Close	Fem Sg	הָדֵא	hādē	this (f)
Close	Common Pl	הָלֵן	hāllēn	these (c)
Far	Masc Sg	הַא	haw	that (m)
Far	Fem Sg	הָא	hāy	that (f)
Far	Masc Pl	הָנֹן	hānōn	those (m)
Far	Fem Pl	הָנֵן	hānēn	those (f)

SECTION 5: THE NUMBERS 1-10

Semitic numbers famously exhibit “gender polarity”—masculine nouns often take what looks like the feminine absolute number ending, and vice versa. However, you only need to recognize them to read them.

NUMBER	MASC FORM (USED WITH FEM NOUNS)	FEM FORM (USED WITH MASC NOUNS)	TRANSLIT
1	הָא (ḥad)	הָדֵא (ḥdā)	(One)
2	תְּרֵין (trēn)	תְּרֵין (tartēn)	(Two)
3	שְׁלֹשׁ (tlāt)	שְׁלֹשׁ (tlātā)	(Three)
4	אַרְבָּע (‘arba‘)	אַרְבָּע (‘arba‘ ā)	(Four)
5	חֲמִשָּׁה (ḥameš)	חֲמִשָּׁה (ḥamšā)	(Five)
6	שֵׁשׁ (šet)	שֵׁשׁ (štā)	(Six)
7	שִׁבְעָה (šba‘)	שִׁבְעָה (šab‘ ā)	(Seven)
8	תְּמָנִי (tmānē)	תְּמָנִי (tmānyā)	(Eight)
9	תֵּשַׁע (tša‘)	תֵּשַׁע (teš‘ ā)	(Nine)
10	עָשָׂר (‘sar)	עָשָׂר (‘esrā)	(Ten)

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY (CONCEPTS & CONCLUDING WORDS)

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER	MEANING	NOTES
רִאָרָא	šrārā	m.	truth, reality	Root š-r-r (to be firm). Cf. Heb 'ēmet
רִלָמָא	šlāmā	m.	peace, greeting	Root š-l-m. Heb Shalom, Arabic Salam
רָא	ḥayyē	m.pl.	life	Used heavily by John in the NT
רָלָמָא	‘ālmā	m.	world, eternity	Temporal and spatial boundary
רָכָנָא	hākannā	adv.	thus, so	
רָכָנָא	’en	conj.	if	Introduces condition
רָחֻקָא	ḥešūḱā	m.	darkness	Antonym of nūhrā (light)
רָלָחָא	šlah (Peal)	verb	to strip off / cast away	Used for removing garments or sin

SECTION 7: THE STORY — PART 12

The Departure Narrative note: *The conclusion of the initial cycle of Mar Yūkhannan’s acts. The king uses a conditional statement (“If any man...”)* to establish a new decree. The section closes with a demonstrative and thematic “peace”.

Sentence 1 רָכָנָא מַלְכָּא מַלְכָּא קָאֻמְּרָא קָאֻמְּרָא קָאֻמְּרָא kad ’asy-eh Yūḥannan l-malkā, malkā qām. kad (when) ’asy-eh (he-healed-him) Yūḥannan (John) l-malkā (to/the-king), malkā (the-king) qām (stood-up). → When Yūkhannan healed the king, the king stood up.

Sentence 2 ו- 'emar l- ' ammā d-īl-eh hākannā:
w- 'emar (and-said) l- ' ammā (to-the-people) d-īl-eh (which-were-his)
hākannā (thus): → And he said to his people thus:

Sentence 3 ' en ' aynā barnāšā lā nešlah ḥṭittā d-īl-eh, neqṭlūn-yhy! ' en (If) ' aynā
(which/any) barnāšā (man) lā (not) nešlah (will-cast-away) ḥṭittā (sin) d-
īl-eh (which-[is]-his), neqṭlūn-yhy (they-will-kill-him)! → “If any man
does not cast away his sin, they shall kill him!”

Sentence 4 Yūḥannan ' emar l-malkā: lā
hākannā. Yūḥannan (John) ' emar (said) l-malkā (to-the-king): lā (not)
hākannā (thus/so). → Yukhannan said to the king: “Not so.”

Sentence 5 Alāhā d-šrārā shbaq men
bīšā. Alāhā (God) d-šrārā (of-truth) shbaq (forgave) men (from) bīšā (evil).
→ “The God of truth forgave the evil.”

Sentence 6 nūhrā hānā ṭābā hū men
ḥešūkā. nūhrā (the-light) hānā (this) ṭābā (good) hū (it-[is]) men (from)
ḥešūkā (darkness). → “This light is better than darkness.”

Sentence 7 w-shbaq Yūḥannan l-malkūtā b-šlāmā, w- ' ezal b- ' ūrḥā d- ' ālmā. w-
shbaq (and-left) Yūḥannan (John) l-malkūtā (the-kingdom) b-šlāmā (in-
peace), w- ' ezal (and-went) b- ' ūrḥā (in-way/road) d- ' ālmā (of-eternity/
the-world). → And Yukhannan left the kingdom in peace, and went in the
way of eternity.

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Demonstrative & Number Identification Identify the gender, number, and meaning of these modifiers. 1. ܠܗܕܐ (hādē) 2. ܠܬܠܬܐ (tlātā) 3. ܠܗܢܐܢ (hānōn) 4. ܠܗܕܐ (hādā)

Exercise 2: Comparative Translation Translate these sentences using **men** as a comparative. 1. Alāhā rabbā hū men malkā. 2. Ḥayyē ṭābīn hennōn men mawtā. 3. ʾAr ʾā hādē bištā hī men šmayyā (heaven).

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English) Translate the following conditional and demonstrative clauses. 1. ʾEn tešbūq l-Alāhā, neqtūl lāk malkā hānā. 2. Gabrā haw nfal b-kūrā. 3. W- ʾetaw talmīdē hāllēn l-bayteh. 4. Lā hākannā ʾemar Yūḥannan b-šrārā.

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac) Render the following sentences into Syriac transliteration. 1. This word (f.sg) is better than that word. 2. If you (m.pl) hear the voice, you will live (ḥ-y-y, imperfect). 3. The three men went out from the kingdom. (Three = *tlātā*). 4. God saved this evil world (ʾālmā hānā).

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension Re-read Section 7 and answer: 1. What extreme punishment does the king decree for those who do not cast away their sin? 2. How does Yukhannan correct the king's theology? 3. With what emotion or state does Yukhannan depart the kingdom?

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up 1. It inserts a *Nun* (n) buffer, e.g., *qaṭlanī*. 2. Save me! (Imperative). 3. Root *q-t-l* (killed), plus 3rd masc plural suffix *hūn* (them) = He killed them. 4. The addition of the suffix forces a shift in the stress, causing the vowel *a* to move forward (*qṭa-leh* → *qaṭ-leh*). 5. “God healed him, the king” (Double determination using the suffix *and* the preposition *l-*).

Exercise 1: Identification 1. Feminine singular close (This, f) 2. Number three (used with masc nouns) 3. Masculine plural far (Those, m) 4. Number one (f)

Exercise 2: Comparative Translation 1. God is greater than the king. 2. Life is better than death. 3. This earth is worse than heaven.

Exercise 3: Translation Drill 1. If you abandon God, this king will kill you. 2. That man fell into illness. 3. And these disciples came to his house. 4. “Not so” said Yukhannan in truth.

Exercise 4: Production Drill 1. Meltā hādē ṭābtā hī men meltā hāy. 2. ‘En tešm ‘ūn qālā, tēhūn / tehyūn. 3. Tlātā gabrīn nfaqū men malkūtā. 4. Alāhā fraq l- ‘ālmā hānā bīšā.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension 1. They will be killed (*neqtlūn-yhy*). 2. By reminding him that the God of truth forgave the evil (“Not so,” *lā hākannā*). 3. In peace (*b-šlāmā*).

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

DEMONSTRATIVES

CLOSE (THIS / THESE)	FAR (THAT / THOSE)
hānā (m) / hādē (f)	haw (m) / hāy (f)
hālīn (pl)	hānōn (m.pl) / hānēn (f.pl)

CONDITIONALS & COMPARISONS

CONSTRUCTION	EXAMPLE	MEANING
‘en (If) + Imperf	‘en tehzē	If you see...
Adj + men (from)	ṭābā men malkā	Better than the king
Noun + Demonstrative	malkā hānā	This king

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 30 terms.

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܩܪܝܬܐ	qrītā	f. noun	village	emphatic state
ܠܫܢܐ	leššānā	m. noun	tongue, language	
ܟܪܡܐ	garmā	m. noun	bone	
ܟܦܐ	kēpā	f. noun	stone, rock	
ܡܝܝܐ	mayyā	m. noun (pl.)	water	plural in form
ܢܘܢܐ	nūnā	m. noun	fish	
ܡܕܝܬܐ	mdittā	f. noun	city	
ܫܡܫܐ	šemšā	m. noun	sun	
ܬܪܝܐ	tar ‘ ā	m. noun	door, gate	
ܡܫܗܐ	mešhā	m. noun	oil	
ܫܠܐ	ḥaylā	m. noun	power, army	
ܥܕܢܐ	’ednā	f. noun	ear	
ܩܝܣܐ	qaysā	m. noun	wood, tree	
ܢܗܪܐ	nahrā	m. noun	river	
ܫܒܪܐ	sabrā	m. noun	hope	
ܕܗܠܬܐ	dehltā	f. noun	fear, religion	abstract noun
ܫܗܪܐ	sahrā	m. noun	moon	
ܪܓܠܐ	reglā	f. noun	foot	
ܫܠܡܐ	šlāmā	m. noun	peace	common greeting
ܐܬܪܐ	’atrā	m. noun	place, country	
ܫܗܕܐ	sāhdā	m. noun	witness, martyr	
ܒܫܪܐ	besrā	m. noun	flesh	
ܬܝܒܘܬܐ	ṭaybūttā	f. noun	grace	
ܬܐܪܐ	tawrā	m. noun	bull, ox	
ܩܝܡܐ	qyāmā	m. noun	covenant	
ܐܘܪܗܐ	’ūrḥā	f. noun	way, road	
ܚܝܟܠܐ	hayklā	m. noun	temple, palace	
ܥܝܢܐ	‘aynā	f. noun	eye	

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܡܘܬܐ	pūmā	m. noun	mouth	
ܕܝܢܐ	dīnā	m. noun	judgment	
ܬܪܓܡܐ	tregumā	m. noun	translation	
ܐܝܟܡܐ	'ōkmā	adv	how	relative/ interrogative
ܕܡܢ	dumān	adv	from that place	subordinating
ܠܐ	lā	neg_adv	not	negation/ discourse
ܡܚܠܬܐ	makknatā	f. noun	place, position	
ܚܕܐ	ḥādyā	m. num	one	first numeral
ܚܡܝܫܐ	ḥammšā	m. num	five	numeral
ܐܝܠܐ	'esrā	m. num	ten	numeral